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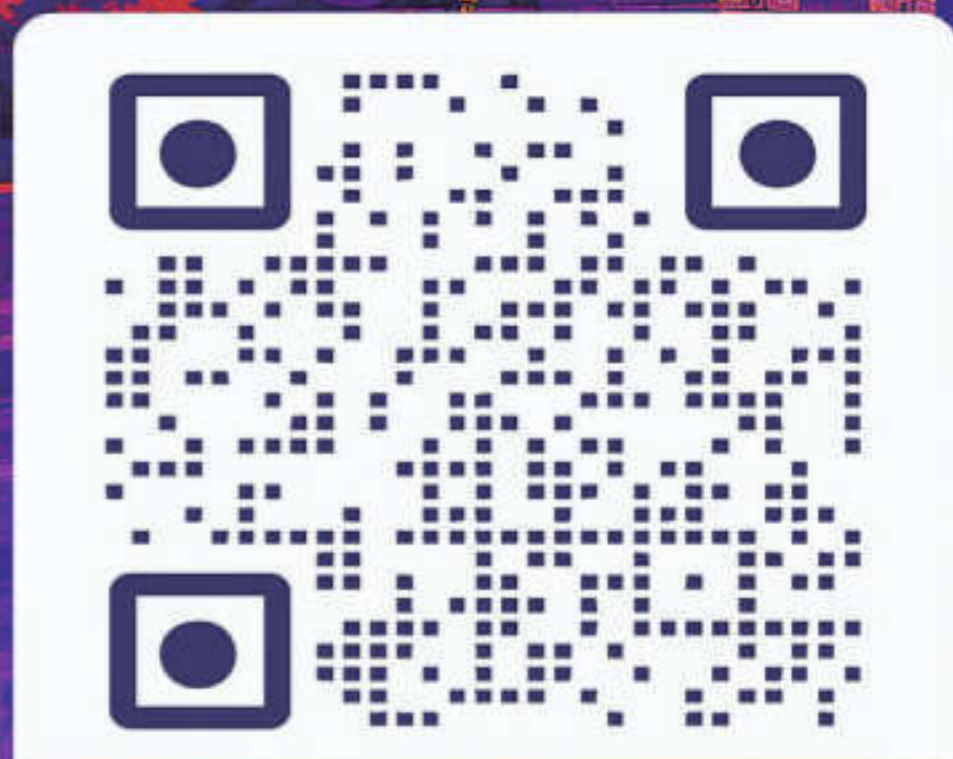
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'ALTERNATIVE FOR GERMANY' SURGES INTO FIRST PLACE IN SAXONY-ANHALT STATE ELECTIONS

Far-Right AfD posts historic election win, exit polls show

Merz coalition under pressure as AfD is poised to win 44.5% vote

Reuters
Berlin, September 6

THE ALTERNATIVE for Germany (AfD) surged into first place in state elections in Saxony-Anhalt on Sunday, exit polls showed, putting a Far-Right party on the cusp of power at state level for the first time since World War II.

The AfD won 44.5% of the vote, with Chancellor Friedrich Merz's conservatives trailing behind on 18.5%, and the Centre-Left Social Democrats and environmental Greens both clearing the minimum threshold to enter Parliament, according to an exit poll from the ARD broadcaster.

"We have made history in this country," said Ulrich Siegmund, the 35-year-old AfD lead candidate in Saxony-Anhalt, who drew thousands to his campaign rallies and repeatedly cast victory in state as a first step towards securing national power in federal elections due in 2029.

The result marks a major advance in the AfD's push for national power and a significant setback for Merz's coalition government, although it remained unclear whether the party would be able to form a state government. Turnout was



Ulrich Siegmund, leader of the AfD party, and his wife Julia leave a polling station in Tangermünde, Germany, on Sunday. AP

around 76%, well above levels typically seen in state elections.

Much could depend on whether the Left-wing populist BSW party, a potential AfD coalition partner, could also clear the threshold. Exit polls showed it just above or just below it.

The AfD party's co-leader Alice Weidel hailed an "historic" result which had given the AfD a clear mandate to govern but it was not clear whether it would be able to form a government.

State premier Sven Schulze congratulated the AfD and acknowledged the result showed it was the strongest party.

If the AfD is unable to rule

outright, it could trigger a protracted process of coalition building by mainstream parties who are determined to keep a party under investigation for right-wing extremism by Germany's domestic intelligence service out of power.

The AfD's programme includes plans to push schools and cultural institutions towards more traditional values, curb immigration and overhaul public broadcasting.

While hard right parties have gained ground elsewhere in Europe, Germany's Nazi past has contributed to a reluctance among mainstream parties to

cooperate with the AfD, which wants a hard line on migration and warmer ties with Russia.

The AfD has dismissed accusations of extremism as scaremongering and an insult to the party's millions of supporters.

Sunday's result is another blow to Merz's authority, whose popularity has sagged as his coalition government struggles to revive growth in Europe's largest economy. In a fracturing political landscape, the AfD is now Germany's most popular party nationally, though other parties have ruled out forging

coalitions with the AfD in a policy known as the "firewall".

Former salesman of air fresheners brings Far-Right to cusp of power

Christopher F Schuetze
Tangermünde, September 6

DURING THE Covid pandemic, a little-known German state lawmaker with an upbeat patter and a telegenic smile started railing on TikTok against regulations.

Complaining about masks, vaccinations and government requirement he deemed "crazy," the lawmaker attracted millions of viewers with his videos by using an affable tone to deliver

an anti-establishment message. Now, that lawmaker, Ulrich Siegmund, has harnessed his online popularity to come closer to power than any other far-right politician in Germany since the Nazi era ended in 1945.

Siegmund, 35, a former air fresher salesman, is the lead candidate for AfD in Saxony-Anhalt, a state in eastern Germany where party is projected to finish first in a statewide poll Sunday.

If the party, known by its German initials, AfD, wins an outright majority, Siegmund will become the first far-right politician to govern a German state since the reestablishment of the country's democracy nearly eight decades ago.

To the political establishment in Berlin, Siegmund's party is an outcast. The domestic intelligence agency has labeled it as "suspected extremist," an accusation it rejects as politically motivated. NYT

US envoys meet Zelenskyy in Kyiv amid fresh peace push

Zelenskyy: Hope to restart talks with US and Russia soon

Reuters
Kyiv, September 6

UKRAINE'S TALKS with US peace negotiators Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner were "very substantial", President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said on Sunday.

Zelenskyy told reporters that they discussed security and economic guarantees for Ukraine and also supplies of air-defence missiles and a winter support package. He also hoped that trilateral talks, including Ukraine, Russia and the US would restart soon.

The two envoys met Zelenskyy and other top Ukrainian officials in central Kyiv. Zelenskyy, who believes Washington will be key to any peace deal, said a window of opportunity to make peace exists before US begins focusing on next presidential polls.

After the first round of talks between Ukrainian and US negotiators that lasted about three hours, the US envoys said that they were looking forward to making more progress.

"Substantive, important, and we are very encouraged," Witkoff told reporters after the talks, which also included a working



Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelenskyy with US envoys Jared Kushner and Steve Witkoff in Kyiv on Sunday. REUTERS

lunch. Zelenskyy said that more talks, which would also include European representatives, were planned later on Sunday.

Kushner and Witkoff travelled from Moscow, where they held three hours of talks with Russian President Vladimir Putin but did not appear to secure a breakthrough.

Previous rounds of US-mediated peace talks encouraged by President Donald Trump, who campaigned on a promise to quickly end war, have yielded few results. He suggested Friday US had a fresh proposal though he did not elaborate.

Kremlin aide Yuri Ushakov described Saturday's meeting as "highly useful", while a White House official told Reuters that next steps would be announced in the coming weeks.

Leipzig drone accusations 'start of real war': Lavrov

Moscow: Russian Foreign Minister Sergei Lavrov said on Sunday that the accusations levelled at Moscow by the West that it was involved in the drone incident at Germany's Leipzig airport were, "by and large, the start of a real war," state news agency TASS reported.

"All these statements by Merz about making Germany the leading military power in Europe once again – they are being put into practice. He is, in effect, declaring war on us," Lavrov said. REUTERS

NEPAL DISASTER: SEARCH ON FOR MISSING, IDENTIFYING THE DEAD REMAINS A CHALLENGE

Rescued after 10 days: Survivor's family in China relieved

Associated Press
Hong Kong, September 6

AFTER DAYS of waiting anxiously, Lu Haitao's family could finally breathe a sigh of relief when the Chinese man was rescued from a tunnel in Nepal where devastating floods killed more than 1,300 people.

Rescuers carried out Lu from a 225-meter (740-foot) hydro-power tunnel and evacuated him by helicopter Saturday, 10 days after the floods. He was taken to a hospital and was in stable condition, Chinese state

broadcaster CCTV reported.

Lu recalled climbing to the highest point inside the tunnel and thinking the whistles he heard from the rescue crews were in his imagination, according to audio shared by CCTV.

He said that the emergency personnel initially could not hear him when he shouted towards their lights.

"When they shone before my eyes, I couldn't believe it," he said. "I no longer shouted. I had lost hope." Lu Hairong, Lu's sister in China, told state media Red Star News that she received



Lu Haitao was rescued 10 days after being stranded in a tunnel at Trishuli Hydropower project

a call about the rescue before the news emerged. But she only found it believable after seeing him in a picture in the news.

Her 49-year-old brother, who is married with a son, was previously a farmer from Henan province in central China and took additional work, mainly carpentry, during his spare time.

He headed to Nepal for work with a fellow villager in February, his first time working abroad, she told Red Star News.

She told Cover News, another Chinese state media outlet, that Lu had not shared his exact

working location and she could only watch the news sent by others in a mutual aid group for families of the missing, unable to eat or sleep well. "It's a stroke of sheer luck amid the misfortune," she said of the rescue.

On Saturday, Lu's cousin received a picture from his sister asking her to help confirm his identity. The man looked very similar but she needed to call another relative to help confirm, the report said. "This day has finally come," she was quoted as saying. "There is hope when one doesn't give up."

Reuters
Dubai, September 6

IRAN SAID it will step up efforts to tackle problems created by the US sanctions that are crippling its economy, while a senior Iranian official warned of a "painful response" if it comes under further attack.

After a pause in military action for much of August, tit-for-tat strikes have resumed with US Central Command saying it hit three Iran tankers Saturday after Iran's Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps launched ballistic missiles at two US Navy ships.

Following the attacks, Iran's Parliament Speaker Moham-

mad Baqer Ghalibaf said Sunday that the US should understand that the rules of the game in the war against Iran have changed "before it is too late".

"From now on, any attack against Iran's interests and security will receive a faster, heavier and more painful response," he said in a speech published on his Telegram channel.

Tehran has shown it retains the capability to attack US interests in neighbouring countries and to shut down oil flows through the Strait of Hormuz.

However, the US campaign to throttle Iran's economy by blockading its oil exports and stopping sanctions evasion is

growing increasingly difficult to withstand, three senior Iranian sources have said.

In his speech Sunday, Ghalibaf added alongside the military front, Iran's main battle was now over production and people's livelihoods.

He cited sharp currency fluctuations, inflation, unemployment and market management as major challenges.

Iran's Economy Minister Ali Madanizadeh said that Tehran planned to respond to US economic pressure with reforms and rejected the notion that sanctions would cause it to change course, according to state media on Sunday.

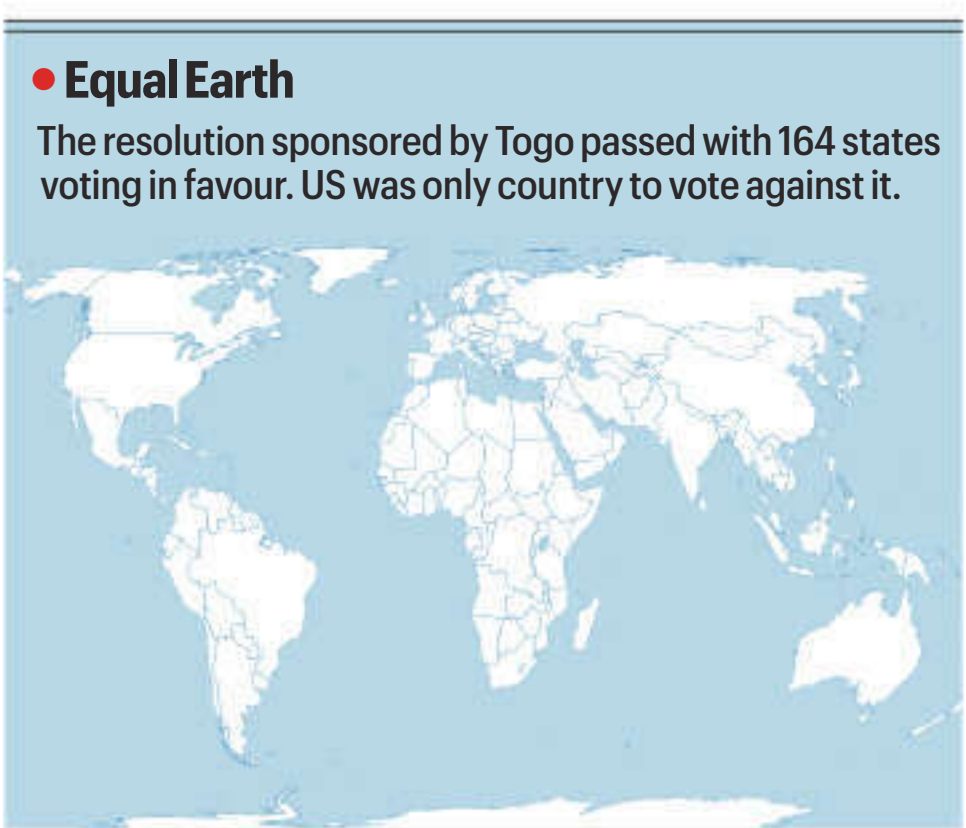
Schoolchildren among 25 killed in Cape Verde bus accident

Lisbon: At least 25 people, many of them schoolchildren and teenagers, were killed when a bus plunged into ravine on Fogo, one of Cape Verde's islands in Atlantic Ocean off coast of West Africa, national news agency Infopress reported Sunday.

The crash occurred on a mountain road in northern Fogo late on Saturday, when the bus veered off the road and plunged about 30 metres into a steep ravine, the report said, adding many on board were primary and secondary school students.

Several injured passengers were taken to Sao Francisco de Assis Regional Hospital on Fogo.

The outing was not organised by local schools but was an annual trip privately arranged by the driver, who was among those killed, Infopress said. REUTERS



Brave New World Map

The new world map that the UN endorsed on September 4 represents Africa, which is 14 times larger than Greenland, more accurately. The UN move encourages governments and institutions around the world to replace the traditional Mercator map, used since the 16th century, with the Equal Earth projection. Friday's resolution does not ban the Mercator projection or impose a replacement, but only encourages the use of the Equal Earth projection, the UN said. AP

• BRIEFLY

INDONESIA

Flights cancelled after Krakatau volcano erupts

INDONESIA'S ANAK Krakatau volcano erupted Sunday, prompting cancellation of flights at Jakarta's Soekarno-Hatta International Airport and disrupting domestic airports as volcanic ash drifted across parts of Indonesia. Indonesia's Geological Agency said the volcano had showed signs of activity since Friday before erupting for 30 seconds at 3:53 am on Sunday. No casualties were reported and no evacuation order was issued. AP

ISRAEL

Seven killed after airstrikes on south Lebanon

ISRAELI STRIKES killed seven people, including two women, in southern Lebanon on Sunday, the Lebanese health ministry said, as Israel retaliated for what it said were Hezbollah drone attacks within areas occupied by its troops. Despite a US-brokered ceasefire deal with Hezbollah agreed in June, the Israeli military is operating in what it has declared a security zone in southern Lebanon. REUTERS

• 12.7MN NEW GRADUATES ARE JOINING CHINA'S WORKFORCE THIS YEAR AS A.I. BEGINS RESTRUCTURING INDUSTRIES & CHANGING RECRUITERS' PRIORITIES

For China's new graduates, biggest challenge — AI killing jobs

Yan Zhuang
September 6

A FEW months out from graduating with a master's degree in urban planning, Jin Shanguy is watching artificial intelligence upend the industry she is trying to enter.

Job boards are filled with roles that require AI expertise, while listings for traditional roles seem to be dwindling. Much of the work involved in the early stage of a design project, which used to involve several people, can now be executed with a few clicks of a mouse.

Since getting her degree from the University of Hong Kong, Jin, 26, who is from northern

China, has applied for about 150 internships and entry-level jobs in Hong Kong and mainland China, but has been met with silence. She took a \$400 professional AI course in hopes of standing out in the marketplace.

It does not seem to have helped. No wonder, she thought: If even seasoned workers are being undercut by AI, what chance was there for those seeking to enter the workforce?

"My feeling is that we, new graduates, are exactly the kind of people that AI will replace," she said. "I really don't know how to even begin because I don't see hope."

An estimated 12.7 million new graduates are joining



Students line up at career guidance booths during a job fair in Beijing. REUTERS

China's workforce this year, the largest yet of a cohort that has been steadily growing over the

years. They are facing two intractable and connected challenges. Like previous classes, they are entering an oversaturated job market and competing for a shrinking pool of entry-level positions in a sluggish economy.

But they also face a new obstacle in the added uncertainty of AI, which is beginning to restructure industries and change recruiters' priorities.

It is a global problem. College graduates around the world are grappling with the prospect that entry-level jobs could simply disappear. But in China, the concern is acute. The country has adopted AI at an almost unmatched pace, spurred by government support and broad

public enthusiasm, while unemployment remains high.

In July, the rate for urban residents aged 16 to 24 was 17.9%.

The supply of desirable, well-paying graduate jobs has not kept pace with the ballooning number of young people who entered college. "AI has arrived at a particularly difficult moment, though it did not create the underlying problem," said Christian Yao, a senior lecturer at Victoria University of Wellington in New Zealand.

For China's leaders, who have long derived much of their political authority from the promise of prosperity, there is a risk that high youth unemployment could be a source of unrest.

MONDAY, SEPTEMBER 7, 2026



The Indian EXPRESS

JOURNALISM of COURAGE

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Happening today

● **THE SUPREME COURT** is scheduled to hear a plea seeking regulatory guidelines to control the ‘unpredictable fluctuations’ in airfares and ancillary charges imposed by private airlines in India.

● **J&K’S FIRST** international film festival begins in Srinagar. Over 130 films from 40 countries will be screened during the four-day event. Among the unique experiences will be a floating screen installed on Dal Lake for audiences seated on shikaras.

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Business as Usual

By EP UNNY



POLITICS

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BEFORE VIJAY’S TN ALLIANCE GETS A NAME, A CONGR LINE: RAHUL FOR PM

NATION

PAGE 6

CCTV IN INDIA TO PUNJAB BUST PART OF GROWING SPY TRAIL

ISRO responds to staff questions: Ecosystem expanding, pvt sector won’t shrink our role

Anonna Dutt
New Delhi, September 6

THE INDIAN Space Research Organisation (ISRO) on Sunday said that it will continue to remain India’s principal institution for advanced space research, and that the participation of the private sector is not about reducing its role.

This comes a day after *The Indian Express* reported that key employee associations of the space agency have written to its chairperson V Narayanan questioning the direction of the organisation’s privatisation drive and its implication for the existing workforce, and the

PM, LG, RAHUL EXPRESS GRIEF; CM SAYS NO ONE WILL BE SPARED

‘Hostel’ collapse near DU: Five dead, students feared trapped

7 of 10 pulled out of rubble critical; rescue ops on

Alok Singh, Drishti Jain, Sakshi Chand, Sophiya Mathew & Tabshir Shams
New Delhi, September 6

AT LEAST five people were killed after a five-storey building used as a private hostel for students collapsed in Satya Niketan opposite Sri Venkateswara College in Dhaula Kuan on Sunday afternoon, officials said.

Ten others were pulled out of the rubble and admitted to AIIMS Trauma Centre, police said. Seven of them were in critical condition. Past midnight, rescue teams were continuing to search for survivors at the site.

The building, which housed an establishment called Hostel Daze, was allegedly owned by a resident of Gurgaon named Hari Ram, police said. Hari Ram, along with his brothers Anand Bansal and Azad Bansal, owns several plots and buildings around the building that

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FULL COVERAGE

CRACKS, NO 2ND EXIT: LAPSES UNDER PROBE

‘SEEN HIM?’: SEARCH ON FOR LOVED ONES [PAGES 3, 4](#)

Rescue operations underway at the site of the incident in Satya Niketan, Sunday. ABHINAV SAHA

A 10-sec video, a scramble to save stranger: ‘He’s alive, get him out’

Drishti Jain & Pragynesh
New Delhi, September 6

DARKNESS ALL around, a shaking camera, debris pressing down.

On Sunday evening, at least seven people showed up at the site of the building collapse at Satya Niketan in South Delhi, drawn by a 10-second clip shot by a student trapped inside. All of them wanted to pull him out.

Among the first to reach the spot was Adi Nain, an NSUI

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

Bengal teen has narrow escape: No water supply, so went to friend’s house

Tabshir Shams
New Delhi, September 6

FIFTEEN MINUTES before the building turned to rubble, Sana Varash, a first-year BA student of Motilal Nehru College, was inside it.

The 18-year-old, from Falakata in Alipurduar district of West Bengal, was among the many students living in the building. He was sharing a “two-room set” on the third floor.



Sana Varash, a first-year BA student of Motilal Nehru College

Sitting on a footpath outside the AIIMS metro station, waiting

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



A student who was pulled out of the debris. PTI

EXPRESS special

Hospital in Nepal heals flood injured with a helping hand — from *Express* readers



DEVANSH MITTAL TASHI TOBGYAL

EXPRESS IN NEPAL

Rasuwa (Nepal), September 6

IN THE corridors of the light yellow-coloured building sit dozens of local residents, some waiting for their monthly vaccine, one waiting to get a knee injury looked at, another to get the dentist’s help with an aching tooth.

Welcome to Jibjibe Rural



The Jibjibe Rural Hospital in Nepal’s Rasuwa district was among the healthcare facilities that received critical medical equipment bought from donations to The Indian Express Citizens’ Relief Fund in the aftermath of the April 2015 earthquake. TASHI TOBGYAL

Hospital, situated on a hilltop in Rasuwa, a district in Nepal on the border with China that was among the hardest hit in

the devastating flash floods that swept through the region late last month.

This neighbourhood pri-

mary medical centre generally acts as the first pitstop for nearby residents with everyday

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

India, China Corps Commanders hold talks at LAC meeting point in Arunachal

Commander of Spear Corps meets China counterpart at Wacha-Damai

Amrita Nayak Dutta
New Delhi, September 6

INDIA AND China were conducting Corps Commander-level talks in Arunachal Pradesh Sunday amid reports of recent tensions in the Taksing area of the Upper Subansiri district.

Lt General Girish Kalita, commander of the Army’s III Corps, also called the Spear Corps, with its headquarters at Rangapahar near Dimapur in Nagaland, was meeting his Chinese counterpart and other officers.

The talks were being held at the Wacha-Damai border meeting point on the Indian side to address ongoing issues along the LAC in the area. Wacha is India’s easternmost border personnel meeting point, located in the Kibithoo sector in Arunachal Pradesh.

The *Indian Express* first reported on Saturday about the holding of Corps Commander-level talks following multiple meetings between local com-

E. EXPLAINED

First such meeting in recent months

This is the first senior military commander-level talks between India and China in recent months amid tensions along the LAC in Arunachal Pradesh. Tensions between Indian and Chinese troops along the LAC are typically resolved through meetings between the local commanders.

manders of the two sides in recent weeks to resolve issues. According to sources, Indian troops continue to remain deployed in large numbers in the area to prevent any escalation.

What makes the talks significant is that it is the first senior military commander-level talks between India and China in recent months amid tensions along the LAC in Arunachal Pradesh. These talks follow a meeting in Beijing on August 25 between National Security Advisor Ajit Doval and Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi who are the

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

IDEA EXCHANGE

‘Working together, combining resources, talent, scale, we think India and Canada can be world beaters’

CHRISTOPHER COOTER,
CANADIAN HIGH COMMISSIONER [P 12](#)



State consent not taken, put HC Chief Justice appointment on hold: Punjab Govt

Kanchan Vasdev & Apurva Vishwanath
Chandigarh, New Delhi, September 6

SAYING THAT the Centre appointed Justice Ashwani Kumar Mishra as the Chief Justice of the Punjab and Haryana High Court without awaiting the state government’s views as required under the Memorandum of Procedure (MoP) for appointment of High Court Judges, the Punjab Cabinet on Sunday passed a resolution demanding that his “appointment and administration of oath... be put on hold”.

The resolution was passed at an emergency meeting chaired by Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann, a day after the Centre notified the appointment. The state government said the appointment was “yet another instance” of the Centre “bypassing Punjab’s constitutional rights and established



Justice Ashwani Kumar Mishra

INSIDE

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NEXT ON COLLEGIUM AGENDA: FILLING VACANCIES IN SC

procedure.”

“This appointment has been made without obtaining the consent of the state government, thereby bypassing all Constitutional norms and set procedures,” it said in a statement. “The Cabinet resolved that the appointment and administration of oath should be put on hold until Punjab’s views are obtained

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

● SHE DIED AT 97 IN DUBLIN ON AUGUST 31

Indu Mitha’s love story carried Bharatanatyam across Partition, kept it alive in Pak

Suanshu Khurana
New Delhi, September 6

THE LIFE and times of Bharatanatyam exponent Indu Mitha, who passed away in Dublin at 97 last week after a brief illness, came with numerous twists and turns. The kind that seem as though lifted off a page-turner. Except that Indu’s story isn’t fiction.

In 1951, four years after the bloody Partition, a 22-year-old Indu, daughter of a Bengali-Christian philosophy professor, Gyanesh Chandra Chatterjee, whose family had moved to

Delhi from Lahore after Partition, decided to move to Karachi against her parents’ wishes and married a Pakistani army officer, Aboobaker Osman Mitha. The two had met at her uncle’s house party shortly after Partition. A few days later, he saw her again. “I took one look, and my heart turned over... I knew this was the girl I must marry,” wrote Mitha in his memoir years later.

Mitha’s family was as opposed to the match as Indu’s, on grounds of culture and religion, especially amid the divisive space that the Subcontinent

had become then. Indu’s older sister, Uma Chatterjee, was married to director Chetan Anand then, which was also not comforting for Mitha’s family, who considered a life around films hardly respectable.

But despite all odds, Indu crossed over and married Mitha, and the two had three daughters in the following years.

When Indu came to Karachi from Delhi, she brought an unlikely inheritance: Bharatanatyam, the dance form she had imbibed in Delhi and Chennai. Indu had studied philosophy at Delhi University while training



Indu moved back to Karachi in 1951 and married a Pakistani army officer, Aboobaker Osman Mitha. INSTAGRAM/ TEHREEMA MITHA

in Bharatanatyam under Lali-litha Shastry. Shastry was from the first batch of Kalakshetra and had learned under the aegis of Bharatanatyam icon Rukmini Devi Arundale.

Alongside, Indu also studied modern and creative dance with actor and dancer Zohra Sehgal and her husband, Kameshwar Sehgal, at their Zorsh Institute in Lahore while her family still lived there.

Mitha, from a wealthy Bombay family, had joined the British Indian Army in 1942 after graduating from the Indian Military Academy, Dehradun, and served with the Parachute

Regiment in Myanmar (Burma then) during the Second World War. After his family moved to Pakistan, Mitha was, in 1954, tasked with setting up the Special Service Group (SSG) of the Army, with help from US Special Forces. He is still known as the ‘Father of the SSG’.

But Bharatanatyam, the art form from Tamil Nadu, was not an obvious choice for a woman making a life in Pakistan, particularly when the country’s cultural ideas became only more conservative with time, mainly in the 1980s. But Indu persisted, and for the next seven decades taught generations of students

an art form whose cultural home was far away in the temples and courts of South India — first in Karachi, then in Lahore and later in Islamabad. She taught over 2,000 students. Some of her noted disciples include Amna Mawaz Khan, Ifikhar Masih and her daughter Tehreema, who now runs a dance academy in the US.

“To me, her greatest contribution was teaching young girls in schools in Lahore, who got exposure to Bharatanatyam and later teaching students at her academy, even though there were very few,” says noted

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2



CM Hemant Soren pays respect to the mortal remains of state Minister Sudivya Kumar at his residence in Giridih district, Sunday. PTI

Jharkhand minister Sudivya Kumar Sonu, key negotiator with student protesters, dies

Shubham Tigga
Ranchi, September 6

JHARKHAND HIGHER and Technical Education Minister Sudivya Kumar Sonu died of a heart attack in Giridih late on Saturday. He was 56.

Sonu, the Jharkhand Mukti Morcha (JMM) MLA from Giridih, experienced discomfort while sleeping at his residence and was rushed to a hospital by his family members. He died on the way to the hospital, sources told *The Indian Express*.

Sonu represented the Giridih Sadar Assembly constituency. He was elected to the Assembly for the first time in 2019 and retained the seat in 2024. He subsequently joined Chief Minister Hemant Soren's Cabinet. He held the portfolios of Urban Development and Housing, Tourism, Art, Culture, Sports and Youth Affairs, besides Higher and Technical Education.

In a post on X, Chief Minister Soren said Sonu was not merely a senior colleague or political associate but was "like an elder brother" who offered affection and guidance and stood firmly

by him during difficult times.

"It is extremely difficult for me to come to terms with this news. Sonu bhaiya's passing has left a void in my life that is impossible to express in words," Soren said. "The moments I spent with him and the lessons I learnt from him will always remain with me," he said.

Sonu had recently been involved in the state government's negotiations with students protesting alleged irregularities in recruitment examinations conducted by the Jharkhand Public Service Commission (JPSC) and Jharkhand Staff Selection Commission (JSSC). He was part of the ministerial panel that held multiple rounds of talks with protesting students in Ranchi in August.

The talks took place amid a prolonged student agitation demanding action over alleged irregularities in government recruitment examinations, including the 14th JPSC Combined Civil Services Examination. Sonu had said the government was consulting student groups and other stakeholders on reforms to the examination system.

No water

for news of his friends being treated at the Trauma Centre, Varash recalled that when he woke up around noon on Sunday, he found that there was no water supply. So he decided to walk to a friend's place nearby to freshen up.

"That decision saved his life. "Since morning, I could hear some sounds from the basement," he said. He recalled that he had even asked a friend, half in dread and half as a running joke he'd made for weeks, "building gir jayega kya (will the building collapse)?"

He said his friend brushed off his remarks with a laugh.

But Varash's fears were not unfounded. He said that while the rooms had been renovated recently, the building itself was old. He said the staircase that led to his third floor accommodation looked unplanned, and was narrow, dilapidated and damp. "I used to tell my friends that I'll

‘He’s alive, get him out’

leader from a university in Sonipat. "I got this video at 4.50 pm on my phone from a former DUSU (Delhi University Students Union) office-bearer who asked me to rush to the spot. We didn't know his name because my friend had first sent this video to another friend, who then forwarded it to another," he told rescuers at the site.

According to Nain, the person who shot the video is a second-year B.Com student in Delhi University's South Campus, a few kilometres from his PG.

Delhi Fire Service sources confirmed late Sunday night that the boy seen in the video was rescued and identified as Aditya, a student from Atma Ram Sanatan Dharma College. "He has been admitted to the hospital and is under observation. He is not in a critical condition," sources said.

The video had been sent to Nain by Abhi Dhaiya, a former DUSU vice-president. Dhaiya said his brother, Dishant, had sent him the video, saying that a friend had received a message from the trapped student asking for help.

"*Vo phasa hua hai abhi, zinda hai, please usko bahar nikaal lo* (He is stuck inside, he's alive, please get him out)," the message read. "But I couldn't figure out the exact location where he was stuck, so I forwarded it to the people on the ground," Dhaiya said.

Dishant told *The Indian Ex-*

press that he had received the video from the owner of an adjoining PG, who was asking for the student to be rescued. "By then, the video was widely circulated, and everyone was trying to identify him," he said.

It was not just that student in the video.

Within minutes of the collapse, WhatsApp groups of colleges and student unions were flooded with messages about those missing. Many students from nearby PGs began forming groups to search for people they knew — at the site, among the items pulled out from the debris was a red suitcase, a water bucket and chairs.

Piyush Sharma (18), a psychology student at Motilal Nehru College, said he was sleeping at his PG about 50 metres from the site when the building collapsed. "I had shifted recently from Jaipur. I used to walk past this building every day... At first, I did not believe it. There are many students in my class who are trapped inside the building," he said.

Sharma then opened his class group on his phone. A message read: "There is a boy... who was on a call with his friend around 1.30 pm. His voice suddenly stopped and we have not been able to confirm whether he is safe. He stays in one of the PGs in Satya Square. If anyone knows which PG he stays in or has any information about his whereabouts and safety, please let us know."

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM]

‘Hostel’ collapse near DU: Five dead, students feared trapped

collapsed, sources said.

An FIR under Sections 105, 290, and 125(a) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023 (BNS), relating to culpable homicide, negligence during construction or repair of buildings, and rash and risky act that endangers life respectively, has been registered against the alleged owner and others, DCP (South West) Amit Goel said.

None of the alleged accused had been apprehended till late on Sunday night. "Multiple teams have been formed to trace the alleged persons," Goel said.

According to police, the building offered paying guest (PG) accommodation to students and others.

"It is alleged that renovation work was being undertaken at the ground floor, which led to the collapse of the building," an officer said. The work, which allegedly included excavation of the basement, may have weakened the foundations of the building, sources said.

A PCR call was received at 1.34 pm about a building collapse near Nanakpura Gurdwara, DCP Goel said. At least eight fire tenders rushed to the spot and began relief and rescue operations, police said. A team of the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF) also joined the rescue.

The Satya Niketan area is popular with students studying in Delhi University's South Campus and in several undergraduate colleges in the area. Hundreds of students stay in rented rooms in private residential buildings that are used as hostels or PG accommodation.

Goel said some students may have been staying on rent in the building that collapsed. Sources in the police said around 30 students lived in the rooms in the private hostel.

Four people were brought dead to hospital, and the fifth succumbed to his injuries, Goel said. At least one of the dead was a student, sources said.

Late at night, sources in the Delhi Fire Services said among the deceased are two young men of ages 19 and 20 years, a 35-year-old man, and an elderly man of age around 75.

"The exact number of persons trapped under the rubble is not known at present," Goel said. Residents of the area were helping the authorities in the search and rescue operations.

Several vehicles parked near the building were damaged as large chunks of concrete fell on them.

In a statement posted on X, the Prime Minister's Office said the collapse of the building was distressing. "Condolences to those who lost their loved ones. Praying for the speedy recovery of the injured," Prime Minister Narendra Modi said.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, who went to the spot and then to AIIMS where the injured were admitted, told reporters: "Whoever is responsible for this, whether it is the building owner or an official, will not be spared."

The Chief Minister said the building was old, and some construction and renovation work had been underway. "Some kind of excavation was being carried out in the basement, due to which a pillar shifted and the building collapsed. The building was being used as PG, and children were inside. All agencies are continuously working. Our priority is to save the lives of these children first," she said.

Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu posted on X: "Deeply concerned to learn of the building collapse at Satya

Niketan, RK Puram... Praying for the safety and well-being of everyone affected."

Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi said the news of the building collapse was "extremely heartbreaking and alarming", and appealed to the NDRF, Delhi Fire Services and other rescuers to make every effort to reach those who were trapped and to ensure that the injured received immediate medical treatment.

He said Congress and National Students' Union of India (NSUI) workers were present at the site and ready to assist the rescue teams.

"Students' lives were already filled with struggles — now the situation has turned life-threatening. Due to the lack of good hostels in colleges or universities, students are forced to live in PG accommodations, 40-40 at a time under one roof, in inhumane conditions," Gandhi posted on X.

Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) leader Arvind Kejriwal said: "The incident of the building collapse... is extremely tragic and alarming... Due to the government's negligence in Delhi, many such accidents have already occurred. The government must wake up from its slumber."

Late in the evening, around 150-200 activists of the Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP), the students' organisation affiliated to the ruling BJP, attempted to enter the office of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) at the Civic Centre to protest against the building collapse.

The protesters raised slogans against MCD and demanded the resignation of the MCD Commissioner. Police detained around 15 of the protesters and took them to Kamla

Market police station.

Rescue operations were particularly difficult because heavy earth-moving machines could not be used freely when people were feared trapped under the rubble, sources said. The pressure and vibration from heavy equipment could shift the debris and endanger those who were trapped, they said.

Rescue teams are therefore proceeding cautiously, removing debris manually, piece by piece, while listening for people trapped underneath, the sources said.

Director of Delhi University's South Campus Prof Rajni Abbi told *The Indian Express* that some of the students trapped under the rubble had been calling, and even making video calls. However, she said she did not have details of the number of students who had contacted the university, or of the condition they were in.

Abbi said South Campus colleges such as Maitreyi College and Jesus and Mary College had been opened to accommodate PG students who had been asked to vacate their accommodation adjoining the collapsed building.

Power supply has been affected in parts of the neighbourhood. Certain adjoining women's student hostels had also been evacuated as a precautionary measure. Abbi said students were being provided support at the university's hostel and guest house facilities.

In a post on X, the University of Delhi said: "We are deeply pained and saddened... Our thoughts are with the students and families affected. We pray for the safe rescue of all those trapped and stand ready to support our students in every possible way."

A similar incident took place in Satya Niketan in 2022, in which two people were killed and several others were injured. The terrace of a three-storey house undergoing renovation had collapsed, trapping six workers.

since June 1, when he took over following the elevation of then Chief Justice Sheel Nagu to the Supreme Court.

The Punjab Cabinet said the appointment reflected a pattern of the Centre's "infringement of Punjab's constitutional rights".

In his post on X, Mann linked the issue to a series of other disputes between Punjab and the Centre.

"The Centre withholding our Rs 9,000 crore RDF (Rural Development Fund) funds and flood relief package, changing the BBMB (Bhakra Beas Management Board) rules, and now directly interfering in judicial appointments will not be tolerated. We demand that this appointment be immediately put on hold and that, in accordance with the constitutional process, the views of the State be accorded due respect. Inquilab Zindabad," he said.

The Cabinet also cited the case of Justice Gurmeet Singh Sandhawalia, a former Punjab and Haryana High Court Judge who was recommended by the Collegium in 2024 for appointment as Chief Justice of the Madhya Pradesh High Court. That proposal remained unnoticed for over two months in the absence of a recommendation

from the Madhya Pradesh government, after which Justice Sandhawalia was instead appointed Chief Justice of the Himachal Pradesh High Court.

The Punjab government said the contrast between the two cases had created a "feeling of perceived discrimination" in the way appointments involving Judges of the Punjab and Haryana High Court are handled.

As Acting CJ, a bench led by Justice Mishra had in August directed the Punjab government to clear pending instalments of dearness allowance and dearness relief owed to its employees and pensioners, observing that the state continued to spend on advertisements and other discretionary items even as it cited financial constraints to withhold the dues.

Meanwhile, the Punjab and Haryana High Court Bar Association has opposed the state government's stand. It said the move risked being seen as Executive overreach into a matter governed by the constitutional process for judicial appointments, cautioning that any impression of political pressure on the judiciary could erode public confidence in the justice system.

Punjab HC CJ

and duly considered," it said.

Justice Mishra, whose parent court is the Allahabad High Court, is expected to be sworn in on Monday.

"Today, the Punjab Cabinet unanimously passed an important resolution against the continued assault on Punjab's rights by the Central Government and the violation of constitutional norms. Appointing the new Chief Justice of the Punjab and Haryana High Court without obtaining the consent of the State Government is a direct violation of the prescribed procedures (Memorandum of Procedure) and constitutional norms," Mann said on X.

He later wrote to President Droupadi Murmu, Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Punjab Governor Gulab Chand Kataria, enclosing a copy of the resolution adopted by the Cabinet.

The SC Collegium had recommended the appointment of four Chief Justices of High Courts, including Justice Mishra's candidature, on August 6. On August 12, the Centre had

sought the views of the Chief Ministers and Governors of the four states.

While the MoP does not stipulate a time period, conventionally, it is learnt that the consent for appointment of a Chief Justice is dealt with immediately. For appointment of HC Judges, it takes four to six weeks for inputs from the Chief Minister. It is learnt that normally, the Secretary of the Department of Justice dials the Principal Secretary to the Chief Minister to facilitate the process. After a certain time period, the Law Ministry deems that there was no objection from the state government.

It is learnt that the Law Ministry had received inputs from Bihar, West Bengal and Maharashtra — the three other states concerned — immediately, but the delay by the Punjab Chief Minister held up the other appointments too. The appointments were notified on September 5.

Justice Mishra has been serving as Acting Chief Justice of the Punjab and Haryana High Court

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sical dancers and choreographers and the founder of the feminist cultural group Tehrik-e-Niswan, met Indu in 1984 after she returned from India after training at Delhi's Shriram Bharatiya Kala Kendra, where she learned Bharatanatyam under Leela Samson, Kathak under guru Ram Mohan and Odissi under guru Mayadhar Raut.

"I had just come back to Pakistan and was looking for other dancers in the country. Most dancers (like Siddiqui) had left by then. So, from Karachi, I went to see her in Lahore. I tried to understand how she managed. Indu ji didn't perform very much and mainly taught. Once I invited her to Karachi to act in a play and she did. When I went to India again in 1988 and came back with more training in Odissi, she was very interested in learning about it," says Kermani, now 75.

Indu also appeared in the documentary '*How She Moves*' (2020), which followed her and her students as she prepared for what was intended to be her final recital. Indu, however, later objected to the film, writing that the film represented the filmmaker's ideas, and not hers.

Mitha was awarded the Presidential Award for Pride of Performance in August 2020 for her exceptional contributions to classical dance and the arts.

Bharatanatyam

Pakistani classical dancer, actor and social activist Sheema Kermani, 75, who was also seen performing classical dance in Ali Sethi's popular Coke Studio song, *Pasoori*.

Against all odds

Indu began by teaching dance at Lahore Grammar School and later taught in cantonment houses, schools and academies; performed in drawing rooms and on stages; trained dancers who wanted to and could learn, including her daughter and choreographer Tehreema Mitha. Indu also formed an academy, Mazmoon-e-Shauq, later.

She also experimented with the form's musical and literary vocabulary, using North Indian instruments and music and setting Urdu poetry to Bharatanatyam, partly because she could not remember all the songs as she was not fluent in Tamil, Telugu and Sanskrit and could not find South Indian orchestras, and partly because she felt that the dance needed to speak to those around her. She translated some of what she remembered into Urdu. This was pioneering work. She was presenting Faiz through Bharatanatyam, rare even in India.

Then came the Zia-ul-Haq years, which were particularly difficult for the arts, especially dance. It was now incompatible with the State's attempt to define a new Islamic identity. But despite severe odds and many curbs, Indu refused to give up dance and continued to teach. She did so more privately then.

Her daughter's *arangeram* in 1986 at the Goethe Institute, as no one else would agree to give them space, took place during the Zia regime. With the organisers providing no help, Indu and Tehreema had to sweep the stage before the performance. Indu contributed to numerous choreographies of Tehreema, including one where a pregnant woman, deserted by her beloved, wants to have the baby.

"This woman's character is unlike the traditional woman in the classical Bharatanatyam repertoire, who either pines for her lover or portrays her heartbreak... the choreography breaks that mould of traditional Bharatanatyam repertoire and of the female character by raising this unconventional theme and by inherently questioning social mores," writes Indu's student Feriyal Aslam in her dissertation *Choreogra-*

Reforms should be seen as ecosystem expansion, not as privatisation: ISRO

stronger, and globally competitive Indian space ecosystem.

"Industry, start-ups and academia are being enabled to participate across the space value chain, complementing and multiplying ISRO's capabilities. The reforms should therefore be seen as ecosystem expansion and capability multiplication, not privatisation," the agency's statement said.

The space agency said it will focus on frontier technologies. "ISRO's role will progressively strengthen in areas where its scientific expertise matters most: frontier research and development, advanced technologies, human spaceflight, next-generation launch systems, deep-space and planetary missions and strategic national capabilities," it said.

"Meanwhile, mature and routinely manufactured systems can increasingly be scaled through industry. Production of mature launch vehicles, routine satellites and other established systems can increasingly be undertaken by industry or PSUs through appropriate competitive processes. This allows ISRO to devote more resources and

scientific manpower to the next generation of technologies and missions," the statement said.

The space agency said India's ambitions include establishing the Bharatiya Antariksh Station by 2035, undertaking an Indian crewed mission to the Moon by 2040, developing next-generation and reusable launch systems, pursuing sustained lunar and planetary exploration, and establishing India as a major global space power. "These are technologically demanding missions that require ISRO to remain focused on advanced research and capabilities that cannot simply be substituted by commercial activity."

It said India's space economy is currently estimated to be around \$8.4 billion, still a relatively small share of the rapidly expanding global space economy. India aims to increase its share of the global space market to \$44 billion by 2033.

"That scale cannot be achieved through government resources and ISRO's manpower alone. It requires private capital, industrial capacity, entrepreneurship and global market access," it said.

Hospital in Nepal helping flood injured thanks an old friend — the Express reader

ailments, vaccinations, routine checkups and minor injuries. But over the past week-and-a-half, it has become something more important — a beacon of hope for those injured in the floods.

Just as it was 11 years ago in the aftermath of the April 2015 earthquake, when readers of *The Indian Express* stepped up to offer a helping hand, responding to this newspaper's call — from schoolchildren dipping into their pocket money to companies mobilising a day's wages to retired Army personnel sharing their pension.

Their donations, constituting *The Indian Express* Citizens' Relief Fund, went towards the purchase of critical medical equipment worth Nepal Rs 1.2 crore for hospitals in the districts of Sindhupalchok, Rasuwa and Nuwakot. The equipment ranged from X-ray machines to infant radiant warmers, operation theatre tables to surgical equipment.

"On the day of the floods last month, we received 10 patients who were injured due to the flood. They were suffering from bone fractures, head injuries and collection of blood in lung cavities. We treated five of them here, while the remaining were referred to the district capital in Dhunche, from where the most serious ones were evacuated on a helicopter to Kathmandu," said Dr Nirajan Bhatta, Medical Superintendent, Jibjibe Rural Hospital.

While just 80-100 people used to visit the hospital daily before the floods struck, it now receives 100-130 patients every day.

Dr Bhatta says most of the incoming people now need psychosocial treatment for post-traumatic stress disorder. "Just yesterday, we got a patient who was complaining of severe pain and discomfort. However, when I checked her vitals, everything was normal. We found out that the patient's father had died in the floods and she had eaten very less in the days after it. This is a clear case of acute stress," he said.

The primary medical health centre currently has a minor OT, an X-ray machine, three emergency beds, two observation beds, an OPD room, a dental OPD, a delivery room and a lab. It is transitioning to a bigger hospital with 15 operating beds. "The building is almost complete and will be handed over by the contractor in a week," said Haikrishan Debkota, chairman of the management committee of the hospital.

"The donations by the *Express* helped the centre a lot. With surgery equipment and OT tables here in Jibjibe, people did not have to go to Dhunche or Kathmandu (over 90 km away) for every minor procedure," Debkota said.

India, China Corps Commanders hold talks in Arunachal

special representatives of the two countries for the boundary talks.

Moreover, Chinese President Xi Jinping is expected to attend the BRICS summit in New Delhi on September 12-13. Xi last visited India in October 2019 when he travelled to Mallapuram near Chennai for the second informal bilateral summit of leaders.

New Delhi and Beijing have been trying to restore ties that plummeted after the start of the military standoff along the LAC in eastern Ladakh in 2020.

India and China have held 23 rounds of Corps Commander-level meetings at the Chushul-Moldo border meeting point in eastern Ladakh to resolve issues related to the military standoff along the LAC.

The 23rd round of talks were held in October 2025, a year after both sides formally agreed on patrolling arrangements in the Depsang Plains and Demchok, the two friction points along the LAC.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and President Xi met on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit in Kazan, Russia, in October 2024, and their talks resulted in the disengagement of troops from the friction points.

India and China have differing perceptions of the LAC, which has historically caused issues between their troops on the ground.

On Saturday, former Chief of Defence Staff Lt Gen Anil Chauhan (retd) commented on the Corps Commander-level talks and the establishment of two additional military hotlines, describing these developments as positive.

He said the boundary issue remains unsettled, and differing perceptions of the boundary, infrastructure construction and force multipliers create "the possibility of friction and escalation".

This, he said, requires vigilance, credible capabilities, clear agreements and consistent adherence.

BUILDING COLLAPSE IN SOUTH-WEST DELHI

FIR filed against building owner, MCD says sealing drive to follow



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, Cabinet Minister Kapil Mishra, BJP MP Bansuri Swaraj and others at the site of the collapse in Satya Niketan on Sunday. ANI

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 6

THE DELHI Police has registered a case of culpable homicide and negligence against the owner of the private hostel in Delhi's Satya Niketan that collapsed on Sunday, leading to the death of at least five people, while the Delhi government has ordered a magisterial inquiry into the incident.

Earlier during the day, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta visited the site to take stock of the rescue operations, and later visited AIIMS Trauma Centre, where many of the injured are currently being treated.

Gupta ordered the magisterial inquiry into the incident following her visit to the site, also stating that she ordered an FIR against owner of the building.

"Those found responsible for this grave incident will be held fully accountable and

dealt with under the strictest provision of the law," a statement from the Chief Minister's Office, meanwhile, read.

The building, which housed an establishment called Hostel Daze, was owned by one Hari Om, a resident of Gurgaon, sources said.

Police said they have registered a case against Hari Ram under sections of the BNS pertaining culpable homicide not amounting to murder, negligence in repairing or constructing buildings, and acts endangering the lives and personal safety of others. He had not been arrested as of Sunday night.

"It is alleged that renovation work was underway on the ground floor, which led to the collapse of the building. Multiple teams have been formed to trace the people responsible for the incident," DCP (South-West) Amit Goel said.

Police sources, meanwhile, said they are looking into

claims that the building had been sealed earlier, and had only been operating as a private hostel following that. The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD), however, has denied having any record related to the sealing of the building.

A police source also said that it will be investigated if Hari Ram's brothers, Anand and Azad Bansal, were co-owners of the building.

The MCD, on the other hand, announced on Sunday that it will carry out a sealing drive in the area.

Reacting to the incident, Mayor Praveesh Wahi said: "The culprits will not be spared under any circumstances. All illegal constructions with more than four floors will be immediately sealed, and strict action will be taken against officials found guilty, leading to their immediate dismissal. These orders will be implemented with immediate effect."

ABVP holds stir, demands MCD commissioner's resignation; 15 detained

Mishal Mussaddique
New Delhi, September 6

HUNDREDS OF ABVP members allegedly attempted to storm into the Municipal Corporation of Delhi's (MCD's) main office on Sunday night, demanding the resignation of Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar over the collapse of the five-storey private hostel in south-west Delhi's Satya Niketan.

The incident has claimed at least five lives so far.

The protestors broke windows at the premises in a bid to enter the main Civic Centre building at Ajmeri Gate and clashed with police personnel. Around 15 of them were subsequently detained by the police on Sunday night, officers said.

The RSS-affiliated student body alleged that the civic body's negligence had led to the building collapse. According to security personnel present at the site, protesters broke locks of the gate around 7.30 pm to enter the premises. They were demanding Khirwar's resignation and threatened that they would not leave the premises till their demand was met.

Slogans of 'Ram, Ram', 'Shame, Shame' and 'MCD Commissioner down down' were also chanted.

"So many students are buried under the rubble, and it is a deeply heartbreaking incident. When such buildings exist in Delhi, it is the MCD's job to cross-check them. Why doesn't this administration do its job properly? Students have died in

Delhi earlier because of water-logging in such a building. People have also died because of fire. And today, it happened because of a building collapse. Is the MCD sleeping?" said Virendra Singh Solanki, national general secretary, ABVP.

In a statement, the outfit also demanded an audit into paying guest and rented accommodations in areas where students reside in large numbers. "We demand ... that accountability be fixed for negligent PG operators and concerned administrative officials. Additionally, an immediate safety and structural audit of all PGs and rented buildings operating in Delhi's student-dense areas must be conducted...", it said.

"Around 150-200 ABVP students had gathered at Civic Centre to protest against today's incident at Satya Niketan. The protesters entered the Civic Centre through Gate No. 5 and sat outside the main building, raising slogans and protesting against the functioning of the MCD. Subsequently, some protesters attempted to forcibly enter the main Civic Centre building, resulting in jostling with police personnel," said DCP Central Rohit Rajbir Singh.

"BJP's corruption in the MCD has once again been exposed. BJP is putting the lives of Delhi residents at risk to fill its own pockets. This is the third major incident in the MCD's South Zone, where BJP has its chairman," Leader of Opposition in the MCD House, Ankush Narang, said.

DU colleges open doors, offer help to stranded students

Satya Niketan houses several PGs for students of colleges in DU South Campus

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, September 6

EVER SINCE Arpit posted his phone number on social media on Sunday afternoon for students and parents looking for help after the building collapse in Delhi's Satya Niketan area, he was inundated with calls.

A student of Sri Venkateswara College in Delhi University's South Campus, he said distressed parents and relatives called him, looking for information about where their children were. "The site of the incident has been sealed off... so we are not being able to give the information they are looking for. Instead, we have shifted our focus to help students who have been stranded because of other PGs in the area being closed or vacated after the incident," he said.

Satya Niketan is a hub of PG accommodation for students who are enrolled in colleges in DU's South Campus. The building which collapsed on Sunday was one such PG accommodation called 'Hostel Daze'.

Soon after the incident, university and college officials, and student volunteers started getting distress calls from trapped students and parents.

In response, colleges such as Maitreyi College, Jesus and Mary College, Motilal Nehru College, Aryabhata College and Sri Venkateswara College offered to help the students asked to vacate their accommodations near the collapsed building.



At the site of the incident on Sunday. ABHINAV SAHA

The arrangements came as many living in the area faced uncertainty, with some buildings being vacated and power supply affected in parts of the neighbourhood. Certain adjoining women's student hostels were closed as a precautionary measure.

By Sunday evening, Arpit said, around 20 such affected students had arrived at the Sri Venkateswara College looking for help. "We have made arrangements, with mattresses, water, and food in the foyer and the old science block as temporary shelter for them. Most likely, many of the students will leave later to go to their families amid this uncertainty," he said.

Similarly, displaced students began arriving with their belongings at Maitreyi College by the evening.

Ananya Shukla, a BA student from the college who coordinated with these efforts, said the college was preparing to accommodate around 20 students. As of Sunday evening, she said that around 10 students had already arrived at the college.

"Some students had arranged hotels themselves, while in at least one case a student's PG had been sealed and she had been left without her belongings, not even her footwear. We have told such students to just report to college, and we will arrange everything here for them," she said.

A teacher at Motilal Nehru College, one of DU's largest colleges, said, "We have made arrangements for the displaced students in our college. Their accommodation as well as food arrangements have also been taken care of."

Saniya Verma, a Masters student at the Delhi School of Economics who lives in a PG near Satya Niketan, said there has been no electricity in her accommodation since a power cut about 10 minutes after the incident.

"There are students in our building who feel stuck because they cannot charge their phones. Most are planning to leave for their relatives," she said. She said that many students were at the PGs as it was Sunday. "I have been living here for the past three years and have always felt safe. I never imagined something like this could happen here. Nothing like this has happened before, and this is quite concerning," she added.

16 yrs, Rs 50 lakh lost: Supertech delays costing homebuyers lakhs

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, September 6

VINOD KUMAR'S daughter was a little girl when he booked their home in Greater Noida. She is 17 now, his son is in college — and Kumar, now 51, is still waiting for the flat.

He invested in Supertech's Eco Village 2 in 2012 and made his final payment in 2015. More than a decade later, he is living in Delhi and paying rent while servicing the loan for a home that remains unfinished.

"I cannot begin to express my pain," Kumar said. "We are living under so much stress that I've developed blood pressure and even start feeling dizzy sometimes."

The delay feels even more cruel because his tower is close to completion. "In my tower, possession for just two floors is pending. If we get it, at least my rent will be saved," he said. "Iss flat ne zindagi barbaad kardi hai (this flat has ruined my life)."

Kumar's story is not an isolated one. Across 16 stalled Supertech projects in Noida and Greater Noida, thousands of middle-class homebuyers have spent years waiting for construction to finish and fighting legal battles. Kumar said he even filed a case in the State Consumer Commission in 2017. "Then the Covid lockdown hit, and the case kept getting delayed. After that, the builders went into insolvency. We are struggling till date."

On August 25, the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT) took note of the sluggish pace of construction across these projects. It has now sought a comprehensive status report from NBCC, the state-owned project management consultant, which has been tasked with completing them.

During the hearing, the counsel representing the homebuyers expressed deep concern over ongoing deviations from the project implementation timeline established by the court-appointed committee and NBCC.

The petitioners represent societies like Sports Village, Ecovillage 1, 2, and 3, UP Country, and Czar Suites in Greater Noida, alongside Eco-city, Romano, Capetown, and North Eye in Noida.



(Clockwise from above) The incomplete Eco Village 1 project in Greater Noida; homebuyers BN Gupta and Vinod Kumar. GAJENDRA YADAV

ting possession has not ended the ordeal.

At Eco Village 1 in Greater Noida, an unfinished tower still stands at the entrance, a tower crane looming beside it. Residents and auto-rickshaws move along the paved roads, past the skeletal concrete structures.

It is here that B N Gupta booked a 2BHK flat in March 2010. He was supposed to get it in 2013, but construction did not begin initially and only picked up in 2017-18.

"This is how builders work these days: they take 90 percent of the money and finish only 50 percent of the work," he fumed.

Gupta said he spent seven years running from one court to another and found no relief. "This is my biggest pain — waiting for a house. Only I know how much mental stress I've faced. I was constantly depressed. It affects your job, your family life, everything."

Gupta finally received physical possession of his flat in 2021, but the official registry remains stalled. "It is a straight loss of Rs 50 lakh. I can't even sell it now to gain any money. I booked this home when I was young and wasted 16 years of my life on it. Imagine, you pay for a car today and get it in 10 years — how bad would that feel?"

His frustration is echoed by Mrityunjay Kumar Jha, 46, a buyer in Eco Village 3. The registry for his flat, which he purchased in 2016 and received possession a year later, is also stalled.

"We have to pay higher EMIs. We can neither transfer



the loan, nor are we getting even half the property's value if we try to sell the house," Jha said.

In the courts

Around 30,000 homebuyers are awaiting possession across 16 major stalled projects, according to the Enforcement Directorate which is probing a Rs 700-crore money laundering case against Supertech promoter Ram Kishore Arora.

The ED, whose case is based on 26 FIRs registered by the Economic Offences Wing (EOW) alongside Delhi, Haryana, and UP Police, claimed the company siphoned off hundreds of crores to four entities.

In December 2024, the NCLAT directed NBCC to complete 16 of Supertech's 30 stalled projects, an undertaking covering nearly 50,000 homes.

The Supreme Court later upheld this order, further directing the NCLAT to expedite its decision regarding the remaining 14 projects and determine if they should be placed under a court-monitored framework to finally ensure completion.

• Skywatch

Forecast: September 7, 2026

Generally cloudy sky. Light to moderate rain.

MAX: 33-35

0.9°C above normal

MIN: 23-25

0.6°C below normal

• Sunrise: 6:03 AM (September 8)

• Sunset: 6:36 PM (September 7)

• Moonrise: 2:45 AM (September 8)

• Moonset: 4:05 PM (September 7)

• AQI Tracker

Narela Satisfactory AQI: 72

Ashok Vihar Good AQI: 49

Najafgarh Good AQI: 23

Chandni Chowk Satisfactory AQI: 95

● Good (0-50)

● Satisfactory (51-100)

● Moderate (101-200)

● Poor (201-300)

● Very Poor (301-400)

● Severe (401-500)

Influencer Bharadwaj sent to judicial custody over attack during CJP protest

New Delhi: Swatantra Bharadwaj, a self-styled influencer who purportedly admitted to attacking the father of a student protester at Jantar Mantar in Delhi in July during the protest by the CJP against paper leak issue, was sent to one day of judicial custody by a Delhi court on Sunday. This comes a day after he was arrested and sent to one day of police custody.

"(The) accused was produced before the Magistrate at

her residence on a holiday which is routine. The Magistrate Court did not have jurisdiction to decide the plea for judicial custody. Prosecution sought 14 days judicial custody which will be decided tomorrow by Sessions Judge...until then 1 day Judicial Custody was ordered. Fresh Medical Report has come. Several sections

under SC/ST Act have been invoked in ongoing FIR," said advocate Rishav Ranjan who appeared for the complainant.

Bhardwaj was picked up by Crime Branch officers from his house in Bulandshahr on Friday and brought to Delhi after securing a transit remand. He was produced at the residence of a judge around 2 pm Saturday.

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Crumbling building had cracks

Tenants paid Rs 14-18K; lens on likely violations

Residents said that this is 4th such incident in area in 15 years

Alok Singh, Drishti Jain
New Delhi, September 6

CONSTRUCTION OF additional floors, ongoing repair work in the basement and on the ground floor carried out allegedly without permission, inadequate safety checks, including no emergency exit: these are among the safety lapses that are under scrutiny following the collapse of the five-storey building that housed a PG accommodation, located in the heart of South-west Delhi's Satya Niketan, on Sunday, sources told *The Indian Express*.

In the resettlement colony, which comprises 299 houses, residents claim that this is the fourth such incident in roughly 15 years. The last major incident was reported in 2022, which claimed two lives.

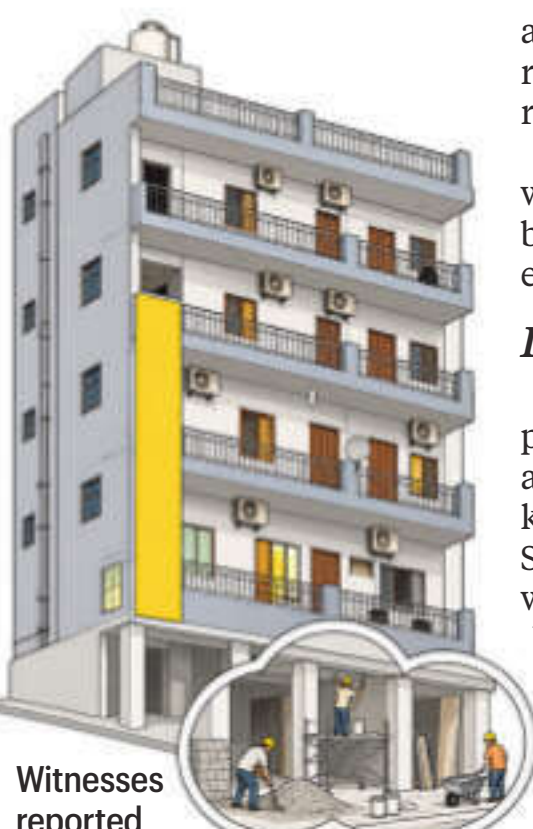
The building, which was constructed in the late 1990s and is spread over 55 square yards, was gradually turned into a paying guest (PG) accommodation. Police officers are also investigating if the operation of the PG facility was in compliance with the rules, said sources.

Even as locals have said that cracks were visible in the building before it crumbled, the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has said that no official complaint was ever recorded against it. The building, marked by the MCD as P-14, comprised a basement, and four floors above the ground floor.

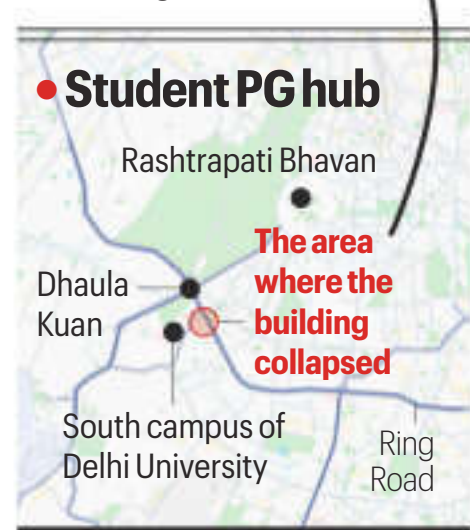
Multiple PG rooms

According to the locals, two additional floors were added to the building around two years ago. The police investigation is expected to establish when and how these floors were constructed and whether the necessary permissions were taken.

A resident told *The Indian Express* that the entire area is a



Witnesses reported ground floor work, potentially weakening the structure.



resettlement colony that was once a JJ colony zone and under a green belt. It was later named Satya Niketan. "As it became the hub of South Campus, with five Delhi University colleges located nearby, many residents converted [their properties] into multi-storey buildings to rent them out to students," he said.

Each floor in the building reportedly had four rooms. The rooms were being rented out on a bed-by-bed basis, with rents varying depending on the floor.

A room on the ground floor was reportedly being rented at Rs 18,000 per bed, while the rent on the third floor was around Rs 16,000. On the fourth floor. The rent was

around Rs 14,000 per bed. The rooms on the second floor were reportedly not rented out.

Residents also said there was no second exit from the building to allow exit in case of emergency.

Lease under scanner

The property was reportedly being operated as a PG after being leased to an entity known as 'Hostel Daze'. Sources said that the building was owned by three Gurgaon-based brothers— Hari Ram Bansal, Anand Bansal and Azad Bansal. It was leased to Hostel Daze last year and was being used as accommodation.

The exact nature of the lease arrangements, the permissions for running PG accommodation and whether the building met the required safety norms are likely to form part of the investigation, sources said.

Repairs despite cracks and dampness Locals said repair work had been taking place for about a week before the collapse. The building was reportedly suffering from dampness, cracks and water accumulation.

"This has raised a key question: if visible structural or water-related problems existed, was a structural assessment conducted before repair work began?" a police officer said.

The police officer said during the probe it will also be examined whether the repair work itself had any bearing on the collapse and whether any load-bearing elements were altered during the work.

The incident has also brought renewed attention to the safety of old buildings and PG accommodation in Satya Niketan, an area where a large number of students live in rented accommodation, and whether these are being systematically inspected for structural and fire-safety risks.



Waiting

Students who live in the PG accommodations near the building which collapsed in Satya Niketan on Sunday wait near the site of the incident as rescue operations continued overnight. GAJENDRA YADAV



Rescue operations started soon after the building collapsed on Sunday afternoon; (right) locals and students also helped. AFSHANA ALI, ABHINAV SAHA



'Can't find him': Frantic search ensues for loved ones

Tabshir Shams
New Delhi, September 6

HOLDING HER mobile phone, a teary-eyed Puja Yadav, 20, asked the same question from hospital staff and police officers at the AIIMS Trauma Centre in Delhi on Sunday as she showed them her brother's photograph: "Have you seen Pawan Yadav?"

A student at Delhi University's Motilal Nehru College, Pawan, 21, was inside the five-storey building in Satya Niketan that collapsed earlier in the day, killing at least three people. The area is a hub of PG accommodations where many students enrolled in DU's South Campus live.

Her frantic search, however, did not yield any relief. "They are saying he is not here," Puja said, crying. She had spoken to Pawan the previous night. "His phone was unreachable after



Several injured were rushed to AIIMS Trauma Centre; (right) Pawan's photograph on sister's phone.



the incident. His roommate's phone was unreachable too," she said. Her friend Mohit consoled her. "We came from the site... they told us Pawan was taken to a hospital. We checked in at Safdarjung Hospital and

Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital, but they said he is not here," he said.

Outside the Trauma Centre, several families gathered within hours of the building collapse—parents, siblings and friends—

staring at their phones and scanning every ambulance as it arrived with the injured from the collapse site. Only one attendant was allowed to go inside the trauma center at one time. Every time the ambulance siren

blared, heads turned. Every stretcher that came out drew a small crowd, hoping, and dreading, in equal measures to recognise a familiar face. At least nine patients were brought to the AIIMS Trauma Centre, hospital officials said.

Umanshi Lamba, a DU student leader, standing with Puja, said she saw students pulling more than 10 people from the rubble at the site of the incident. "The most important thing right now is that the information about patients is shared quickly so that their parents and relatives can be informed," Lamba said. "Most of these students were living alone, away from their home in Uttar Pradesh, Jammu, and Rajasthan," she added.

Not too far, Anil Sharma, 20, was going through the same ordeal, looking for his friend Sukalp, 20, also a student at Motilal

Nehru College. He approached a police officer, standing outside the Trauma Centre, who scanned the register and told him Sukalp's name wasn't on it. "At Satya Niketan, they said he has been brought here. We spoke to him in the morning... We had planned to meet for lunch in the afternoon. He was very excited," Anil said, his voice getting heavy. Some families were fortunate to find their loved ones. Neeraj Bawa, a BA student at Motilal Nehru College (Evening), was among those being treated. He had come to Delhi from Jammu.

His elder brother set out from Jammu with two cousins after hearing about the collapse. "We haven't been given much information. Just that he is severely injured in the pelvic area and hips, and the doctors are treating him," said Ravinder, Neeraj's friend.

First responders recall moments after building crumbled

Alok Singh & Drishti Jain
New Delhi, September 6

BARELY A few minutes after the rescue operations started in South West Delhi's Satya Niketan where a building collapsed on Sunday, students living in nearby paying guest (PG) accommodations and others formed a human chain. Bricks, stone slabs, broken chairs, pillows and mattresses were cleared after being pulled out of the debris so students, who were trapped, could be spotted and rescued faster.

Deepak Kumar (21) was at a fast food outlet when, he said, he heard a loud sound.

"I was in the washroom. My owner rushed out. There was a cloud of dust and nothing was visible. People quickly shut their shops. We ran and pulled out the owners of two shops that were in front of the building (that collapsed). One ran a paan stall, the other sold electrical goods. We also removed some vehicles. There was an old man whose leg was stuck. He was screaming for help. We pulled him, but we could hear people crying and shouting from inside... the mud made their rescue difficult," he said.

Abhishek Mishra, a law student at DU who used to live in the building two years ago, was among the first responders. Mishra, who now lives in a rented accommodation nearby, rushed to the spot with his roommate.

"The locality has narrow lanes, and getting cranes inside was not easy. During the first hour following the collapse,

those who came forward to help were mostly residents of the area," he said.

Mishra said they also asked residents to move their vehicles parked around the building to make way for the rescue teams. "We removed the rubble with our own hands. The local police also arrived soon after being informed, but the cranes took some time to reach the spot," he said. Later, teams of Delhi Fire Services (DFS) and the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF) arrived. Over six cranes were also pressed into service.

Another resident of the area said he heard a loud sound too, adding that he initially thought a transformer had probably exploded. However, when he stepped out, he found dust had covered the entire lane.

To search for survivors beneath the debris, the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF) used life detectors and trained search dogs. Officials said that once "signs of life were detected", rescuers used diamond chain saws, hydraulic jacks, combi cutters and plasma cutters to carefully clear the rubble and create access routes.

While two NDRF teams comprising 70 officials reached the spot soon after they were alerted about the incident and began the rescue operations, two additional teams were kept on standby.

The biggest challenge, officials said, was locating survivors trapped beneath the debris. They added that inputs from residents of the area, however, helped rescuers.

REGULATORY FRAMEWORK NECESSARY TO PREVENT SUCH INCIDENTS, SAY EXPERTS

How Satya Niketan grew into a hub for DU students

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, September 6

SQUEEZED into a pocket between the Ring Road, San Martin Marg and Nanakpura, Satya Niketan sits directly beside Delhi University's South Campus. Developed by the Delhi Development Authority in 1968 under the Jhuggi Jhopri Removal Scheme, residential plots were laid out at up to around 40 square metres. Nearly six decades on, many of those plots are barely recognisable, having been redeveloped or adapted into PG accommo-

dations and private hostels catering to the thousands of students drawn to the colleges nearby.

The transformation pre-dates the hostel boom. When DU established its South Campus in 1973, and subsequently shifted it to its present location near Dhaura Kuan in the 1980s, Satya Niketan found itself next to a growing concentration of colleges.

Its small residential plots acquired a new value as students began looking for accommodation close to campus.

That demand has been rein-

forced by the limited availability of university hostel accommodation. DU's 2024-25 annual report records over 2.45 lakh regular students, while its financial estimates list 18 university-run hostels. The university has itself noted that hostel accommodation is limited and that a hostel seat cannot be guaranteed to every applicant.

With hostel places available only to a fraction of the university's large regular student population, students have traditionally looked beyond campus for accommodation.

It is not just the housing

that has changed. Milk booths, homeopathy clinics and public libraries sit alongside coaching centres, printing and photocopy shops, eateries and other businesses catering to the colleges across the road.

AK Jain, architect and town planner who served as Commissioner (Planning) of DDA, said, "The colony began as a resettlement area in the 1960s, but it was regularised much later in the 1980s. There were conditions attached to regularisation, including approval of layouts and building plans in accordance with the applicable

bye-laws but (mixed land use say... etc)," Jain said. "This is no different to what happened in Hauz Rani a few months back. It's [unsafe buildings] not new to Delhi. In 2006, the Tejendra Khanna Committee report had warned that nearly 80 % of Delhi's buildings were illegal, violated development norms without approved plans, or were residential properties being illegally misused for commercial activity," Jain said.

Architect and urban planner Prof P.S.N. Rao, Dean of the School of Planning and Architecture, said, "Whether a

PG is licensed or unlicensed, there has to be transparency about what is permitted and what basic standards have to be met. There needs to be a clear regulatory framework, with enforceable requirements relating to occupancy, ventilation, windows, electricity, water supply and other basic services," Rao said.

Suptendu Biswas, an architect and urban-designer said, "If the foundation was exposed or compromised during repair work, it could seriously affect the structural stability of the building."

DISCUSSIONS ON SEPTEMBER 9 AIMS TO FORMALISE COALITION

Rahul for PM: Cong draws red line before Vijay’s ruling alliance meet

Arun Janardhanan
Chennai, September 6

TAMIL NADU Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay’s TVK has called its post-poll partners to a September 9 meeting to discuss formalising their alliance, as Congress confronts another proposition from within the ruling party: projecting the new CM as a probable prime ministerial face in future.

TVK government is three months old. But remarks promoting Vijay for the country’s highest political office have prompted Tamil Nadu Congress Committee chief Manickam Tagore to repeatedly assert his party’s choice for the 2029 LS elections: Rahul Gandhi.

“The Tamil Nadu Congress Committee is very clear. Our candidate is Rahul Gandhi. There is no doubt about that,” Tagore said while confirming that Congress would attend the September 9 meeting.

AICC general secretary (organisation) K C Venugopal on Sunday echoed Tagore’s views. “Nobody should create any such

confusion. Rahul Gandhi will be the face of the INDIA alliance (in 2029)... The INDIA alliance is moving forward. There are some issues in a few states where they are competing against each other. Otherwise, it is the INDIA alliance itself that is moving forward. That is the truth,” Venugopal said.

Meanwhile, the meeting of the ruling coalition called by the TVK will follow the conclusion of Assembly’s Budget session. It will be the second meeting of the parties supporting the Vijay government, after their discussions in Kovalam on July 1.

The first meeting envisaged a coordination committee, a common minimum programme and a name for the new alliance formation.

Tagore said the alliance’s name is to be decided and announced at the forthcoming meeting. “As far as we are concerned, the aim is to give this alliance a name and take it forward to a good position,” he said. The formation, he added, must be based on secularism and social justice and arrive at a common position on Tamil Nadu’s issues.



Tamil Nadu’s TVK government, led by Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, is just 3 months old. PTI FILE

Asked about Vijay being projected as a prime ministerial candidate, Tagore sought to close the subject. “This is a story that is over, all right? There is no need to keep bringing this up again and again,” he said. “As far as we are concerned, Vijay should be Tamil Nadu’s CM.”

Tagore said Vijay has just begun carrying out the responsibilities entrusted to him by voters. He accused sections of the media of seeking to create divisions within the secular alliances. “In Tamil Nadu, we will take this forward clearly under

Vijay’s leadership,” he said, while maintaining that Rahul Gandhi would lead nationally.

His earlier response to similar questions had been sharper. Asked about a minister’s description of Vijay as “Today’s CM, tomorrow’s PM,” Tagore said: “They are all in fan mode. Well, you cannot change people who are in fan mode.”

He also drew a distinction between the state arrangement and the national Opposition bloc. “Once TVK has MPs, we will ask TVK to join the INDIA alliance,” he said. “We cannot keep saying, ‘Come, come,’ to those who do not have MPs.”

In those earlier remarks, Tagore reminded the TVK ministers of the Congress’s role in enabling Vijay to form his government. He said Vijay had first called Gandhi to seek support. “Congress’s support came first, enabling all of them to become ministers,” he said.

Nevertheless, he left Vijay room to respond later: “Vijay will make the right decision at the right time. He always speaks very little. I think he will

speak when it is time to speak.”

TVK ministers have meanwhile begun inviting the parties supporting the government. N. Anand, Aadhav Arjuna, Nirmal Kumar and Rajmohan met the leaders of the CPI(M), CPI and MDMK. The two Left parties stayed away from the July meeting, saying they supported the government from outside and were not alliance members.

CPI secretary M. Veerapandian said internal consultations would determine the party’s response to the invitation. He reiterated it would not join the Cabinet. MDMK leader Vaiko confirmed his participation.

The outreach also brought an apology over official circulars concerning Left party members and student protests. Nirmal Kumar said officials had issued them without the government’s knowledge and assured the Left leaders that such incidents would not recur. The July meeting was attended by leaders of Congress, IUML, MDMK and Viduthala Chiruthaigal Katchi, alongside Vijay. A formal alliance was not announced then.

Aiming for drug-free India by 2029, Shah outlines roadmap based on four pillars

Pavneet Singh Chadha
Panaji, September 6

TERMING DRUG menace the country’s biggest national fight after eradicating Naxalism, Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Sunday unveiled a three-year roadmap and a vision document for narcotics control, with an aim to achieve a drug-free India by 2029.

At a press conference in Goa, Shah said. “We have created a roadmap to achieve the milestone of making India drug-free by 2029. Narcotics trafficking is a crime that destroys future generations and is used to fund terrorism. Narco-terror modules have come up in several countries and the whole world is plagued by this issue.”

Shah said since 2019, the government has taken several measures to combat narcotics trafficking, through which networks have been dismantled



Union Home Minister Amit Shah and Goa Chief Minister Pramod Sawant in Panaji on Sunday. ANI

and financial chains have been broken. He said prior to 2014, when Congress government was in power, action against narcotics was done in “bits and pieces” and in “silos”, and limited to small seizures.

“In 2019, we made it a priority issue for national security. A four-tier NCORD (Narco Coordination Centre) mechanism was created and we integrated local police with national strategy by forming dedicated anti-nar-

cotics task forces in all states and UTs. We transformed seizure-centric action into network-centric enforcement — reaching the kingpins, associates, distributors, and suppliers through bottom-to-top and top-to-bottom investigations,” he said.

Shah said that after “ending Naxalism”, the fight against drugs is the country’s biggest national fight. “We will make 2026-29 a mission-mode period. With every goal, there

will be a timeline, a ministry responsible, measurable outcomes, quarterly reviews and result-based accountability. The strategy will have three outcomes — supply reduction, demand reduction and harm reduction,” he said.

Shah said a four-pillar roadmap vision document has been prepared. These pillars include intelligence and operation-based enforcement, precursor and synthetic drugs control, demand and harm reduction, and capacity building and coordination. He said there has been an unprecedented increase in drugs seized since 2014. From 2004 to 2014, 26 lakh kg of narcotics and psychotropic substances were seized, while from 2014 to 2026 (until July), it was over 1.19 crore kg.

Shah then headed to Chimbel near Panaji to inaugurate BJP’s new Goa headquarters. The event was curtailed due to the Delhi building collapse, said Goa CM Pramod Sawant.



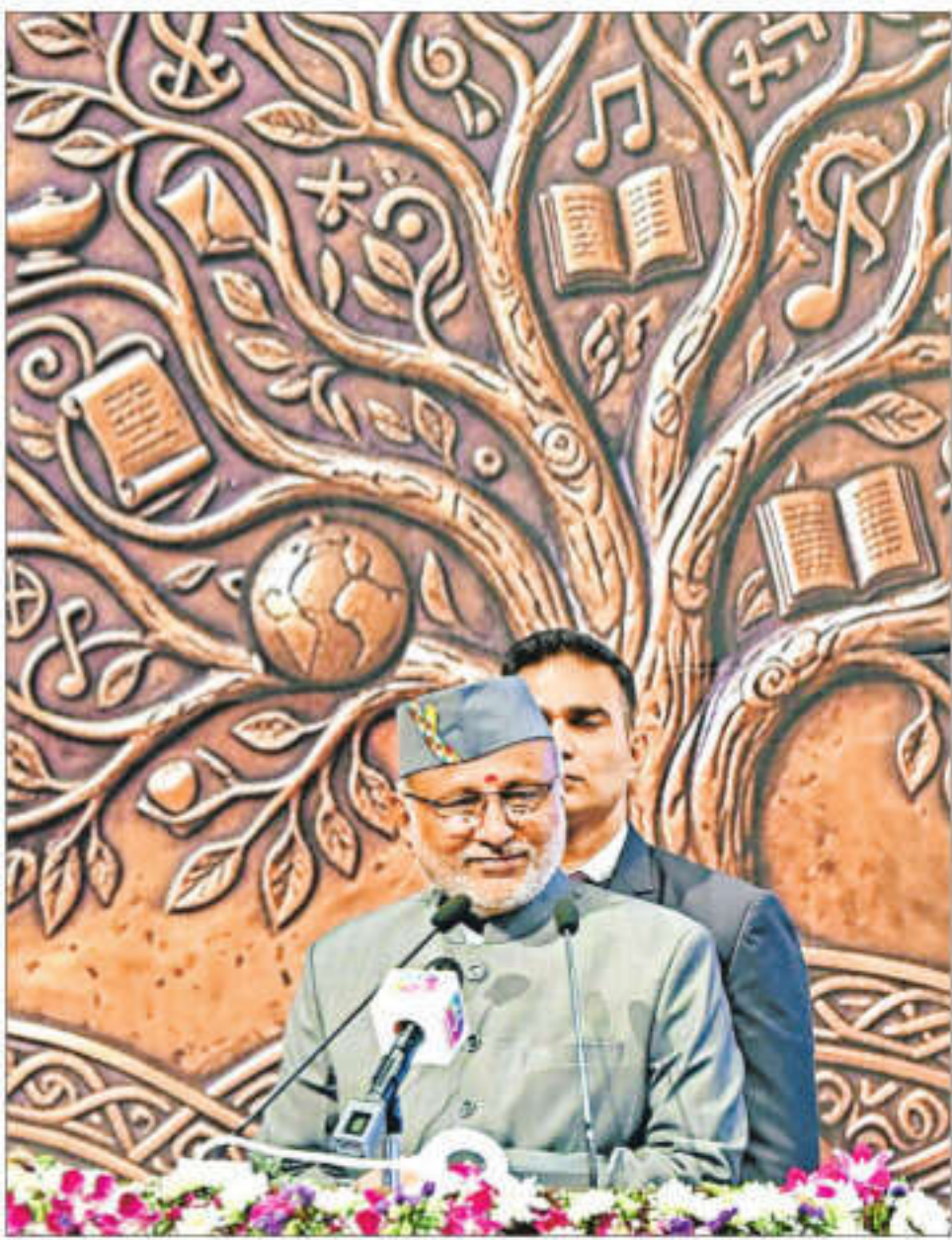
Gen-7 Deadline

RSS CHIEF Mohan Bhagwat appears to have set a generational deadline for the Sangh’s project of “organising Hindu society”. Speaking at an outreach event in London, Bhagwat was asked about a “piece of wisdom” from the RSS’s 100 years. His answer: “It should not take long to complete our work.” Bhagwat said he was the third generation in the RSS, while two more generations were already working in the organisation — making five generations in all. “Before the seventh generation, organising the Hindu society should be complete,” he said, defining it as “consolidating the benevolent power of society” and creating the necessary atmosphere. He also pointed to the Sangh’s growing acceptance, including among its political opponents. They “know the usefulness of swamyamsevak”, he said, and therefore do not hesitate to call on them or cooperate with the RSS on “some crucial matters”. The task now, he said, was to change people’s behaviour and the atmosphere within families.

‘Respect Timeline’

IN LATE July, the Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) in the NCR and adjoining areas amended a key direction, relaxing timelines for installation or retrofitting of air pollution control devices to meet a new set of pollution standards for select sectors. This was done ostensibly because of financial strain faced by industries in light of the prevailing geopolitical churn. However, it is learnt that industry associations have also been told in subsequent meetings that co-operation is not a one-way street and that compliance timelines ought to be respected, given the relaxations already provided to use less clean fuels in light of the West Asia crisis.

Assam’s MMR now below national avg: V-P



Vice President C P Radhakrishnan in Guwahati on Sunday. PTI

BJP knows better how to make others’ dhan its own: SP chief

Press Trust of India
Auraiya, September 6

SP CHIEF Akhilesh Yadav on Sunday called BJP’s UP in-charge Vinod Tawde “pagal” (mad) in response to his dig at the opposition party’s PDA slogan, which he referred to as ‘paraya dhan apna’.

Reacting to Tawde’s “dhan” remark, Yadav said that BJP knows better how to grab someone else’s “dhan” and make it

its own. This came a day after Tawde said the BJP would challenge the SP’s PDA formula, which stands for ‘pichhda, Dalit, and alpasankhyak’.

“The in-charge has come, which is a good thing. P stands for in-charge (prabhari), and P also stands for pagal,” Yadav said in Bidhuna. “They not only know how to make someone else’s wealth their own, but they also know how to make party money their own. Who

‘We work for Hindu interests’: Outfit behind ‘purification’ ritual registered in 2026 has 7 members, 11 active workers

Vidheesha Kuntamalla
Dehradun, September 6

AN EX-VHP functionary, a former BPO employee, a young B.Com graduate — these are some of the office-bearers of the Shri Ram Sena Dharmarth Seva Nyas, the Haldwani outfit at the centre of the controversy over a “shuddhikaran” (purification) ritual performed at the town’s Ramliila Maidan after Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge’s rally there last month.

Formally registered only in early 2026, the Nyas is described by its office-bearers as a “voluntary” organisation. Secretary Ramjee Awasthi puts its numbers at about 7 registered members and office-bearers, 11 active workers and around 45 volunteers, and says the Nyas depends for its finances on contributions by members and donations.

The organisation denies links to any political party, and among its chief activities, lists running a ‘cow ambulance’ and funding the education of around five to ten students every year.

The Indian Express tracked down five of the seven office-bearers of the Nyas. The outfit refused to share details of the other two, saying they did not wish to speak with the media.

Ramjee Awasthi, 42, used to be the VHP’s district ‘Seva PramuKh’ in 2018-19. An MBA graduate who had a stint working in marketing in Delhi, he says he now runs his own business in Haldwani. “I worked in the VHP for a few years before joining the Nyas. We work for the benefit of people and are not associated with any organisation or political party,” Awasthi told *The Indian Express*.

Grish Pandey, the Nyas president, is also 42 and a “businessman”. A native of Haldwani, he says he holds a Bachelor’s in Computer Applications degree and worked in Delhi in the BPO sector for some years. The idea of setting up the Shri Ram Sena Dharmarth Seva Nyas came to him during Covid, Pandey says, “out of concern for animals, the environment and social issues”. But, the overriding principle is: “Whatever we do, we will work for Hindu interests.”

On political affiliations, Pan-



Grish Pandey (extreme left) at an event organised by the Nyas along with spiritual leader Gita Manishi.

dey says: “Whom do I vote for... that is my right to keep it a secret. I owe no direct responsibility to any party or organisation.”

According to Pandey, “We did not even know what caste Khargeji belongs to”. “The organisation does not ask people their caste and we have members from different sections. I myself swept and mopped the ground (where the rally was held) on August 9 and all members later sat together... Our only aim was to clean the area. Amit, the complainant against Rahul Gandhi, also participated in the (purification) ritual.”

Amit Kumar, a member of the Nyas who belongs to the Dalit Valmiki community, has filed an FIR against LoP Rahul Gandhi over his criticism of the “shuddhikaran”. *The Indian Express* reached out to Kumar but received no response.

On August 29, Gandhi said the “purification” was an act of untouchability and demanded action under the SC/ST Act.

Another prominent face of the Nyas is Lata Pant, 45, its spokesperson. A Kumaun University graduate currently pursuing a Master’s in Social Work, Pant has been tutoring children in nearby villages.

Pant says the idea of the Nyas had been discussed for a long time, “among people who knew each other locally through social work and gatherings”. “We have nothing to do with any party or organisation,” she says.

Narendra Negi, 43, the Nyas’s treasurer, says he holds a degree in Bachelors of Computer Applications and, till 2021, worked in the human resources section of

a firm in Chandigarh. “After I returned to my hometown Haldwani, I started my own business in the sector of Human Resources,” Negi says, adding that he balances his Nyas responsibilities with his work. The outfit grew out of an informal network of people already helping others in small ways, he adds. “Grish ji and I were together in college. The other members are also from Haldwani and we know each other. We came together to start the Nyas to help people,” Negi says.

Denying any personal or organisational links to BJP, VHP or RSS, he says: “Till today, if I speak, it is for myself.” The Nyas is the first organisation he has ever been part of, he adds.

The youngest among the office-bearers is Vijay Fartiyal, 25, originally from Almora but now based in Haldwani. He and his cousins run the family’s mobile shop. A.B.Com graduate, Fartiyal says he joined the Nyas five-six months ago after meeting Pandey. The focus on Shuddhikaran was misplaced, says Fartiyal, talking about other activities of the Nyas such as “subsidising or providing wedding essentials like plates and glasses, organising communal festival meals, running an ambulance service, and a plan to help children prepare for competitive exams”.

He also denies links to any political party, and says the Nyas gets its funds “through society”.

On August 31, Congress filed a police complaint against Pandey and 15 unidentified others. Police are yet to take note of this complaint. Haldwani Congress MLA Sumit Hridayesh told *The Indian Express*: “Congress complaint to the police is not accepted, but an FIR against Rahul Gandhi is conveniently filed.”

Police refused to speak about the FIR filed against Gandhi, or the Congress demand for action against the Nyas. A senior Uttarakhand police officer told *The Indian Express*: “We are in the initial stage of investigation into the FIR registered against Gandhi. Different Congress members have given complaints in different formats... We are examining them from a legal standpoint.” **FULL REPORT ON**

WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Police summon former TMC leader over scuffle at party’s Kolkata office

Tanusree Bose
Kolkata, September 6

KOLKATA POLICE issued summons to MLA and former TMC leader Humayun Kabir on Sunday over the scuffle that broke out when police took down an allegedly illegal billboard at the party’s Camac Street office last month.

This was the third time the police had visited his home at Kasba to serve him the notice. His staff collected the summons for appearance on September 8. The MLA has informed the police he will appear for questioning on the afternoon of September 7.

Kabir, whom TMC suspended last year, said, “They (the KMC officials) had come there to destroy the billboard. There was a signboard. Now someone has complained about it, though there are 500 such signboards around that area. There should have been an inquiry by KMC in which someone from TMC would have appeared. They should have sent a notice giving us time to remove the board. That was not given.”

Denying allegations that the police were heckled, Kabir said, “Police tried to force their way in. They had come with a gas cutter to remove the billboard.” FIRs were filed against TMC MPs Derek O’Brien and Abhishek Banerjee, and other leaders over the August 27 incident. O’Brien and Banerjee’s PA, Sumit Roy, were summoned second time.

From CCTV in India to handlers across border: Punjab’s latest bust part of growing spy trail

Man Aman Singh Chhina
Chandigarh, September 6

FROM SOLAR-POWERED cameras to those with SIM cards, the Punjab Police has busted its fifth case in six months of internet-based CCTV cameras outside shops and commercial establishments along key roads being turned into spy devices by operatives linked to Pakistan’s ISI for tracking military and security movement.

In latest bust, 22 of 23 identified accused have been arrested, and 11 cameras with equipment, including solar plates, SIM cards, mobile phones, a router and an adapter, have been seized, according to DGP Gaurav Yadav. A senior officer of police’s counter-intelligence wing said “eight FIRs have been registered across various districts, including Kapurthala, Amritsar (Rural and State Special Operations Cell), Bathinda, Pathankot, Barnala and Ludhiana, under Sections 3, 4, 5 and 9 of the Official Secrets Act, 1923, along with applicable sections of the BNS”.

Punjab Police is now examining the technical trail, including SIM cards and device IDs, to identify the complete network of handlers and local facilitators, the officer said.

Police say the latest crack-down follows a pattern seen across states: cross-border espionage using cheap solar-powered, SIM/4G internet cameras placed near military routes, cantonments or railway stations, with live feeds sent to handlers abroad. The first such major case was busted in Ghaziabad in March, when police and a state STF arrested members of a module accused of installing solar-powered, SIM-enabled cameras at the Delhi Cantt and Sonipat railway stations, filming military sites, and sharing photos, videos and GPS data with handlers.

The case prompted the MHA to order a nationwide CCTV audit. “These CCTV cameras are off-grid with solar power plus 4G/SIM, so no wiring is used and they are harder to spot. The placement is usually on poles, shop fronts or highway points covering Army/ paramilitary movement. Local installers are often paid a few tens of thousands of rupees by Pakistani handlers across the border,” the

senior officer said.

In April, Delhi Police Special Cell said 11 men from Punjab and Delhi were arrested, and nine solar-powered CCTV’s were recovered from sites linked to troop and logistics movement across Kapurthala, Jalandhar, Pathankot, Patiala and Moga in Punjab; Ambala in Haryana; Kathua in J&K; and Bikaner and Alwar in Rajasthan.

Police at the time said the cameras had been streaming for about three months through mobile apps and a Chinese cloud platform, and linked the module to Pakistan-based handlers and Babbar Khalsa International.

In April, counter intelligence and Kapurthala Police, along with a central agency, said they had cracked two modules using China-made solar/SIM cameras to livestream military sites. Three persons were arrested, and cameras, a solar plate with 4G connectivity, phones linked to foreign handlers, and a Wi-Fi set were recovered. Police alleged a handler known as “Fauji” paid the accused about Rs 35,000 for one installation.

In May, another person was arrested for installing a CCTV at a shop in Pathankot-Jammu stretch of NH-44, allegedly to watch Army and paramilitary convoys. Police said he got about Rs 40,000 and directions from a Dubai-based contact, with the feed going to Pakistan-based handlers. FIR named three others. Between June and July, a solar-powered SIM camera on an electricity pole was found on the Bathinda-Malout/ Bathinda-Sriganganagar road, near the city’s military station, after a road-accident inquiry at Thermal police station. Police said it had run for nearly three months and sent footage to contacts in Pakistan and Canada.

Last month, another such operation was busted on the Ludhiana-Ferozepur Road, about 6 km from Baddowal Cantonment, after which police arrested a man who had rented a shoe shop nearby as an alleged front. Police said Chinese CCTV’s were installed outside the shop facing the road, and that the accused, Rachhpal Singh from Gurdaspur, shared user IDs and passwords with Pakistan-based handlers. He allegedly received Rs 3 lakh in instalments, police said.

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER

Gujarat Energy Limited (Erstwhile Gujarat Gas Limited), desires to invite bids against Tender(s) under two bid system through e-tendering portal from eligible and interested parties for the following categories:

Tender ID	Tender Description	Link for accessing the Tender Documents
338934	Rate Contract For Supply of Various Types of Pressure Gauge Across GEL	
339425	Rate Contract For Supply of Various Types of Differential Pressure Gauges Across GEL	• geltender.nprocure.com
340319	Supply and installation of File Compactor System/ Mobile storage systems at Amritsar Office	• https://www.gujarat-energy.com/ggl-current-tender/
336373	Hiring of Agency for Development, Implementation and Support of Mobile and Web-Based application on Safety Permit to Work (PTW) System with dashboards	

Any revision, clarifications, corrigenda, addenda, notifications etc. related to this notice will be updated on the above referred websites only. Interested parties should regularly visit websites to keep themselves updated.

IIFL HOME FINANCE LIMITED
IIFL House, Sun Infotech Park, Road No. 16V, Plot No. B-23, MIDC Thane Industrial Area, Wagale Estate, Thane – 400604, Maharashtra CIN: U65993MH2006PLC166475

By virtue of this notice, the general public and customers of IIFL Home Finance Limited are hereby informed that the IIFL Home Loan branch at 3rd Floor, Pari Palaza, Radhika Vihar, Mathura, Uttar Pradesh -281004 will be closed w.e.f. **December 9, 2026.**

All the customers and general public are requested to take note of the above and visit iiflhomeloans.com/locate-us to find other IIFL Home Loan branches near you.

Gor: US, India very close to finalising trade deal

US envoy says Modi, Trump likely to hold bilateral on the sidelines of G20 Summit

Divya A
New Delhi, September 6

US AMBASSADOR to India Sergio Gor has said Prime Minister Narendra Modi would be at the top of President Donald Trump’s list of leaders to meet at the upcoming G20 Summit, while also hinting at a possible bilateral on the event’s sidelines.

Gor also indicated that the Quad Leaders’ Summit would be held during the time of the Summit, even as he maintained that such an event is not “set” yet. His remarks came during an interview with India Today.

“If you asked the President, ‘You have 35 people coming. Who do you want to see?’, Prime Minister [Narendra Modi] would be at the top of that list,” Gor said when asked about the G20 meet, to be held in Florida in December. “Because the President considers the Prime Minister a friend, I anticipate that there will be more to that visit than just a group meeting,” Gor added, hinting at a Modi-Trump bilateral on sidelines of the Summit.

The ambassador also said that the two sides are “very close” to finalising the trade deal, and that Trump is expected to visit India next year. “The trade deal is being reworked after the Supreme Court’s unfortunate decision, but we are very close,” the ambassador said, adding that he hoped the agreement would be finalised within the next few months.

“People ask me, ‘It has been a year’, but the European Union has been negotiating for more than 20 years and it is still not done. We are way ahead of a lot of other partners,” the close aide of Trump said.

Gor also praised PM Modi for bringing stability to India, saying it had made the country an attractive partner for the United States. “India doing well is a great thing for us. We want a stable India. We want to work



US Ambassador to India Sergio Gor

with a stable India,” he said.

The ambassador said India should “get used to” more frequent visits by senior US officials as Washington seeks a closer relationship with New Delhi. Secretary of State Marco Rubio returns to India in October, months after his four-day visit in May this year for the Quad Foreign Ministers’ Meeting.

“This is very rare, that the Secretary of State would come twice in such a short time. My message was very clear: get used to it,” Gor said.

The ambassador also high-

lighted that External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar could be travelling to the United States three times over the next four months, including for the United Nations and the G20 meets.

Emphasising that Quad remained central to cooperation among its partners — India, the US, Japan and Australia — Gor said, “Any time the four leaders are at a place, Quad meeting will be held.” Prime Ministers of Japan and Australia are also likely to visit Florida for the G20 Summit being hosted by the US.

The next Quad ministerial meeting will be held in Sydney in October, with Rubio expected to attend, Gor said, adding that the four countries were also working towards a leaders’ summit, possibly later this year.

Interactions between New Delhi and Washington were in abeyance of late as relations strained between the two sides, especially after Trump’s claims of mediation in India-Pakistan ceasefire and his decision to impose heavy tariffs on India. The two countries are currently firming up a bilateral trade deal.

At London event, Bhagwat says uniformity not necessary for unity

Deeptiman Tiwary
New Delhi, September 6

RSS CHIEF Mohan Bhagwat, addressing a largely Indian diaspora audience in London, said the idea of “Hindu Rashtra” was not based on religion, worship or lifestyle but acceptance of diversity, arguing that “uniformity is not necessary for unity”.

Bhagwat’s London engagement is part of the RSS’s centenary-year global outreach, with the Sangh seeking to deepen its engagement with the world and give the “right” perspective about its organisation and work. Bhagwat earlier held similar events in New York and Toronto.

Explaining the Sangh’s understanding of Hindu Rashtra and Hindutva during the question-and-answer session, Bhagwat said: “The word Hindu cannot be understood on the basis of any religious practice or lifestyle. It is nature. The nature to respect and accept all diversities.”

“All kinds of thoughts came from Bharat, including atheism,” he said. “All say everyone’s path is true. We will all reach the same goal. We need not convert each other. Only we



RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat visits Khalsa Jatha British Isles Gurdwara in London. PTI

are right? No? We are also right. You are also right. That attitude is Hindu.”

Bhagwat drew a distinction between “nation” and “rashtra”, saying the former referred to a nation-state where people come together on the basis of similarities such as language, religion or a model of governance, with a state enforcing common rules. Rashtra, he said, was defined first by a common purpose.

“The purpose of the Hindu Rashtra is to give this to the world — diversity is natural and unity is truth,” he said.

He said India had remained a “rashtra” despite being invaded and enslaved. “People with one purpose is ‘rashtra’,” he said. If the country progressed along these lines, he said, “never will a dictator be created, nor will wars take place”.

Asked what inspired him about the current generation, Bhagwat said he was “more confident about future generations”, which, he said, had an urge to

make the world a better place and were willing to shed “petty differences” for that purpose.

He said the younger generation should be given a purpose and the necessary knowledge “without imposing” a method on them. “Set the goal, not the method,” he said, arguing that young people would find ways of achieving it “quicker than others”.

On how British Hindus should act if British and Indian interests diverge, Bhagwat said there would be no conflict if “British Hindus are pucca Hindus”. But if such a conflict arose, he acknowledged, British Hindus would naturally side with Britain. “Hindutva never asks you to betray your ‘karmabhoomi’,” he said.

Asked about the essence of Hindu unity, Bhagwat said the focus should be on commonalities rather than differences. “Give stress to what unites us rather than what divides us,” he said.

Govt sells 4,000 tonnes of onion from buffer stock

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, September 6

THE GOVERNMENT has sold about 4,000 tonnes of onion from its buffer stock of 1.21 lakh tonnes in the first ten days of a subsidised sale in select cities to curb skyrocketing prices.

“Approximately 4,000 tonnes of buffer onion have been sold so far in 17 cities,” Consumer Affairs Secretary Nidhi Khare said on Sunday.

The Centre’s agencies, the National Cooperative Consumers’ Federation (NCCF) and the National Agricultural Cooperative Marketing Federation of India (NAFED), are transporting

the stored onions in bulk from producing states to consuming centres, either by a dedicated rail rake christened ‘Kanda Express’ or by trucks, as part of the retail intervention. Bulk consignments have reached Delhi and Chennai via the Kanda Express, and a third rake is now being loaded for dispatch to Guwahati in the coming days, she added.

Onions are being sold at a subsidised rate of Rs 35 per kg.

“The distribution of buffer onions has brought some relief to consumers. Prices have fallen slightly,” Khare said, adding that the quality of the buffer stock was comparable to those of private traders were selling.

Next on Collegium agenda: Filling up vacancies in Supreme Court

With 8 appointments notified by the Centre, all 25 HCs now have regular CJs

Apurva Vishwanath
New Delhi, September 6

ALL 25 High Courts across the country now have a regular Chief Justice after eight appointments were notified by the Centre on Saturday, on the seven recommendations made by the Supreme Court Collegium on August 6 and August 31. The eighth, for Chhattisgarh, followed separately after its sitting Chief Justice retired on September 4.

Law Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal announced the appointments on X. Justice Valluri Kameswar Rao of the Delhi HC will head Patna, Justice Ravindra V Ghuge of Bombay moves to Calcutta, Justice Sanjay Kumar Agrawal of Chhattisgarh goes to Rajasthan, and Justice Mahesh Chandra Tripathi of Allahabad takes over Bombay. Justice Ashwani Kumar Mishra was confirmed as the regular Chief Justice of his own Punjab and Haryana HC, while Justices Krushna Ram Mohapatra, Alpesh Yeshvant Kogle and Pushpendra Singh Bhati take charge of Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh, and Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh, respectively.

With all positions of HC Chief Justices filled, it is learnt, the Collegium’s spotlight now shifts to the four vacancies in the top court. These vacancies trace back to the Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment Ordinance, 2026, which raised the court’s sanctioned strength in May.

Currently, the SC has 34 judges — four short of its sanctioned strength — even after five elevations in June. A fifth seat will fall vacant when Justice Satish Chandra Sharma retires on November 29. Justice Surya Kant, who took over as CJ on November 24 last year, retires on February 9, 2027. These will be the last recommendations the CJ Kant-led Collegium can make.

Sources told *The Indian Express* that gender representation

is expected to weigh on the Collegium’s choice. Among sitting HC Chief Justices, Justices Sunita Agarwal, Lisa Gill, and Revati Mohite Dere, the current Chief Justices of the Gujarat, Andhra Pradesh and Meghalaya HCs, are the only women judges. Justice Agarwal, the senior of the three judges, is originally from the Allahabad HC and is due to retire in April 2028. Justice Dere, who is from the Bombay HC, retires in April 2027. Justice Gill, who is from the Punjab and Haryana HC, retires in November 2028. The SC currently has only one woman judge, Justice Nagarathna, who is part of the five-member Collegium.

Another key issue for consideration is recommending a candidate who can add to the potential line of succession to the office of the CJ. Under the seniority convention that has governed the office for decades, the succession is mapped through Justices Vikram Nath, B V Nagarathna — in line to become India’s first woman CJ — PS Narasimha, J B Pardiwala, K V Viswanathan, Joyimala Bagchi and Vipul Pancholi, taking the office till May 2033.

Almost every CJ in the last decade has recommended at least one candidate who is a potential CJ, except for former CJs S A Bobde and U U Lalit.

As CJ, Justice Ranjan Gogoi recommended CJ Kant; CJ N V Ramana recommended Justices Nath, Nagarathna, Narasimha; and as CJ, Justice B R Gavai recommended Justice Pancholi. To join that line, those elevated now would join the SC at the bottom of the seniority list. Essentially, they would be junior even to the five judges sworn in on June 2 and would still have to be sitting on the bench after Justice Pancholi’s tenure ends in May 2033 to have a shot at the office. Of the sitting HC Chief Justices, only three clear that bar: Justices Pushpendra Singh Bhati, Alpesh Yeshvant Kogle and Ashwani Kumar Mishra — all three appointed last week.

MEA: UN’s world map must depict India’s official map accurately

Shubhajt Roy
New Delhi, September 6

HAVING VOTED in favour of the world map with equal-area projections, India said Sunday that the United Nations-initiated proposed world map must depict the Union Territories of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh in accordance with the country’s official map, and any “inaccurate” or “misleading” representation will be unacceptable.

New Delhi’s statement came two days after it voted in favour of a UN General Assembly resolution aimed at correcting the world map to promote a more accurate representation of continental landmasses.

The resolution titled ‘Correct the Map: Rebalancing Global Cartographic Representation and Promoting Equitable Representation of the World’s Regions, Particularly Africa’ was adopted on September 4.

The resolution, sponsored by Togo, received 164 votes in favour, with abstentions from Estonia, Georgia, Lithuania, Moldova, Serbia and Ukraine, and a lone vote against from the United States.

The Ministry of External Affairs official spokesperson

Randhir Jaiswal said India highlighted that the resolution does not constitute the endorsement of any specific map, projection, or depiction of national boundaries.

“India voted in favour of the resolution and also made an explanation of the vote stressing on the underlying principle of promoting equal-area cartographic representation,” he said.

“India’s sovereign territory, including the Union Territories of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh, must be depicted in accordance with India’s official map. Any inaccurate or misleading depiction is unacceptable,” he said.

“Our position on India’s sovereignty and territorial integrity is clear, consistent and non-negotiable,” he noted.

Jaiswal said the purpose of the UN resolution is “to encourage the use of equal-area map projections that preserve the relative sizes of continental landmasses”.

“The resolution neither adopts nor authenticates any particular world map, nor does it address political cartography, including international boundaries, disputed territories or place names,” he said.

Pvt bus operators threaten indefinite strike in Keralam

Press Trust of India
Palakkad, September 6

PRIVATE BUS operators in Keralam on Sunday threatened to launch an indefinite strike over the financial impact of the state-owned KSRTC’s Priyadarshini scheme, saying the recommendations of an expert committee appointed to address their con-

cerns are inadequate.

T Gopinathan, general secretary of the All Kerala Bus Operators Association (AKBOA), said, “The recommendations in the expert committee report are inadequate for private bus owners to sustain their business. We see no recommendations from the commission regarding our demand.”

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDERING					
The Executive Engineer JSV Division Sujapur invites following tenders on behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh from approved eligible contractors for the following work(s) through e-tendering Process:-					
S. No	Name of work.	Estimated Cost.	Earnest Money.	Cost of Tender	Time
1	Relocation & Reconstruction of various Water Supply, Sewerage & Lift Irrigation Schemes on the Left Bank of River Beas, Submergence due to Construction of Dhaulasidh H.E.P. by S.J.V./N.L. in Tehsil Sujapur Distt. Hamirpur (H.P.) (SH)- Construction of 1 No. RCC, framed open well Intake Structure, Construction of 1 No. Clear Water Tank of 5,50,000 liter capacity with 3.00 meter staging height , Construction of 1 No. Pump House cum Attendant Room at LWSS Sujapur Town Old, Construction of 1 No. RCC, framed open well Intake Structure, Construction of 1 No. Pump House cum Attendant Room, Construction of Water Treatment Plant (WTP) of 0.65 MLD capacity, Providing, Fixing, Testing & Commissioning of UV (Ultra Violet) plant with automatic cleaning wiper for 20.88 m3/hour capacity, Providing, laying , jointing & testing of various dia Rising mains. Supply & Erection of Centrifugal and Submersible pumping machinery with allied accessories at LWSS New Karot and Old Karot, Construction of 1 No. RCC, framed open well Intake Structure, Providing laying , jointing and testing of various dia Rising mains & Supply & Erection of Submersible Pumping Machinery with allied accessories at LIS Bhaleth, Construction of RCC Underground Collection Tank of 50,000 Liter capacity, Construction of 1 No. Pump	14,36,11,627/-	15,11,116/-	20000/-	12 Months

Last date of filing/ uploading the tender through e- tendering 15.09.2026 up to 11.00 AM The tender forms and other detailed conditions can be obtained from the website www.hptenders.gov.in.

No. 3170/HP

Executive Engineer, JS Division Sujapur

NOTICE
For Ordinary Members.
('A' Class Shareholders)

Notice is hereby given that all the Ordinary Members ('A' Class Shareholders) of Lokmanya Multipurpose Co-operative Society Ltd. registered till 31st March 2026, that the 32nd Annual General Body Meeting of the Society for the financial year 2025-26 will be held on Wednesday 23rd September 2026 at 5.00 p.m. at Sarthi Headquarters, City Survey Number 173, Senapati Bapat Road, Shivajinagar, Pune, Maharashtra 411004. All Ordinary Members ('A' Class Shareholders) admitted as members of the Society till 31/03/2026 are requested to attend the same.

PLEASE NOTE:
a) A link to download the Annual Report for the FY. 2025-26 has been uploaded on the website of the Society. www.lokmanyasociety.org
The Ordinary Members ('A' Class Shareholders) registered till 31st March 2026 can download the same from the website for their perusal.
b) Any member who intends to seek any clarification on any matter mentioned in the Agenda, at the AGM, shall send a query in writing, so as to reach the CEO at the registered office of the Society at least 3 days prior to the AGM.

For Lokmanya Multipurpose Co-operative Society Ltd.,
Sd/-
Kiran D. Thakur
(Chairman)
Date : 05.09.2026 | Place : Pune

Ganga swells in Patna, areas downstream on alert; 22 lakh hit by floods in Bihar

Press Trust of India
Patna, September 6

MORE THAN 22 lakh people in 12 districts of Bihar have been affected by a deluge as rivers overflowed following heavy rain in the state and neighbouring Jharkhand, with authorities sounding an alert as the water level in the Ganga crossed the highest flood level in Patna on Sunday.

The East Central Railway cancelled and diverted some trains because of the high water level at a bridge that connects Punpun and Parsa Bazar stations on the Patna-Gaya section.

A total of 190 community kitchens were being operated in various districts for flood-affected people, while 1,429 boats have been pressed into service to take marooned people to safety, officials said. Besides, 27 teams of the State Disaster Response Force and 10 from the National Disaster Response Force have been deployed in various districts.

In Patna's Gandhi Ghat, the Ganga was flowing at 50.57 metres at 6 am on Sunday, which is 0.05 metres above its previous highest flood level (HFL) of 50.52 metres, recorded on August 21. In Pandarak, the river was flowing at 43.92 metres at 6 am, which is 0.19 metres above its previous HFL of 43.73 metres on August 16.

Several rivers such as the Gandak was flowing above the danger mark at Dumariaghat and Hajipur, the Kosi at Baltara and Kursela, the Budhi Gandak at Khagaria, the Ganga at Hathidah, Bhagalpur, Kahalgaon, Buxar and Munger, the Punpun at Sripalpur, the Bagmati at Benibad and the Ghaghra at Darauli, officials said.

AIIMS-Jammu likely to be first hospital to get CISF cover

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, September 6

THE AIIMS in Jammu could become the first hospital in the country to be guarded by an armed contingent of the CISF given its "sensitive" location close to the India-Pakistan border, officials said.

The 226.84-acre hospital and medical college is located in the Vijaypur area of Jammu and Kashmir's Samba district, along the Srinagar-Jammu National Highway-44.

The campus is located a few kilometres from the India-Pakistan International Border (IB). The hospital was inaugurated by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in February 2024.

Sources in the security establishment told PTI that given the "sensitive" nature of its location near the IB, the Centre has planned to provide an armed security cover to the facility. They said security survey and a manpower-estimation exercise are underway.

12 die after consuming illicit liquor in MP, 3 excise officials suspended

Anand Mohan J
Bhopal, September 6

AT LEAST 12 people died and many more were hospitalised after allegedly consuming illicit liquor in Baraj village of Madhya Pradesh's Sagar district late Saturday night, prompting the district administration to order a magisterial inquiry.

Three officials of the excise department were suspended on Sunday while the Deputy Excise Commissioner was attached to the department's headquarters, pending a comprehensive investigation.

The probe so far into the case has pointed to spurious country liquor, allegedly supplied by a gang based in Lalitpur, Uttar Pradesh, according to Sagar Superintendent of Police (SP) Anurag Sujaniya.

"Early this morning (Sunday), around 4.30 am, information was received from the Banda police station area that people were arriving at the hospital in critical condition. Upon reaching the scene, it was observed that all the patients were suffering from poisoning by methyl alcohol. They specifically belonged to the villages of Nauraj and Gogra," Sujaniya said.

The SP said the substance involved in the deaths was initially identified as country liquor and that the police investigation had led them towards a Lalitpur-based gang with a history of legal action for al-



Police at a hospital as part of their investigation into the deaths, in Sagar district, on Sunday. PTI

edly manufacturing and circulating spurious liquor.

"Based on our initial investigation, the substance involved is country liquor. Preliminary findings point to a Lalitpur-based gang, which has faced legal action in the past. It manufactures spurious liquor mimicking Madhya Pradesh brands and distributes it here. It is highly likely that the supply originated from that source," he said.

Investigators are now looking into the supply chain to establish where the liquor came from, who sold it and where it entered the local market. About 10 people have been detained for questioning as police attempt to identify the source of the supply and those involved in its distribution.

The SP said the investigation would also examine whether there were administrative lapses that allowed the illicit liquor to reach the affected villages. "While both the Excise Department and the Police share the responsibility for taking action against illicit liquor, the fact remains that this incident has occurred; therefore, we will investigate where the shortcomings lie," he said.

The administration has, meanwhile, begun disciplinary action against officials of the Excise Department. Deputy Chief Minister Jagdish Devda said the latest official information put the death toll at approximately 11 to 12 and confirmed that three officials had been suspended. The Deputy Excise Commissioner has been

attached to the department's headquarters pending a comprehensive investigation.

The action followed preliminary findings suggesting negligence on the part of Excise Department officials. The government has also directed authorities to specifically investigate the role of the liquor licensee concerned and take strict action under the law if they are found responsible.

"Till now, 8 to 10 deaths have come to my notice," Sagar Chief Medical and Health Officer Dr Devesh Pateria said earlier in the day as medical teams were deployed across three villages identified as hotspots in the suspected illicit-liquor poisoning.

The health department has stationed teams of doctors and

nurses in the affected villages, where they have been conducting door-to-door screening and identifying people who may have fallen ill after consuming liquor. Patients requiring treatment are being stabilised locally before being referred to higher centres, Pateria said.

"We have three teams continuously deployed in the three villages that have emerged as hotspots. Doctors and nurses are going from house to house to identify anyone who is ill, and patients are being referred directly from there whenever required," he said.

The response intensified after patients began arriving at the casualty ward in Sagar. Pateria said one patient reached the hospital gasping at around 7 pm on Saturday. Doctors attempted to revive him but were unsuccessful.

"Looking at the symptoms, it could be methyl alcohol poisoning. We cannot say that with certainty at this stage, though," Pateria said.

About 25 patients have so far been referred to higher medical centres, he said.

CM Mohan Yadav directed officials to take prompt and stringent action following the deaths. "I have instructed the minister in charge and the officials to act promptly, take the strictest possible action and conduct a thorough investigation. Our government will absolutely not tolerate such incidents," Yadav said.

BRIEFLY



Security personnel at the site of the collision in Sambhal on Sunday. PTI

UTTAR PRADESH

Truck collides with tempo in Sambhal; six killed, several injured

SIX PEOPLE, including two children, were killed and several others injured after a truck collided with a tempo in Sambhal district on Sunday, police said. The accident took place near the Bamnetta village on the Moradabad-Agra National Highway. The deceased, all of whom were travelling in the tempo, were identified as Ruvaidd (30), Sarvadhya (four months), Dhruv (6), tempo driver Saudaon Singh (40) and Rohni (20), the police said. Another person, identified as Rampal, succumbed to injuries later, Circle Officer (Bahjoi) Stuti Singh said. Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath expressed condolences to the bereaved families. PTI

TVK functionary hacked to death in Chennai; 5 held

A FUNCTIONARY of the ruling TVK was hacked to death by an armed gang in Besant Nagar here, police said on Sunday, with the murder drawing criticism from the Opposition over the state's law and order situation. Police have arrested at least five persons in connection with the murder so far, officials said. The deceased, identified as Kannan, was a resident of Vannanthurai and ran a car rental business catering to IT firms. He was a history-sheeter with a criminal record and was under regular surveillance, police said. PTI

Six killed in house collapse incidents in UP

AMAN, along with three of his minor daughters, was killed, while another daughter of his was seriously injured after their house collapsed amid rain in a village in Kanpur on Sunday, police said. In Budan, a farmer was buried under the debris and died on the spot, while his wife sustained serious injuries after the wall of their house collapsed due to heavy rains at night, they added. In Ballia district, a six-year-old girl was killed when a mud wall fell on her in Naferpur village, police said. PTI

Jhiram Ghati verdict: What remains of the legacy of 'Bastar Tiger' Mahendra Karma, face of Salwa Judum

Karma was killed along with 27 others in 2013; his family asks why 'political conspiracy' angle not probed in the attack

Jayprakash S Naidu
Raipur, September 6

AS THE VERDICT came in Saturday convicting all the 10 Maoists accused in the Jhiram Ghati attack of May 2013, the family of their prime target, Mahendra Karma, said they are still waiting for justice.

Karma, 62, who was killed along with 27 others in the Jhiram Ghati attack, was one of the foremost tribal voices against Maoists in Chhattisgarh. He was also the face behind the Salwa Judum, a force of civilians who were made Special Police Officers (SPOs) and armed to fight the Maoists, and later ran into controversy. Within six years of its founding, the Salwa Judum was struck down by the Supreme Court in 2011, saying it was unconstitutional and violated fundamental rights to equality and protection of life.

But Karma's resolve to take on the Maoists at the height of their powers in Chhattisgarh is not doubted by even his rivals. He had survived several attempts on his life before the Jhi-

ram Ghati blast.

The Maoists described his killing as a "historic success".

Karma's son, Chhavindra, 44, said that many of his supporters were also killed by the Maoists later. Karma's three sons and wife are under central government's Z-plus cover.

"Maoists murdered over 95 people connected to our family... My father was their oldest enemy, and they took decades to kill him. But we will continue to oppose their ideology," he said, adding that the BJP government may claim to have ended the Maoist movement, but it is too early to say so.

While Karma and his 15 siblings had a difficult childhood, after losing their parents early, he became a lawyer while one of his elder brothers, Laxman Karma, joined politics and was a Congress MP (1980-84).

Karma emerged as a rare anti-Maoist tribal voice in Bastar around the end 1970s, with his supporters calling him the "Bastar Tiger". He stood up against the Maoists first through the Jan Jagran Abhiyan of the 1990s and



Mahendra Karma; (right) his statue installed in Dantewada

then the Danteshwari Samiti in the 2000s — both movements seeking to build public opinion against the Maoists.

Calling the Danteshwari Samiti "a soft precursor to Salwa Judum" in some ways, journalist-turned-activist Shubranshu Choudhary said Karma's role in the history of the anti-Maoist fight in Chhattisgarh can't be ignored. The special anti-Naxal District Reserve Guard (DRG) is "part of Karma's controversial legacy", he pointed out. "Its roots lie in SPOs who emerged during the Salwa Judum period."

Karma's former CPI colleague-turned-rival Manish Kunjam said Karma was aware of the long shadow cast by the Salwa Judum and feared it would continue to haunt his image after his death.

On how they fell out, Kunjam



added: "The CPI was demanding the Sixth Schedule (granting legislative, judicial, executive, and financial powers to tribal councils) for protecting tribals in Bastar, but Karma was opposed to it... I met him before Jhiram Ghati attack and he spoke about the Sixth Schedule and Salwa Judum. I felt he realised he had made a mistake with Salwa Judum."

After Karma's death, his wife Devi contested from the Dantewada seat the same year and won, but in 2018, lost to the BJP's Bhima Mandavi. A year later, Mandavi was killed in an IED blast, and Devi won the bypoll against Mandavi's wife Ojaswi.

In 2023, Congress fielded Chhavindra, who lost to BJP's Chaitram Atami, who had incidentally been a Salwa Judum member. Apart from Chhavi-

ndra, three other of Karma's nine children joined politics. While Deepak died in 2021, Tulika, Chhavindra and Sulochna are part of Congress and have been winning panchayat-level polls.

Chhavindra said justice has not been done to Karma. "The Jhiram Ghati attack was not a Naxal attack but a political conspiracy. Top police officers and BJP leaders (BJP was in power in the state at the time) need to be questioned... to find out the larger conspiracy. NIA never spoke with anyone from our family to know what we had to say."

Former Congress CM Bhupesh Baghel has also said the BJP never wanted political conspiracy to be probed. Under his government, a second FIR was filed in 2020 and a SIT formed to probe this alleged conspiracy, but after BJP returned to power, the investigation went cold.

Congress general secretary Malket Singh Gaidu said Karma is wrongly blamed over Salwa Judum. "It was a people's movement led by him, in which tribals stood peacefully against Maoists. But then BJP government recruited them as SPOs and, without giving training, armed them with weapons to fight Maoists. Due to this the matter went to the SC. After it was struck down, Maoists became stronger in Bastar."

• AFTER NEPAL REFUSED TO ACCEPT ALFAZ'S GULAK, EFFORTS BEING MADE TO SEND IT THROUGH EMBASSY

Bahraich boy gives gulak for Nepal flood relief: 'Accha nahi laga... log pareshan hai'

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, September 6



Alfaz, 8, hands over his gulak to Bahraich DM, Thursday. EXPRESS

down the Gandak river from Nepal into India. After conducting postmortems and preserving DNA samples, the district administration handed the bodies over to Nepali authorities. But amid this solemn exchange, a small act of a child's kindness found itself caught in bureaucratic limbo.

Sources said that when officials tried to hand over Alfaz's

gulak along with the bodies, Nepali authorities reportedly declined to accept it, asking instead that the money be deposited directly into a bank account.

Now, officials are exploring another route — reaching out to the Nepal Embassy with a request to ensure that Alfaz's gulak, exactly as he had given it, finally makes its way to the flood-affected people of Nepal. "The gulak represents a child's own savings — a small gesture of solidarity from him — and every effort is being made to ensure it reaches the Embassy intact," an official said.

Speaking to The Indian Express over the phone, the child said: "Mujhe accha nahi laga mobile par video dekh kar, log pareshan hain Nepal mein baad aane par. Humney apney

baba se kaha hum apna paisa dena chahate hain pareshan logo ko, toh unhone kaha theek hai aur humne de diya (I felt bad watching videos on the mobile — people are suffering in Nepal because of the floods. I told my grandfather I wanted to give my money to the people in trouble, and he said okay, so we gave it)."

"There were coins and small notes Alfaz had received from elders over time — we believe there must be around Rs 2,000 in there. When I told his father about it, he said that if Alfaz wished to do this, we should find a way to send it to Nepal," said his grandfather Qasim Ali.

The family first reached out to local residents to send the money to Nepal, before deciding it would be simplest to hand the gulak over to the DM.

Pune residents seek ban on DJs during festivals, slam govt and police inaction

Manoj More
Pune, September 6

PUNEITES ON Sunday took to the streets, demanding a blanket ban on the use of DJs during festivals, religious events and anniversary celebrations. They slammed the inaction of the state government and Pune police in this regard.

The rally started from Bangadharva Chowk and ended at Pune Municipal Corporation headquarters. Over 1,000 citizens, including elderly and the ailing, gathered on the call from "PuneKars Against Loudspeakers Forum" to protest against DJs and other sound systems.

They carried placards and banners, displaying a level of spontaneous enthusiasm — reflecting the anger of adult residents.



Over 1,000 people participated in the protest on Sunday. PAVAN KHENGRE

However, Vidyant Bapat, who first raised the issue during a Ganesh festival preparation meeting organised by the Pune Municipal Corporation and the police, gave the protest a miss. It was the second time in one week he skipped such a protest. When contacted, Bapat did not cite any reason for skipping the protest.

Mukund Kirdat, one of the organisers, said, "We are pressing for a complete ban on DJ music. It is dangerous for children, the elderly and the ailing," Kirdat said. Kirdat handed a formal petition to DCP Krushikesh Rawale and Joint Commissioner Anuja Deshmane.

The Forum emphasised that the ban must cover all religious,

social, and political events — not just the Ganesh festival.

"The police have imposed a ban on sound system in Nagpur, Solapur, and Mumbai. Then why can't police enforce it in Pune? Both the Government and Pune police have remained indecisive. If decisive action is not taken within the coming week, citizens will be forced to take to the streets once again," said Kirdat who is also the city president of AAP.

NCP(SP) leader Sunil Mane said, "There is unanimity among the educated population of Pune that DJ music should have no place in our festivals, religious events or anniversary celebrations... Neither the State government nor the police are taking firm action against the use of ear-splitting sound systems. We condemn this inaction on their part."



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GDP debate is not about numbers alone. It is about trust deficit



ABHISHEK ANAND, JOSH FELMAN AND ARVIND SUBRAMANIAN

THE RELEASE of new GDP data, always contentious, has again sparked a lively debate. Former finance secretary Subhash Garg has asserted that the Ministry of Statistics and Planning Implementation (MoSPI) headed by Saurabh Garg has vastly overstated growth by reducing the previous year's output. Who is right? Consider our five-fold assessment.

First, MOSPI's response is plausible on some technicalities. Subhash Garg is comparing 2026-27 GDP calculated using the new base and the latest methodology to the 2025-26 numbers produced using the old base and previous methodology. This compares apples to oranges. Applying the new methodology to both years yields real growth of 7.8 per cent. MoSPI is also right that value added deflators can rise less than the CPI or WPI; and can even be negative (but, of course, only rarely, when input prices rise sharply relative to output prices).

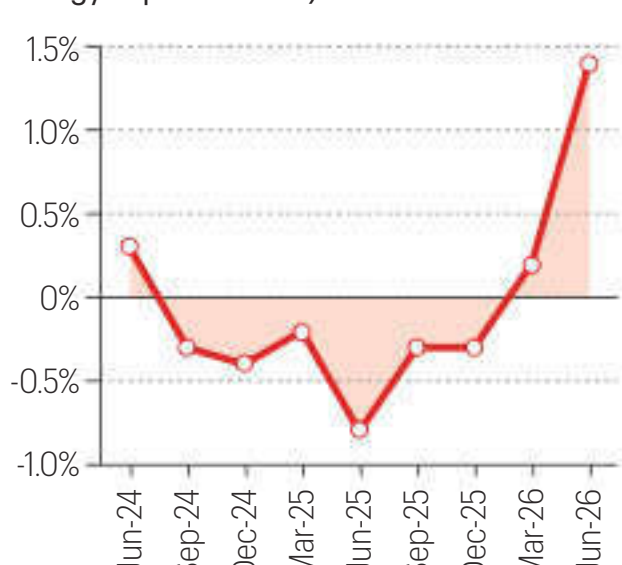
More importantly, there are reasons to believe that growth was good in the first quarter, even if the precise magnitude is open to question. As government spokesmen have pointed out, some of the macro-economic indicators — exports, credit and sales — rose strongly during the period.

So, why all the controversy? This brings us to our second point: The government's handling of data has created a fundamental trust deficit. Scepticism about GDP dates back at least to 2016-17, when the official data showed growth accelerating to a dizzy 8.2 per cent in a year when 86 per cent of cash was withdrawn.

The problems go well beyond GDP, and include the delayed census, the withdrawn 2017 consumption survey, the understated Covid, and exaggerated claims about open defecation. Unsurprisingly, the public seems to have replaced its traditional "trust-but-verify" attitude

Fig 1: **Energy Shock**

Year on year percentage change in price of Indian oil imports multiplied by the share of energy imports in GDP



Sources: Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas and Ministry of Commerce. **Note:** Energy imports comprise oil, natural gas and fertilizers.

with a "doubt-but-remain-open" approach to the data: The burden of proof has shifted to the government.

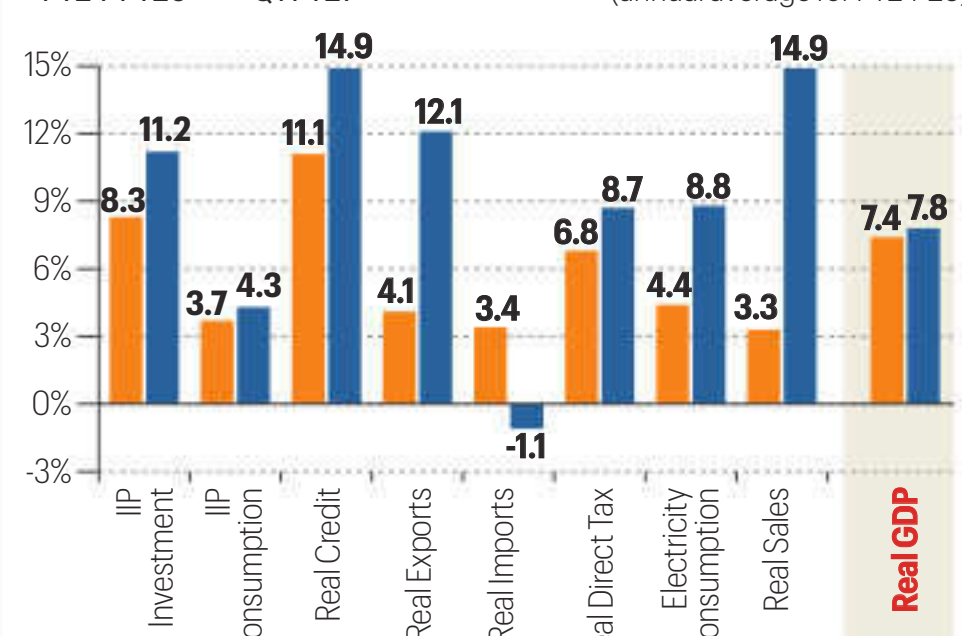
This trust deficit explains why Subhash Garg's criticism has touched a nerve. Public doubts have been fuelled because the government has done little to dispel his allegation that backward revisions are aimed at boosting current growth rates. It has not explained why first quarter 2025-26 GDP was revised down by 7 per cent when the methodology changed, nor released a long back series that would explain when the loss of growth actually occurred.

Moreover, while MoSPI has addressed many issues with the annual GDP series, challenges remain with the quarterly GDP numbers. MoSPI does not have good, timely information on unlisted firms or the informal economy, together accounting for nearly 45 per cent of the economy. Historically, their performance has been proxied using large listed companies — an assumption our Peterson Institute for International Economics working paper shows has not held over the past decade. The problem may have been acute in the first quarter because the energy shock disproportionately affected smaller enterprises.

Third, the numbers seem de-

Fig 2: **GDP Growth & Macro-Economic Indicators**

(annual average for FY24-26)



Sources: MoSPI; RBI; and Ministry of Power. **Note:** Real exports and imports refer to exports and imports of goods and services, respectively. Real sales are based on the performance of listed non-government non-financial companies. Real credit, real sales and real direct tax are nominal values deflated by core CPI.

coupled from felt reality and economic reasoning. April and May 2026 were months of fuel rationing, curbing travel and forcing businesses such as restaurants to buy LPG cylinders on the black market or shut down. This came amid long-standing tepid wage growth, poor job creation, a sagging stock-market, and a currency under intense pressure — all contributing to growing anxiety among the young, reflected in the recent student protests.

It is also difficult to understand how the economy accelerated amid such a large energy shock. A decade ago, falling oil prices were rightly seen as a huge wind-fall for Indian growth. By the same logic, the recent rise in energy costs — equivalent to a tax increase of around 1.5 per cent of GDP — should have imposed a substantial drag (Figure 1).

There were offsets, including fiscal stimulus and stronger exports, but these seem smaller than the damage from a 32 per cent increase in import prices. Indeed, the RBI recently estimated that the economy slowed in the first quarter. Merely sustaining growth in these circumstances would have been impressive. Yet MoSPI estimates that growth accelerated by nearly one percentage point.

The problems go well beyond GDP, and include the delayed census, the withdrawn 2017 consumption survey, the understated Covid, and exaggerated claims about open defecation



SUMANA ROY

IT WASN'T "shakti" but "*bhakti*" that I heard when the schoolgirl Jaya Bhaduri sang "*Hum ko mann ki shakti dena...*" in the film *Guddi*. It must have seemed natural to me that the close-eyed obedience of the student was a form of *bhakti*. Our conditioning in the ritual of prayer is such that we internalise the priest's instructions, the closing of the eyes, the folding of our hands, the semi-ceremonial opening of the eyes, so that it seems that what was in front of us appears slightly different now. This insight seems to be the ambition of the teacher in the classroom, and it is easy to make an analogical connection between prayer and the classroom period. When I say "prayer", I'm thinking of the dialogue and discussion with oneself and life that Henri Matisse, in an extraordinary phrase about creative practice, called the "state of mind that approaches prayer".

We imagine *bhakti* to be close-eyed adoration, the reason we dismiss the blind veneration of a political party with a catch-all phrase like *bhakt*. There are at least two elisions happening here. The first is the Bhakti tradition of literary and spiritual practice — *bhakti*, which originally meant devotion, worship, homage, piety, became critique, a resistance to the caste system, and to a monolingual culture of worship for the Bhakti poets. It was also playful-

Though Nietzsche dances in their classrooms, they ignore texts like 'Twilight of the Idols' that criticise this neediness of the teacher to be the recipient of bhakti: 'Thou seekest followers? Then thou seekest ciphers'

Note to teachers: Stand out of students' sunlight

ness, the remnants of which we see in both the student and the teacher comically opening one eye during the prayer song in *Guddi*. *Bhakti* was — this scene reminds us — a critique of the idea of god and *bhakti* itself.

The other kind of elision has to do with the *bhakt* of the personality cult. Those who ridicule the *andh bhakt* are *bhakt*s of another kind — an endorsement by a famous writer, a meeting with a well-known academic, among other teenagerish things, mark their behaviour. There's an important difference between these two kinds of *bhakt*s though — the *andh bhakt* wants to remain a *bhakt*, in the belief that they will be protected by the object of their adoration; the *bhakt* of academia and the literary world wants to be the recipient of such *bhakti* themselves. The *andh bhakt* worships the powerful, the academic-*bhakt* the powerless, so that both transform into a fetish. One wants to remain

Hanuman, the other lives with the belief that it's only a matter of time that they too will become Foucault.

Though Nietzsche dances in their classrooms, they ignore texts like *Twilight of the Idols* that criticise this neediness of the teacher to be the recipient of *bhakti*: "Thou seekest followers? Then thou seekest ciphers". "Star professor" — a coinage that competes in cringe quotient with the "university don"

of a previous era — should be an oxymoron in the classroom; but star professors — and everyone likes to think of themselves as one — lubricate the personality cult, seemingly unaware that it is a weapon of bullying and indoctrination. Ursula K Le Guin has spoken about the stranglehold of such a power equation: "I hope you live without the need to dominate, and without the need to be dominated. I hope you are never victims, but I hope you have no power over other people."

Jacques Derrida had deconstruction, René Girard mimetism, "I have no logo, no brand. But a philosophy does not spread without a logo," rued Michel Serres, an extraordinary thinker and teacher. Substitute "philosophy" with "philosopher" or "professor", and it'll explain why Serres — and various other writers, thinkers and critics — are not on the Humanities syllabus. "Stand out of my sunlight" — Diogenes, the "beggar philosopher" is said to have told Alexander when asked what he wanted. The young conqueror was so struck by the philosopher's contempt and detachment that he's believed to have said, "But as for me, if I were not Alexander, I would be Diogenes."

Instead of conquering the classroom like Alexander, I wish that teachers stood out of students' sunlight.

Roy is a poet and writer. Views are personal



UDAYAN DAS

THE RECENT Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) summit offers a useful reminder of the limits of India's efforts to isolate Pakistan at the global level. Pakistan assumed the rotational presidency of a multilateral organisation which has counter-terrorism at its heart. Is Pakistan undercutting India's relations with other states? Is India adequately expanding ties with other states to counter this? Strategically speaking, India's policies have the right objectives. Weakening Islamabad on the global stage, ensuring sanctions, and rallying condemnation are common playbooks of statecraft. Where it is going wrong is in assuming that

it is easy to effectively isolate a state. Interests drive state policy more than morality does. States are far more likely to react to an issue that affects their interests directly. Therefore, Pakistan remains a bilateral problem for India, and other states share little overlapping concern with New Delhi.

States also make themselves useful to others despite their differences. Take, for instance, US relations with Pakistan in the post-Cold War era. Washington has been harsh on Islamabad on several occasions, particularly on the issue of terrorism, and aid has been granted, suspended, curtailed, and restarted repeatedly. Yet the Americans remained engaged with Pakistan, largely because of their interests in Afghanistan. Nor has the Iran war been the first time Pakistan mediated between states; recall the famed realignment of the US and China during the

Cold War. Flexible diplomacy can align interests despite moral complaints, and for states, that matters more.

A strategy focused solely on isolating Pakistan will not prove efficient for India. A more effective strategy is to steadily strip it of its ability to limit India's options. Consider the relationship between India and the US over the last two decades. Washington did not abandon its engagement with Islamabad, but its engagement with New Delhi grew across a wide range of issues, involving economic, security, and political

Isolation does not happen in a vacuum, but in relative terms. If one wishes to isolate a rival, stronger positioning is the key

convergences. The de-hyphenation of India and Pakistan took place during this period. The US was also seen as decisively favouring India when it came to South Asia because of its overarching regional interests. The key to negate Pakistan's influence would be to make India's already existing security and defence relations stronger. Donald Trump's tenure so far has not been the best for India; however, the deep strategic ties over the last two decades allow some consistency and reliability for India-US relations. This includes the existing issues of the defence partnership, critical and emerging technologies, along with fronts like the 2+2 and the Quad.

Saudi Arabia, too, has a long history of relations with Pakistan, yet India was still able to develop consistent relations with it, owing to economic and strategic conver-

gences. In both cases, India's positioning rendered Pakistan's equations with these states largely irrelevant.

Isolation does not happen in a vacuum, but in relative terms. If one wishes to isolate a rival, stronger positioning is the key. A measure of this is when other states do the de-hyphenation, choose to engage with you more, and find greater interest in siding with you in a crisis. If these boxes are ticked, the rival is already isolated, regardless of official statements. This strategy should extend in multilateral forums like SCO and BRICS where India's relations with other states need to be aligned.

The writer teaches in the Department of Political Science, St. Xavier's College (Autonomous), Kolkata and is a visiting fellow, Asian Confluence, Shillong

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Climate commitments

THE RISE in climate-related calamities, most recently the Nepal flood tragedy, confirms that urbanisation has pushed ecological balance much beyond its limits ('In a warming world, reframe climate task', IE, September 5). While the UNFCCC's Loss and Damage Fund addresses financial losses, it remains inadequate given the intensity of the disasters. The question is: What about the human cost — the displaced families, the missing people and the damaged homes?

Paavni Srivastava, Dhenkanal

THE UNEP's report acknowledges that exceeding the 1.5°C threshold is now unavoidable, but it does not suggest surrendering the objectives of the Paris Agreement ('In a warming world, reframe climate task', IE, September 5). Instead, the international community should emphasise limiting the magnitude and duration of this overshoot by reassessing the adequacy of existing climate strategies. Climate action cannot remain confined to long-term declarations; it should shift towards faster emission reductions that are measurable and hold countries accountable for their commitments.

Vaibhav Goyal, Chandigarh

Brewing storm

WHILE RECENT GDP figures offer a comforting snapshot, the brewing storm in global bond markets signals that our current economic stability is largely a mirage ('Beyond GDP, brace for turbulence ahead', IE, September 5). With soaring long-term interest rates abroad, the cost of borrowing dollars and the burden of hedging against rupee depreciation are quietly becoming unsustainable. We must face the structural reality that expensive foreign capital will eventually drain our reserves. A pragmatic way forward demands fiscal discipline over populist spending, paired with export promotion and a reduction in duties.

K Chidanand Kumar, Bengaluru

‘INDIA GOT LUCKY IN 2014 AS FOREX INFLOWS AFTER THE ELECTIONS HELPED MEET FCNR(B) REPAYMENTS’

‘For markets, GDP way down in pecking order of economic data’

THE GDP growth rate ranks “way down” in financial markets’ pecking order of economic indicators, with inflation, government finances, and geopolitics all seen as more important, **Sandeep Yadav**, Head of Fixed Income at DSP Mutual Fund, told **Siddharth Upasani** in an interview.

Adding that the 7.8% growth rate for April-June is “stale”, Yadav also voiced concerns about India’s ability to attract foreign money and the difficulty the Reserve Bank of India may face when the Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) deposits, raised under the swap window, are repaid starting 2029. Edited excerpts:

GDP data has continuously exceeded expectations for several quarters, but markets aren’t really reacting to it.

There are multiple reasons for this. The first is that the April-June GDP numbers are stale, because we have seen the US-Iran war carry on and impact commodity prices and government finances. So, while these numbers are good, they are not very fresh.

Another reason why these

GDP numbers did not matter much was because we already had an inkling, looking at the tax collection and other data, that the nominal GDP numbers at least are looking fine.

So where does GDP growth rank in the market’s pecking order of economic indicators?

I think it’s way down in the order right now, especially for the debt market...because there are more pressing issues right now, especially inflation, which is going to be above 5% for some time. We have seen the Reserve Bank of India also care more about inflation rather than growth.

Fiscal deficit, this year, is much higher in the order than growth because subsidies have spiked due to the war.

For the debt market, GDP growth probably ranks lower than geopolitics. What Donald Trump says and does, the war, and oil prices — these are all more important right now than a growth rate of 7.8%.

Are there warning signs for India in how the US and Japan have worked together to strengthen the



EXPRESS
interview

SANDEEP YADAV
HEAD OF FIXED INCOME AT DSP MUTUAL FUND

yen without raising US yields?

In the 25 years that I’ve been in the markets, there have been so many times that I have felt “This is something we have never seen before”. Yet, somehow, after every couple of years, we see it again... It’s the same now.

I don’t expect a contagion, but I am worried about India, especially foreign inflows, for two reasons. One, we are still not able to garner net inflows. Yes, this year the Balance of Payments surplus is very high, but that’s because of the FCNR(B) deposits.

My second worry is the FCNR(B) deposits themselves. They have helped us this year, but how do we fix the issue next year? They also have to be paid back after 3-5 years. And it’s not just \$130 billion; even before these deposits mature, we have a significant FX forward maturity.

So, the future is worrisome when you have a short forward book of \$200 billion, even if reserves are close to \$800 billion by then. I think the RBI is also worried because that’s the only reason I can think of why they stopped the FCNR(B) swap scheme early despite saying

just two weeks earlier there is no intention to do so.

Structurally, nothing has changed in India to warrant more FX inflows and we have outflows lined up over the next few years. If US yields keep on rising or we see a dislocation in Japan, it’s going to be very difficult for India to get money (from abroad) because there’ll be a flight to safety the way we saw in 2008 and 2013, and it will be very difficult to even get incremental inflows which we are not able to get anyway.

How disruptive will the redemption of the FCNR(B) deposits be?

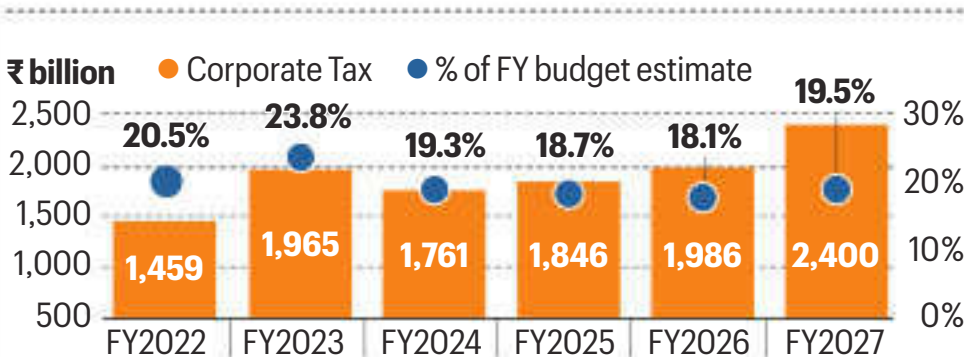
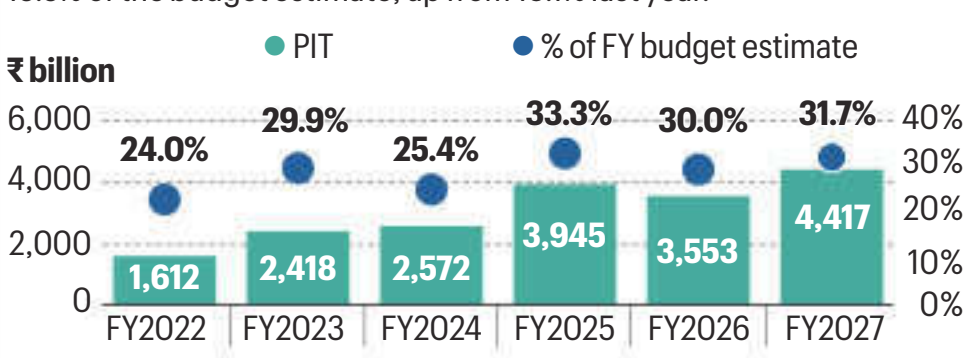
We were quite lucky in 2016 (when the 2013 FCNR(B) deposits matured) because the result of the 2014 general elections led to bumper forex inflows for the next couple of years.

If we get FX inflows, it should not be that difficult this time. My worry is that we have not seen those flows come for many years... I remain optimistic, but yes, it is something I am sure policymakers would and should be worried about.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

• DIRECT TAX GROWTH REMAINS STRONG

Personal income tax (PIT) collections surged 24.3% year-on-year in the first four months if 2026-27, while corporate tax inflows rose a healthy 20.8%. At Rs 4.42 lakh crore, PIT collections have reached 31.7% of the FY27 budget estimate, up from 30% a year ago. Meanwhile, Rs 2.4 lakh crore has been collected as corporate tax in April-July, amounting to 19.5% of the budget estimate, up from 18.1% last year.



NOTE: EACH YEAR’S DATA FOR APR-JULY; SOURCE: CGA, ICRA

GST Council’s meet now on Oct 7 to avoid BRICS clash

ENS Economic Bureau
New Delhi, September 6

THE GST Council’s 57th meeting has been rescheduled to October 7 after the original date of September 12 clashed with the BRICS Summit in New Delhi, according to government sources.

As is the usual practice, the officers’ meeting is likely to be held the previous day, sources said.

The Council, chaired by Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman, last met in September 2025, where the number of GST slabs were reduced to two from four earlier.

The Council is expected to prioritise reducing litigation and take up issues related to

input tax credit (ITC).

The Council can also take up the simplification in GST registration of businesses with tax credit of over Rs 2.5 lakh per month.

In August, Central Board of Indirect Taxes (CBIC) Member Sanjay Mangal said that the central and state governments were working on a uniform circular for registration of large businesses.

At the last Council meeting, held on September 3, 2025, the four GST slabs of 5%, 12%, 18%, and 28%, were merged into a two-tier structure of 5% and 18%, along with 40% rate for ultra-luxury and sin goods. These changes came into effect on September 22, 2025. FE

RBI faces liquidity deluge as surplus climbs to 4-yr high of Rs 10.3 lakh crore

George Mathew
Mumbai, September 6

THE RESERVE Bank of India is faced with an unusual monetary-policy headache: there is simply too much money, or liquidity, in the banking system with the banking-system liquidity climbing to a four-year high of about Rs 10.3 lakh crore on September 3, its highest level since May 2022.

Foreign-currency inflows through the recent swap facility on a large scale, combined with the liquidity released through the RBI’s foreign-exchange operations, have resulted in a huge pool of rupee funds chasing relatively limited avenues for deployment. While core liquidity crossed to Rs 10 lakh crore, the daily average surplus stood at Rs 3.67 lakh crore in August, more than three times July’s Rs 1.07 lakh crore, said Sneha Pandey, fund manager, Equity, Quantum AMC.

The central bank must now drain this excess liquidity without triggering a sharp rise in interest rates or unsettling the government securities market. Huge liquidity in the banking system generally puts downward pressure on the overnight money-market rate, including the repo rate, unless the RBI actively absorbs the excess liquidity. This can further push up inflation levels.

The unusual situation has come at a time when global central banks are planning to hike interest rates to curb inflation and Members of the RBI’s Monetary Policy Committee had indicated that as headline inflation is projected to peak to a level as high as 5.9% in Q3 2026-27, a “case for a hike may emerge” during the course of the year.

“Even after adjusting for the increase in currency in circula-

• LIQUIDITY MOUNTS

THE CENTRAL bank must now drain this excess liquidity without triggering a sharp rise in interest rates or unsettling the government securities market

HUGE LIQUIDITY in the banking system generally puts downward pressure on the overnight money-market rate, including the repo rate, unless the RBI actively absorbs the excess liquidity

CAREEDGE RATINGS expects core liquidity to rise from Rs 8.1 lakh crore as of mid-August to potentially closer to Rs 13-14 lakh crore by December-end in the absence of any liquidity management operations by the RBI

tion during the upcoming festive season and the maturity of the RBI’s short dollar positions in the forward markets, we expect core liquidity to rise from Rs 8.1 lakh crore as of mid-August to potentially closer to Rs 13-14 lakh crore by December-end in the absence of any liquidity management operations by the RBI,” CareEdge Ratings said.

“Given the swap arrangement, these inflows will add to an already abundant rupee liquidity backdrop, which was at a four year high this month, depressing overnight rates,” DBS Bank Senior Economist and ED Radhika Rao said.

The deluge was created as the RBI’s special US dollar-rupee forex swap facility has drawn foreign exchange inflows of \$136.377 billion through August 31. FCNR(B) deposits accounted for the overwhelming share of the mobilisation at \$127.226 billion. “These dollars, when converted, released rupees into the system and the exemption of

India emerges as key diesel supplier to Europe: Report

New Delhi: India has emerged as a crucial source of diesel for Europe, supplying about 60% of the fuel transiting the Bab-el-Mandeb to the region in August, as Russian exports remain severely constrained and US shipments begin to weaken, according to data from Vortexa — real-time data and advanced analytics for energy and freight.

About 2,00,000 barrels per day of diesel (gasoil) transited the Bab-el-Mandeb in August on vessels bound for Europe, close to year-earlier levels after flows through the key shipping route nearly stalled in March and April. India supplied roughly 60% of that volume, making Indian refineries an increasingly important source of Europe’s eastern diesel supply, Vortexa said in a report.

India is the world’s fourth-largest refiner, with an installed capacity of 258.1 million tonnes per annum, which exceeds domestic fuel demand by a margin. PTI

OPEC+ keeps oil output policy unchanged for Oct

Reuters
September 6

OPEC+ KEPT its oil output policy unchanged for October at a meeting on Sunday, it said in a statement, as the producer group needs to agree new quotas before deciding its next output steps.

The meeting of seven core OPEC+ members — Saudi Arabia, Russia, Iraq, Kuwait, Algeria, Kazakhstan and Oman — comes as the Iran war continues to disrupt oil exports through the Strait of Hormuz, limiting OPEC+’s influence over prices and market share.

In August, OPEC+ agreed its production boost for September, completing a phased roll-back of a 1.65 million-barrel-per-day supply cut first agreed in 2023. Despite the agreed production increases, the group made up of the Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries and its allies, including Russia, still produces far below its targets because of the war.

“OPEC+ currently has very limited power over the physical oil market,” said Jorge Leon of

these deposits from CRR and SLR meant the liquidity landed unencumbered,” said a fund manager.

Beyond strengthening the capital account and the overall balance of payments, these sizeable inflows are also likely to lead to a surge in liquidity conditions. However, the upside to the liquidity inflows could be partly offset by seasonal currency demand and the RBI’s maturing forward book. “We estimate that currency in circulation (CiC) could rise by around Rs 1.1 lakh crore from June levels by December amid seasonal uptick in festive periods,” CareEdge Ratings said.

Further, maturing RBI’s short positions in the forwards market should create additional drag of around Rs 3 lakh crore (RBI short-forward book maturing stands at \$22 billion in 3 months). CRR accretion on the deposit growth should further reduce core liquidity by Rs 70,000 crore.

Global central banks are mostly planning to keep rates high or tighten cautiously because inflation — especially from energy and geopolitical shocks — remains above target despite weakening growth. The RBI can’t afford to trigger inflationary pressures by keeping liquidity high and put downward pressure on interest rates.

Rao said concerted steps will be required to drain the potential surge in liquidity. “Near-term options include temporary Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR) hike or Incremental CRR introduced back in 2023. While this will have an immediate impact, such a move could be viewed as effectively unwinding the RBI’s earlier decision to exclude these deposits from CRR and SLR requirements,” Rao said.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Large corporate loans put banks’ credit assessment and monitoring under lens

Kshipra Petkar
Mumbai, September 6

THE RESOLUTION of debt linked to Essel Group founder Subhash Chandra has once again put a familiar question before Indian banks: was the due diligence strong enough?

Chandra is hardly an isolated case. The banking system has seen large exposures to promoter-led businesses associated with Vijay Mallya, Anil Ambani and Venugopal Dhoot, among others deteriorate, forcing lenders to resort to restructuring, recovery proceedings, insolvency and,

eventually, write-offs.

According to Kritika Krishnamurthy, founding partner at AK & Partners, the most rigorous due diligence generally takes place when a loan is first sanctioned. As borrowers build a record of timely repayments, lenders can become more comfortable and gradually increase their exposure.

That comfort can turn into complacency.

“Long-standing relationships can give lenders information that may not be captured in financial statements. The risk arises when promoter reputation, group standing or

past repayment behaviour begins to provide disproportionate comfort,” said Sagar Lakhani, partner at Uniques Consultech.

“For the top 2%, the creamy layer loans, there needs to be more rigorous monitoring,” Krishnamurthy said.

An RTI response from SBI showed that between FY18-26, the lender took 309 loan accounts with combined claims of Rs 1.5 lakh crore to the NCLT and similar forums. It recovered Rs 49,727 crore through resolution plans, implying a haircut of about Rs 1 lakh crore, or 67% of claims. FE

• CHINA LIFE INSURANCE (GROUP) CO, THE COUNTRY’S LARGEST LIFE INSURER, WILL RECEIVE 35 BILLION YUAN (\$5.2 BILLION), WHILE CHINA TAIPING INSURANCE GROUP WILL GET 7 BILLION YUAN

China to pump \$54 billion into state banks, insurers in capital-boosting push

Reuters
Beijing, September 6

CHINA’S FINANCE ministry will inject a combined \$54 billion into state-owned insurers and banks, the companies said on Sunday, in a coordinated push by Beijing to shore up capital across its financial system.

China Life Insurance (Group) Co, the country’s largest life insurer, will receive 35 billion yuan (\$5.2 billion), while China Taiping Insurance Group will get 7 billion yuan, the two groups said in statements.

Separately People’s Insurance Company (Group) of China said it planned to raise up to 15 billion yuan through a private placement of A-shares to the Ministry of Finance, with the proceeds to be used to replenish its capital.

plish its capital.

The initiative could help bolster state insurers that were directed to support the stock market with medium- and long-term funds, while positioning them to help regulators manage smaller, higher-risk insurance companies.

Financial sector stability

The insurance sector has been grappling with eroding profitability due to persistently low interest rates, with numerous small and mid-sized insurers reporting deteriorating solvency ratios.

China Export and Credit Insurance Corp also said the finance ministry will inject 10 billion yuan to boost its core capital, and China Reinsurance

(Group) said it will raise 3 billion yuan.

“The injection is an important step by the country to enhance the financial sector’s ability to serve the real economy and promote the high-quality development of the financial and insurance industries,” China Life said in its statement, adding that it would strengthen the group’s ability to withstand risks.

Taiping said the funds would bolster its solvency and other key indicators.

Banks tap recapitalisation plan

Separately, three state lenders on Sunday also announced they will receive a combined 290 billion yuan in capital injections.

The plan was first unveiled



The initiative could help bolster state insurers that were directed to support the stock market with medium- and long-term funds. REUTERS

at an annual parliamentary meeting in March this year, extending a financing tool that had helped bolster some other big state banks last year.

Agricultural Bank of China and Industrial and Commercial Bank of China, two of the country’s largest state banks, said they planned to raise up to

160 billion yuan and 100 billion yuan respectively through private A-share placements to the finance ministry, China National Tobacco Corp and its subsidiaries.

Both lenders said the proceeds would be used entirely to replenish core Tier 1 capital, in a move to help sustain credit expansion as Beijing leans on state banks to support growth.

Weak loan demand remains a persistent drag on the world’s second-largest economy, which also has been eroding profitability of the banking sector.

The Export-Import Bank of China, one of the country’s three policy lenders, said the finance ministry will inject 30 billion yuan into the bank, effectively enhancing its capital base.

Chinese banks buying US Treasuries

Beijing: Chinese banks have been buying US Treasuries over the past few months after lifting dollar deposit rates, according to people familiar with the matter, moves that could help slow gains in the yuan and which come amid a spike in US yields.

The purchases, which have not been previously reported, represent a shift in strategy for Chinese commercial banks. *Reuters* was, however, not able to ascertain the amounts of money involved or whether they move the needle in terms of China’s overall holdings of US Treasuries.

For many Chinese banks, US Treasuries represent an attract-

ive investment at a time when yields on Chinese government bonds are very low and heavy investment in the domestic bond market has attracted attention from Chinese regulators.

Dollar interest rates offered by China’s “Big Five” state-owned lenders on most deposits have been capped at 2.8% since 2023.

But account holders with balances over \$50,000 have been able to negotiate rates above 3% since June and even close to 4% at some smaller banks or foreign lenders since August, according to a state banker with direct knowledge of the deals. REUTERS

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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

• **ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE**

Claude’s ‘thought process’ & AI consciousness debate



ANIL SASI

WILL ARTIFICIAL intelligence (AI) be able to outperform human intelligence—and, if yes, will that will happen in the foreseeable future — is a recurrent question fuelled by the portrayal of AI in popular culture. Central to this comparison is a clear need to define the term “intelligence”.

So, when Anthropic’s research, led by its ‘Model Psych’ team leader Jack Lindsey, found something like an internal thought process in the workings of its AI chatbot Claude Sonnet 4.5 — words that were related to its eventual outputs but invisible to the user — the debate was reignited.

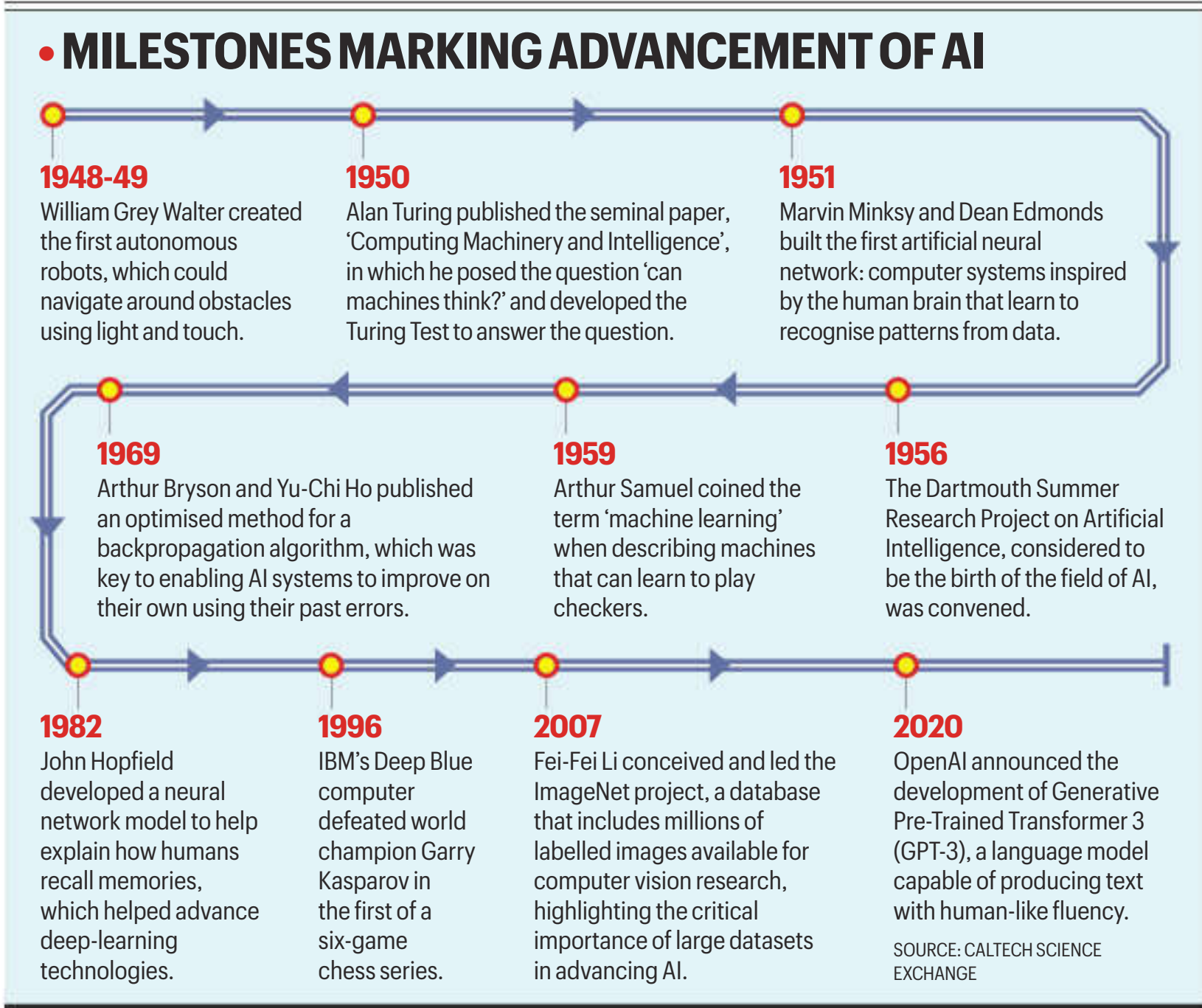
The AI company published a book-length research paper about the inner workings of large language models and put out a blog post announcing the results of this new paper in July, titled *A global work-space in language models*. The study presents evidence that a Claude has developed “a small collection of internal neural patterns that, compared to all its other internal processing, play a special role”.

J-space

Anthropic is calling the collection of these patterns ‘J-space’—short for Jacobian space and named after the technique used to find patterns. Essentially, these are patterns in a subset of Claude models’ inner computations and provide a mathematical approximation of an LLM’s working memory. Each J-space pattern is linked to a particular word; when one of these patterns lights up, it doesn’t mean the model is saying that word—just that the word is on its mind.

The J-space is essentially something that operates silently, in the model’s internal neural activations, allowing the model to think about a concept without writing it down. What is important is the clarification by Anthropic: that the J-space wasn’t designed or programmed by the model maker, but instead emerged on its own during Claude’s training process.

So does this answer the search for consciousness inside large language models



Anthropic has found something like an ‘internal monologue’ in the workings of its chatbot. Experts believe consciousness is still far off

broadcast in words,” according to Bergmann.

For instance, in the experiment of Claude Sonnet 4.5, Anthropic researchers asked the LLM to count to five and, at the same time, “introspect deeply”. The artificial intelligence model complied, dutifully coming up with 1,2,3,4,5. During this task, the researchers were observing what was going on inside the LLM’s many layers of artificial neural networks.

For a long time, these layers have remained largely impenetrable. But what surprised the researchers when they parsed through the layers as the model counted the sequence of five numbers was that different words kept popping up in the layers underneath. ‘Countdown’ was one such word. Then midway through the output, the word ‘halfway’ appeared. After the model produced the number five, it said nothing else to the researchers, but the word ‘done’ appeared in its neural layers.

This can be likened to an internal thought process, words that were related to Claude’s eventual outputs but were not visible to the user.

Seth is clear in his view that biological traits may be necessary to produce consciousness. And we’re nowhere close to that. Anthropic said its J-space experiments do not show Claude can have experiences or feel things the way humans do, so that means there is no evidence of consciousness.

But the J-Space appears to support the functions associated with conscious access. It holds the thoughts Claude can report on, deliberately bring to mind, and reason with, while the rest of its processing runs automatically beneath.

“This work is just a first step in what we expect to be an extensive line of research. The J-space looks like a good candidate for the divide between consciously accessible and unconscious processing in a language model, but we’d be surprised if it’s the whole story... And there remain many mysteries about how the J-space works,” Anthropic said in its blogpost.

“We don’t know what mechanism decides what enters the J-space in the first place. We’ve seen hints that it’s tied to Claude’s sense of self, something like emotional reactions, and traces of metacognition, without exactly having worked out how. But we now have methods for tackling questions like these. As that work progresses, our understanding of LLM minds—and their relationship to our own—will grow clearer,” it added.

and others are building may well move the needle on the potential for consciousness. The reason is that, all else equal, the more similar our technologies are to real brains, the more plausible consciousness becomes. The challenge is that we don’t yet know what difference makes the difference,” Seth told *The Indian Express*.

The difference

So, what exactly does this step-by-step thinking on the backend look like? According to AI researcher Dave Bergmann, when a reasoning LLM shows you its reasoning steps, that output is the equivalent of someone thinking out loud. (In technical terms, it’s reasoning in the token space.)

“Imagine yourself cooking a simple meal and narrating every step out loud, like you are hosting a cooking show: how you know when the pan is hot enough, why you are adding salt after a quick taste test, how you’re cutting this vegetable and why. You’re still not saying every thought aloud. There’s a distinct inner monologue in your head that doesn’t get fully or faithfully

Thoughts?

Anthropic researchers asked the LLM to count to five and “introspect deeply”.



As the chatbot finished the task, words kept popping up in its neural layers underneath. ‘Countdown’ was one such word. Midway through the output, the word ‘halfway’ appeared.

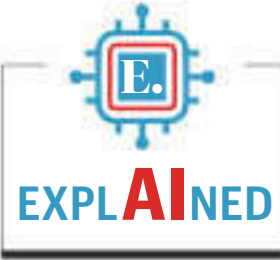
(LLMs) such as Claude, and can algorithms one day wake up and develop feelings? There are divergent answers.

Anil K Seth, Professor of Cognitive and Computational Neuroscience, University of Sussex and Director of the University’s Sussex Centre for Consciousness Science, said this is not really anywhere close. “I study consciousness, and I have my doubts,” Seth has maintained.

AI pioneer Geoffrey Hinton, meanwhile, has consistently said that chatbots have “subjective experience”, challenging the human belief in unique consciousness.

Does the kind of ‘biological computer’ that Australian startup Cortical Labs seems to be developing — a computer with

human neurons mounted on silicon — potentially hold greater promise than Claude’s most recent experiment in achieving some sort of sentence? “The kind of bio-hybrid computers that Cortical Labs



A weekly column decoding AI’s new frontiers, how they shape the world and our place in it

• **HEALTH**

What is postpartum psychosis, can it affect criminal responsibility?

Anagha Jayakumar
New Delhi, September 6

A CLOSELY watched legal case in the US, involving a mother killing her three children, was declared a mistrial last week. Lawyers defending Lindsay Clancy, 36, had argued that jurors should find her not guilty by reason of insanity, citing a condition known as postpartum psychosis for her actions.

With the jurors unable to reach a unanimous verdict, prosecutors could seek a retrial with a new jury.

What is the condition?

“A most basic description of psychosis is that someone is out of touch with reality,” Susan Hatters-Friedman, forensic and reproductive psychiatrist at Ohio’s Case Western University, told *The Indian Express*.

Postpartum psychosis is a state in which mothers who have recently given birth may experience delusions, hallucinations, irritable or depressed mood and insomnia, she added. Its symptoms can wax and wane quickly, but the condition is not synony-

mous with violent tendencies. Its cause remains unclear, but risk is higher among people with bipolar disorder, a previous episode of postpartum psychosis or other psychosis, and a family history of psychotic illness.

In comparison, postpartum depression is more common, Hatters-Friedman said, where mothers experience symptoms of depression.

Clancy’s symptoms reportedly included hallucinations following the birth of her third child. She also physically harmed herself after the killings.

But psychosis does not always mean that a person appears disorganised. “A lot of it comes down to how organised the person’s mind is in their state of psychosis, in any psychotic disorder (such as schizophrenia). For example, someone could still be hearing voices and experiencing delusions, but be able to plan behaviour,” Hatters-Friedman said.

She added that in her research and forensic experience, “altruistic” and “acutely psychotic” motives are the two most commonly found among mothers de-

The case

● Lindsay Clancy is accused of fatally strangling her three children — five-year-old Cora, three-year-old Dawson, and eight-month-old Callan — at the family’s home on January 24, 2023.

● The judge in her case declared a mistrial on September 4 after the jury was unable to reach a unanimous verdict. The court will now reconvene at the end of the month to decide what happens next.



Lindsay Clancy tried to harm herself too. AP

clared legally insane. The former involves a belief that killing is in the child’s best interests, while the latter refers to killings driven by psychosis without a clearly apparent motive.

When is it legally relevant?

A postpartum diagnosis does not automatically imply that a person is legally insane or not criminally responsible. In

Massachusetts, where the trial took place, the legal question is whether a defendant is criminally responsible under what is commonly called the insanity defence.

The burden of proving criminal responsibility “beyond a reasonable doubt” rests with the prosecution. It must establish either that the defendant had no mental disease or defect at the time of the offence, or retained substantial capacity to appreciate the wrongfulness of their conduct and conform it to the law.

Psychiatric experts can offer opinion on whether a defendant was experiencing psychosis based on evidence of their past behaviour, but the jury ultimately decides on criminal responsibility.

A lack of criminal responsibility does not imply an ordinary acquittal and release. In Massachusetts, a person found not guilty by reason of mental illness or defect may be ordered to undergo up to 40 days of observation and examination. The state may then seek a commitment order.

Hatters-Friedman said that a lack of awareness of the condition by the legal system and the public also affects such cases.

• **GEOPOLITICS**

Banque Misr sanctions: US widens economic war with Iran

Moinuddin Ahmad
New Delhi, September 6

EXPANDING THE scope of ‘Operation Economic Outcast’, the Secretary of the United States Department of Treasury, Scott Bessent, last month issued an order that identified the United Arab Emirates branches of Banque Misr—Egypt’s second-largest state-owned financial institution—as a body of “primary money laundering concern.” The Treasury claimed that the bank’s UAE operations were processing transactions for accounts linked to Iran’s shadow-banking networks.

The Treasury proposed invoking Special Measure Five under Section 311 of the USA PATRIOT Act, which allows the Secretary to target specific money laundering and terrorist financing risks. The move applies only to Banque Misr’s five branches in the UAE — its operations in Egypt and other countries are outside its scope.

What are the UAE branches accused of doing?

Since the primary US sanctions prohibit Iranian banks from accessing US dollars, Tehran uses multi-jurisdictional “shadow-banking” architectures to monetise export revenues (primarily petroleum and petrochemicals) and buy foreign goods. According to the US Treasury, the mechanism functions through layered commercial intermediaries.

The Iranian networks established shell companies registered in commercial hubs across the world, the US Treasury said. These firms posed as standard commercial entities engaging in food, consumer goods, or general commodities trade. The ultimate owners were tied to the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps, Iran’s Ministry of Defense and Armed Forces Logistics, and financial entities managing assets for the Supreme Leader.

The US Treasury’s Financial Crimes Enforcement

Network (FinCEN) found that front entities held accounts at Banque Misr UAE. When these entities initiated foreign exchange transfers in US dollars, Banque Misr UAE routed the instructions through its correspondent bank accounts in the US. Banque Misr UAE was found to have transacted about \$1.8 billion between January 2024 and June 2026 for 103 companies. Transactions worth \$520 million took place during the last 12 months, alleged the FinCEN.

• COMPOUNDING IRAN’S WOES

- Tehran is testing its endurance against severe domestic economic strain.
- Deprived of hard-currency inflows, the Iranian rial faces rapid devaluation, exacerbating hyperinflation and shrinking domestic consumer purchasing power. The US hopes that the fresh sanctions will force Iran to capitulate.

Why an Egyptian bank?

Tehran exploited key structural features of regional North African bank branches instead of attempting to bypass the heavy, AI-driven compliance systems of major Western banks in Dubai, the US says.

Banque Misr UAE is involved in routine trade finance and worker remittances. Iran-backed companies, posing as general traders, chose places like Dubai and Hong Kong because these cities are considered neutral hubs. Unlike major international banks that rely on advanced real-time ownership-tracing tools, smaller bank branches still use standard, static name-matching software. Hence, Iran worked with layered shell companies and proxy directors to bypass basic filters.

What will be the likely impact?

Financial institutions in the US are expected to end ties with Banque Misr UAE once the 30-day public consultation ends and the official rule is enacted. This will result in Banque Misr losing its capability to clear USD. Corporate account holders will also have to go for transactions in local dirhams (AED) or alternative foreign currencies.

Major international institutions, including JPMorgan Chase, Citigroup, and Deutsche Bank, are likely to tighten compliance oversight across Egypt’s financial system. These possible changes, in turn, can hike transaction fees and increase clearance time.

West Asian financial hubs like Dubai, Abu Dhabi, and Doha will remain vigilant. The Treasury action comes as a warning for many banks in the region. The move also comes as the first phase of what could be the future of US sanctions against overseas branches in allied states without penalising the parent institutions.

• **HISTORY**

Rajghat artefacts: A 1950s excavation sheds new light on Varanasi’s ancient past

Adrija Roychowdhury
New Delhi, September 6

THE BANARAS Hindu University (BHU) recently examined 22 boxes stored with it for around 70 years, containing more than 10,000 artefacts, including painted black pottery believed to be 3,000 years old. The artefacts were excavated from Rajghat, one of the oldest known settlements in the Varanasi region, between 1957 and 1969.

Earlier in August, experts had opened a box containing a human skeleton recovered from the same site.

Rajghat’s significance

Rajghat today refers to a neighbourhood located in eastern Varanasi. But the Rajghat archaeological site refers to the ancient settlement located on the north-eastern outskirts of the city, near the confluence of the rivers Ganga and Varana.

Archaeologist and former professor of archaeology at BHU, Vidula Jaiswal, explained that Rajghat is identified as the

capital of the Kashi Janapada. Janapadas were territorial kingdoms or political units in ancient India, particularly during the later Vedic period. Some of these janapadas grew into larger, more powerful kingdoms known as mahajanapadas by the 6th century BCE. Early Buddhist and Jain texts mention Kashi as one of 16 mahajanapadas in the Indo-Gangetic plain.

The region of Kashi, more popularly known as Varanasi, is dotted with several ancient settlements. A number of them have been excavated in the last few decades, which includes Aktha, Ramnagar, Sarnath and Rajghat. Jaiswal, who has led excavations at eight sites in the region, concluded that while Sarnath emerged as a pilgrimage site, Rajghat developed as the main urban centre.

Excavations at Rajghat

The settlement at Rajghat first came to archaeological attention in 1940, when a railway contractor reported finding archaeological remains while excavating earth for



A storage jar from the Gupta period. BHU

the extension and remodelling of Kashi Railway Station. The archaeologist Krishna Deva then took up trial excavation of the site on behalf of the Archaeological Survey of

India (ASI) in October-November of the year. Consequently, excavations were carried out at three mounds at Rajghat in 1957 by A K Narain and his colleagues from BHU’s Department of Ancient Indian History, Culture and Archaeology. Conducted in four phases over 12 years, the excavations unearthed a large number of significant artefacts. The lowest, and therefore oldest, layer of the settlement yielded pre-Northern Black Polished Ware (pre-NBPW), a type of pottery associated with an earlier phase of the Iron Age.

Based on this evidence, the origins of the settlement at Rajghat were dated to around 800 BCE.

Several years later, in the early 2000s, Jaiswal and archaeologist B R Mani re-excavated Rajghat to verify the dating of its oldest layer. “We just dug the lower levels of the site, starting from the Kushana period (1st century BCE to 3rd century CE), and kept going further down,” Jaiswal said.

Scientific analysis of the artefacts recovered from these layers subsequently

confirmed the date of the settlement’s oldest layer as around 800 BCE.

Among the artefacts recovered from the site are hundreds of seals and sealings. Professor Prasad Ahirwar, head of the department at BHU, said that the seals are the most important artefacts from Rajghat. “Many of them carry Greek inscriptions. Several of them carry names of the administrative units and their officials,” he said. That apart, ivory and iron objects, punch-marked coins, and terracotta figurines have also been found.

The significance of these finds, said Ahirwar, is in tracing the development of human civilisation in the subcontinent.

Centenary celebrations

The recent documentation of the Rajghat artefacts, said Ahirwar, is part of the centenary celebrations of his department at BHU. The idea was to preserve all the past work that the department has done over the last 100 years, and lay them out in the public domain for future generations

of researchers. “There are also plans for developing a museum in future,” Ahirwar said.

The documentation, which started from January this year, has already recorded about 4,000 artefacts. Ahirwar believes that there are close to 10,000 objects from Rajghat alone.

He also pointed out that the Rajghat excavation reports are already in the public domain and the artefacts have been available to researchers all these years. Some researchers have also studied the material. However, this is the first concerted and organised effort to document all the findings.

The human skeleton is the only artefact that has been opened for the first time. “When Professor Narain excavated it in the 1960s, we did not have the technology to analyse human remains,” said Ahirwar. With advances in techniques such as DNA sampling and analysis, he believes the skeleton could now yield more information about the age, ancestry and lifestyle of the people who lived in the region in antiquity.

WHY CHRISTOPHER COOTER

About three years ago, Canadian PM Justin Trudeau's allegation of 'potential' involvement of Indian government agents in the killing of pro-Khalistan separatist Hardeep Singh Nijjar — a charge India rejected as 'absurd' and 'motivated' — had derailed ties between India and Canada. In June last year, the two countries hit the reset button and announced new envoys. Canadian High Commissioner to India, Christopher Cooter, has worked on repairing the relationship which led to PM Mark Carney's visit. He is best placed to explain the transformation in equations, Delhi's security concerns, cooperation in energy, education, visas, the West Asia war and ties with the US

Shubhajit Roy: It has been almost three years since your former Prime Minister, Justin Trudeau, levelled allegations of Indian involvement in the killing of what our government views as a pro-Khalistan separatist, Hardeep Singh Nijjar. Why did he do that? Could you give a sense of the journey from there to now.

About that turbulent period, there was a killing in Canada. There is now a judicial process around that and arrests were made. It's before the courts, and we'll see what justice decides in the end. But more broadly, between the two countries, there was an absence of trust, which really broke down at the official level. Over the last year, there has been a rebuilding of that trust. You see it in the four meetings that the two PMs have had over the last year. You see it in the relationship we now have between security officials who met. They were in regular contact in the kind of practical things they do together now, so that they understand each other and we don't surprise each other with statements or events. We've taken a lot of steps to address the security concerns, first and foremost of Canadians, but they also speak to some of your security concerns. We've listed the Bishnoi gang as a terrorist entity, launched a financial crimes commission, we have the Indian community in Canada under threat of extortion from some of these gangs, and so a lot of work has been done by our police. There is now a good deal of cooperation between the two countries in dealing with these kinds of issues. We want to build something that we've never had before with India, and our Prime Minister is committed to it. I think Prime Minister Modi is equally committed.

Shubhajit Roy: Moving forward, have you been able to insulate the bilateral political diplomatic relationship from the trial and the investigations into the killing of Nijjar and other such activities in Canada?

Yes, we all recognise that things can happen. There are people out there who do not want this relationship to be a success, who promote a negative agenda between the two countries. That's what happened in the past. It could happen again in the future. There could be some unexpected event. So what we've done by these institutional linkages is to try to insulate. It's not to put it to one side but to address it in a manner in which we have a productive outcome, where we can anticipate problems and deal with them. There is remarkable progress in the last few months in getting to a place which we've never really been in before.

Shubhajit Roy: What is the different approach adopted by PM Carney as compared to PM Trudeau?

It is not just with respect to India. We will maintain our principles, of course, but we will be pragmatic. We will not take things off the table just because we don't agree with the way people are doing things. We will talk to everyone. And that has worked very much in the favour of improving the relationship. In the uncertain world that we now live in with respect to trade relationships, our PM, who has a strong economic background, having been the bank governor of both Canada, and of England, comes forward with a very strong economic pitch that we need to build our ties with. We need to, in a way, almost rebuild Canada. And as we do this, India is a key player on the global scene. So there's a recognition that we need to work with India. We also have this very large diaspora; it's almost two million people in Canada. One of the things I was struck by in India is that sense of relief that Canada and India had come back together again. There was an emotional piece to this, not just about security but a feeling that how could this happen — we're family. We are rebuilding that emotional connection at an individual as well as a collective level. We are at different places in development, different speeds, different needs in our economies, but there's an interesting relationship that just happens to work very, very well right now.

Shubhajit Roy: Amid the energy crisis and energy insecurity, how does Canada look at this war in West Asia and how can Canada and India cooperate in energy collaboration?

The crisis, the war in the Gulf, the Ukraine war, and even Covid, they've all been highly disruptive. The lessons we are taking away are that we need to have fewer eggs in one basket, more resilience and more redundancy. Of course, we all hope these wars end as soon as possible. I know that you've got 10 million people in the Gulf, with a lot at stake in that region. But if you look at Canada, what we offer is a reliable partner in energy, probably more than any other country in the world. We like to think of ourselves as an energy superpower. We are number four in oil reserves and production, number five in natural gas production, number five in LPG production, and number six in nuclear power. We also have all the critical minerals that go into the green transition: rare earths, lithium, graphite and so on. So what we offer is stability and an enormous variety of energy sources. We've got fossil fuels, transition fuels, and the technology to make those transition fuels work, like batteries, which we're producing in large numbers. We have a long history in nuclear power. When the PM was here, there was a sale of \$2.3 billion of uranium for your reactors. But beyond nu-



ON BRIDGING TRUST DEFICIT

'There was an absence of trust, which really broke down at the official level... There is remarkable progress in the last few months in getting to a place in which we've never really been before'



ON DEFENCE COOPERATION

'We've just agreed with the Europeans to develop 12 submarines. But what we lack is scale. As we grow together, we're hopeful our industries can work together to protect both countries, while giving us access to world market'

Indian side has expressed concern about the political space given to separatist elements in Canada. How seriously has the current dispensation taken those concerns?

It's a democracy; people have a right to express themselves. We may not agree with them, but we do have to maintain that respect for the right of people to express their views, whether we like them or not. I think if you look at the report of our intelligence agency that was tabled before Parliament a few weeks ago, you'll see a tone that's a bit different. It talks about Khalistan actors. It talks about the Air India bombing, which we've commemorated. We are looking at that issue seriously, and the primary driver is never going to be about what another country thinks about it. It's going to be what protects our citizens. The Air India bombing killed a great many Canadian citizens, and I think that our agencies are aware of the risks.

Amrita Nayak Dutta: After March, when the maritime security partnership was announced, which also covered defence material cooperation, how has it progressed and what are the key things that you're looking at in that particular domain?

So, in the maritime, as we have in the joint statement that the two PMs agreed to, they foresee a defence dialogue to take place. We also would like to see our private sectors work together. We are ramping up rapidly on defence spending. About \$180 billion of that will be in procurement. I mentioned the \$500 billion between now and 2035, and the rest will be on dual-use infrastructure. It's a huge increase for Canada. So what we hope is that the companies on both sides will be able to work together. We're also working on what we call a joint security of information agreement that allows them to have a framework for sharing sensitive information. We've got expertise in areas like optics, for example. We're ramping up there because with climate change the Arctic zone is becoming more accessible to other countries and we have a big piece of real estate up there. So we're concerned about that area. We've just agreed with our European friends to develop 12 submarines for Canadian use. But what we lack is scale. We only have 42 million people, and defence products can be extremely expensive. As we grow together, we are hopeful that we can find areas where this makes a lot of sense for our industries to work together to produce something that is to protect both of our countries, but potentially gives us access to the world market.

Saptarshi Basak: PM Carney became an international superstar with his speech in Davos. Canada is the first US ally to directly resist the US. Why do we see this from Canada and Carney and not from, say, the Europeans?

As the PM said, the cumulative effect of a number of decisions, including something we gave at the last minute, resulted in him having to pull back on the trade talks. So it wasn't done in any way as performance art. It was done because it was the only decision we could take at this point. How others in the EU react to the US: everybody has their own calculation of what makes sense. At the end of the day, though, we want a great relationship with the US, whether it's in defence, economics, culture, and so on. Many people, particularly in the US, find it rather bizarre that we're in this position.

As for the Davos speech, in the world today, it's not the simpler world of 1945. The world has evolved a lot, so there are a lot of powers who want to be more active in the world. They've got the capacity to do it, they've got the population, and they have a legitimate role to play. So when we talk about what he said, variable geometry and so on, regardless of the US or other larger powers, there is a lot of scope for countries to work together. In that Davos speech, it's not simply a reaction to, as he called them, the hegemon. He also said the old order wasn't entirely honest. We haven't yet constructed a new one. Those of us who can rely on other orders when it comes to trade pacts or other deals should work together, to protect each other's sovereignty.

Shubhajit Roy: There are 4,00,000 students in Canada besides the diaspora. Visas have been a big concern for many Indians. How are you trying to fix that?

We did have some problems over the last few years, where in some cases there were so many students coming, not just from India, but so many international students that there wasn't enough housing. There were also fly-by-night colleges that were not really giving an education. We've tightened the rules, and the goal is to make sure that Indian students coming to Canada, or any students coming, have a great educational experience. They come away well-trained, properly housed, with an excellent education at a good price point. We've made a lot of progress in the last couple of years. We did impose caps because the numbers were growing more than we could handle. One unintended consequence was that the reputation of Canada in India was that it was somehow closed to students. Nothing could be further from the truth. We would like to see more Indians coming for tourism. We know we have to get the visa system working better, and we are looking at that very seriously now.

Christopher Cooter, Canadian High Commissioner to India, on a new chapter in India-Canada relations, expanding trade and navigating a changing world. The conversation was moderated by Shubhajit Roy, Diplomatic Editor, *The Indian Express*



Canadian High Commissioner Christopher Cooter (right) in conversation with Shubhajit Roy, Diplomatic Editor, *The Indian Express* RENUKA PURI

clear, we've never sold you oil, gas, or LPG. Those are all huge now in Canada, and the infrastructure to deliver them to you has improved enormously. By 2030, we'll be able to export 50 million tonnes of natural gas through our West Coast ports. We'll have a 400 per cent increase in our ability to export LPG. We have a pipeline exporting oil from the West Coast that, with a few tweaks, will be able to export about a million barrels. But we just announced another pipeline, allowing us to export two million barrels. We produce between five and six million barrels a day. Interestingly, you import about that amount per day, so we will have the capacity to supply a significant amount. If you've had difficulties with supply from the Gulf, suddenly Canada appears as exciting. On nuclear, we just announced a new nuclear policy, looking forward to producing up to 10 more reactors in Canada. That policy is focused on working with countries abroad on building their nuclear capacity. Eighteen of your 24 existing reactors are based on CANDU reactors, the Canadian technology. So as your energy needs grow and are distributed — for example, your PM spoke about the full electrification of your railway system — that takes a lot of power. Could that be something that a small modular reactor would be able to power? There is lots of interest in that field.

Shubhajit Roy: The other major takeaway from PM Carney's visit in March this year was the speeding up of negotiations to conclude a trade agreement — the CEPA (Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement), by the end of the year. What are the issues and challenges? Are you confident it will be wrapped up by the end of the year?

I'm very confident that it will go forward. Both PMs have expressed their commitment several times. We like free trade agreements, good ones that work for us. We've done a number of them in the last year, giving us access to about one and a half billion people, and we expect we can even double that

amount. We did one in 47 days with the UAE recently. We took, unfortunately, 12 years the last time we tried negotiating with you and didn't get very far. That isn't going to happen this time. I'm confident that we're going to get this done soon.

There are two things that a trade agreement should achieve. One is that it increases the ease of doing business through the removal of tariffs. But the other is that it demonstrates that both countries are open to business. We also have a large trade delegation coming in October. There are other pieces to the economic equation that we're working on hard as well. When all these start to come to fruition, you'll see our overall economic relationship in a much stronger place. The two PMs committed to double trade by 2030. That sounds ambitious, but our trade is nowhere near where it should be. Even a few large agreements on energy or critical minerals could easily double or even triple. I think we should be even more ambitious and look beyond 2030. Where do we want to be for Viksit Bharat? That is probably the long-range frame that we need to think about. If you look at things like critical min-



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erals and opening a mine on a mineral like tungsten, we have 20 per cent of the world's reserves, that's important for defence, auto, and so on. We don't have a single active mine. So to get to the place where we have a mine, we need three to five years. So a lot of areas need some time to ripen. It fits so well with the Canadian economy, potential and our resources, human and natural. It fits so well with the way that your economy is growing that it's hard to imagine that we would not have a much bigger economic relationship, which the free trade agreement will facilitate.

Shubhajit Roy: US President Trump has taken a much more hardline approach with Canada, calling it the 51st state and almost berating the Canadians and the government. How do you view this to play out?

We are disappointed. And the PM said that we had to walk away from the talks because the demands at the end were just beyond what we could possibly meet, and they went beyond normal trade talks. The 51st state dimension, imposition on our cul-

ON CANADA'S CHINA TIES VIS-A-VIS INDIA

'There is always going to be an important Canadian-Chinese relationship. It will be different from the one that we have with you, different in quality and character'



tural sovereignty... Efforts to strain our ability to have free trade agreements with other countries. These were impositions that we couldn't accept. The US will always be an incredibly important partner for us: culturally, people-to-people, economic ties. That's a geographic and political reality. We'll find our way through this. But in parallel, diversification and building Canada stronger is not plan B; it's plan A. So, we are investing heavily into our own economy and resources. So, if the Americans think that we're going to just roll over because we don't have resources, they miscalculated. We really like Americans. We look like them, talk like them, all the rest of it. But we are going to protect that sovereignty. The talks have broken down, as you know, tariffs will be imposed on the Americans dollar for dollar, but we will do what's in the best interest of Canada.

Shubhajit Roy: On Canada's relationship with China, PM Carney reached out to President Xi. Given India's own complicated relationship with China, how do you view Canada's relationship with Beijing?

PM Carney was in China before he came to India. His foreign policy is based on pragmatism. As with India, we also have a very large diaspora from China in Canada and the economic relationship with Canada is very large. It's much bigger than the one we have with India and a lot of Canadian jobs are at stake in that relationship. So, he was determined to put that back on an even keel, which we've now done. We do see India and China as different kinds of countries. You're a democracy, a federal country. We share a language. We share a legal history, so that makes it easier for us to do business in some ways. Insurance, banking, all those kinds of things are founded in similar laws. There is always going to be an important Canadian-Chinese relationship. It will be different from the one that we have with you, different in quality and character.

Divya A: On a number of occasions the

{ W E E K L Y C A P S U L E }

Tea for stronger bones

FOLLOWING 10,000 older women for 10 years, researchers at Flinders University have found that tea drinking was associated with slightly higher hip bone density. Moderate coffee consumption didn't appear harmful but drinking more than five cups a day was linked to lower bone density. The findings suggest tea may offer a small bone-health boost, while excessive coffee could carry some drawbacks. Women with higher lifetime alcohol consumption experienced stronger negative effects associated with coffee, while the apparent benefits of tea were more pronounced among women with obesity.



Mindfulness may lower BP

SIMPLE PRACTICES such as mindfulness, gratitude journaling and optimism training may improve several markers of cardiovascular health within eight weeks. A recent study by the University of Illinois found that these positive psychology interventions were consistently associated with improvements in blood pressure, inflammation and other heart disease risk factors. Because some of the benefits appeared to be connected with healthier behaviours, like better eating habits and increased physical activity, the researchers said continued reinforcement may be necessary to maintain progress over time.



Sweeteners impact generations

TWO WIDELY used zero-calorie sweeteners, sucralose and stevia, may have effects that linger far longer than the sweet taste itself. Researchers at the Universidad de Chile found that both sweeteners altered the gut microbiome in mice, reduced beneficial compounds produced by gut bacteria and changed the activity of genes involved in metabolism and inflammation. Some of those changes were seen in later generations that had never consumed the sweeteners themselves. Among first-generation offspring, signs of impaired glucose tolerance appeared in males.



New sleep apnea pill

ONCE-NIGHTLY oral medication significantly improved obstructive sleep apnea (OSA) in a large Phase III clinical trial at the 2026 ATS International Conference. The drug, known as AD109, is designed to treat OSA by targeting the neuromuscular problems that contribute to airway collapse during sleep. More than 40 per cent improved enough to move into a less severe OSA category, while 18 per cent achieved complete disease control. By strengthening the muscles that keep the airway open during sleep, AD109 could offer a new option for people unable to tolerate CPAP.



Neighbourhood shapes heart health

WHERE A person lives during early adulthood may influence their heart health decades later. A recent study by Northwestern Medicine researchers found that people exposed to more unfavourable neighbourhood social conditions when they were young adults had a greater likelihood of developing coronary artery calcification by midlife. This is a key marker of early cardiovascular disease. The measure incorporates socio-economic conditions, access to food, opportunities for physical activity and local crime rates. Researchers are now probing if these impact myocardial infarction and heart failure.



SUGAR-FREE LIFE

DR MOHAN

CHAIRMAN, DR MOHAN'S DIABETES SPECIALITIES CENTRE, CHENNAI

Why does blood sugar rise during a flu infection?

Know which flu remedies to avoid and how vaccination can help

A PATIENT arrived at my clinic with classic flu symptoms — fever, cough, body aches and overwhelming tiredness. But there was one thing that worried him more than the flu itself: his blood sugar had suddenly gone much higher than usual, even though he had barely eaten. For people living with diabetes, this is an important concern. Influenza can be more serious because infections can make blood sugar harder to control and increase the risk of complications. The good news is that being prepared, monitoring your health closely and seeking help early can make a big difference.

When the flu sends blood sugar soaring

It may seem surprising that blood sugar can rise when you are eating less. But during an infection, the body releases stress hormones to help fight the illness. These hormones can raise blood glucose levels. That is why it is important to check your blood sugar more often than usual when you have the flu, following your doctor's sick-day plan. Keep a record of your readings and contact your doctor if your levels remain much higher or lower than normal. A poor appetite can make people wonder whether they should stop their diabetes medicines. The answer is: not without speaking to your doctor. What happens to your medication during an illness depends on the medicines you take, your blood sugar readings, and how well you are eating and drinking. Some medicines may need to be adjusted while you are unwell, but these changes should be made with medical guidance.

No appetite? Focus on fluids first

When the flu takes away your appetite, you do not need to force yourself to eat large meals. Small portions of foods you can tolerate may be easier. Fluids, however, are especially important. Take frequent sips of water or other suitable drinks to stay hydrated. Dehydration can make blood sugar management more difficult and may add to the strain caused by the infection.

That cold medicine isn't always as harmless as it looks

A quick trip to the pharmacy for an over-the-counter cold or flu medicine may seem harmless, but not every product is suitable for someone with diabetes. Some cold and flu medicines contain ingredients that can affect blood sugar or interact with other medicines you may already be taking. Check with your doctor before starting an over-the-counter remedy.

Could an antiviral help you recover sooner?

People with diabetes are considered to be at a higher risk of complications from influenza. So antiviral treatment may be recommended in some cases. Timing matters. Antiviral medicines work best when started early, so if flu symptoms have just appeared, speak to your doctor promptly. They can assess your symptoms and decide whether antiviral treatment is appropriate. Most cases of flu can be managed with appropriate care, but certain warning signs should never be ignored. Seek medical attention promptly if you develop difficulty breathing, chest pain, severe weakness, confusion, persistent vomiting, signs of dehydration, or very high or very low blood sugar. If unable to keep fluids down, do not wait for the situation to get worse. People with diabetes are always more vulnerable.

Why the flu shot should be on your diabetes checklist

One common misconception is that a flu vaccination is mainly important in colder countries. That is not the case. Influenza also circulates in India, and people with diabetes can be at a greater risk of complications. The flu vaccine also does not provide lifelong protection. Influenza viruses continually change, and vaccines are updated periodically to protect against strains expected to circulate. Seasonal flu vaccination should, therefore, be taken as recommended rather than assuming that one dose is enough for life.

There is another vaccine people with diabetes should discuss with their doctor: the pneumococcal vaccine. Diabetes can make people more vulnerable to serious infections such as pneumonia. Unlike the flu vaccine, pneumococcal vaccination is not generally required every year. Depending on the vaccine and your individual health profile, it may be given once and repeated only after several years if recommended.

Managing flu is not only about knowing what to do after you fall sick. Prevention matters too. Along with vaccination, simple habits can lower your risk: wash your hands regularly, avoid close contact with people who are sick, cover your mouth and nose when coughing or sneezing, and stay home when you are unwell. Having diabetes does not mean you need to fear the flu. You need to be a little more prepared.

Unnoticed for years, they realised they had ADHD as adults

Anxiety, burnout, procrastination or emotional struggles? Experts explain why symptoms are often missed in childhood, how ADHD presents differently in adults and what can help

Reva Thakkar

FOR NINE years, Yukta thought she had anxiety issues. The 37-year-old aerospace engineer had been in sessions with multiple therapists, struggling with anxiety so severe that she could not appear for exams, interviews or other crucial situations. At times, she even attempted self-harm. Yet there was another pattern running through her life that neither she nor the people around her had recognised.

She had undiagnosed Attention-Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD), a neurodevelopmental condition that affects how a person regulates attention, impulses, physical activity and often executive functions, such as planning and organising. Those with the condition have difficulty focussing, particularly when a task is repetitive or uninteresting, while being capable of very intense concentration when something is engaging. It begins in childhood and is detectable at that stage in most but sometimes remains masked.

As a child, Yukta was good at academics and participated in extracurricular activities. She was not the distracted, disruptive child one normally associates with ADHD. "But I did struggle with procrastination, anxiety and emotional dysregulation." This distinction is at the heart of a crucial question that's increasingly being asked as more adults are diagnosed with ADHD. Can one develop ADHD as an adult? No. All that happens is that the props that helped the person manage it in younger years may simply have disappeared, triggering behavioural symptoms. As Dr Jyoti Sangle, a Mumbai-based psychiatrist specialising in neurodivergence, says, "Unmasked, unrecognised ADHD during childhood does lead to a lot of behavioural problems and emotional dysregulation in adulthood. This results in personality disorders, relationship issues and substance abuse. Diagnosing ADHD retrospectively is common indeed."

A 2025 systematic review in the *Journal of Indian Association for Child and Adolescent Mental Health*, pooling 24 Indian studies, found community and population-based prevalence ranging from 5.5 per cent in Chandigarh to 23.3 per cent in Punjab, with mid-range estimates of 14 per cent in Delhi-NCR and 15.9 per cent in Ujjain. Across these community studies, the inattentive subtype was consistently dominant — in the Delhi-NCR sample, nearly two-thirds of ADHD cases fell into this more easily missed category. In clinical and substance-use populations, prevalence climbed far higher still, 18 per cent to 62 per cent, where ADHD is often only caught while treating something else entirely.

Signs and symptoms people don't recognise

The popular image of ADHD is still largely that of a child who cannot sit still in class. But ADHD has three broad presentations: predominantly inattentive, predominantly hyperactive or impulsive, and combined. As people grow older, the outward signs of hyperactivity can become less obvious. Inattention, restlessness, impulsivity and difficulties with executive functioning can remain. For an adult, that can mean chronic procrastination, poor time management, difficulty organising tasks, losing track of things, struggling to start or finish work, or repeatedly pushing themselves into exhaustion.

That was closer to Yukta's experience than the stereotype. "Burnout happens and then I rest for a bit, recover and the cycle just repeats," she says. Aishwarya, a 31-year-old doctor, did well academically as a child. Her difficulties became more apparent as the demands of studying increased, particularly while preparing for her NEET undergraduate and postgraduate examinations.

One reason ADHD goes unnoticed in childhood is because it does not always demand the same kind of self-management as adulthood. The school provides timetables, reminders and fixed deadlines. Parents supervise homework, meals and sleep. Teachers may notice when an assignment

How can one recognise adult ADHD?

● Recognising ADHD in adults means looking past the stereotype of childhood hyperactivity that ADHD is usually associated with. In grown-ups, restlessness often shows up internally — racing thoughts, inner agitation or fidgeting — rather than visible overactivity. Watch for chronic difficulty focussing or finishing tasks, frequent disorganisation, poor time management, and habitually losing or misplacing things. Impulsiveness is another hallmark, appearing as interrupting others, impulsive spending or risky decision-making. Many adults also struggle with mood swings, low frustration tolerance, quick tempers and trouble multi-tasking or prioritising when everything feels equally pressing.

● These difficulties typically ripple outward, straining relationships, careers and self-esteem, and often co-exist with anxiety or depression, which can mask or mimic ADHD and complicate diagnosis. The key distinction from everyday forgetfulness or distraction is persistence and severity: true ADHD symptoms last at least six months, affect multiple areas of life and usually trace back to childhood, even if unnoticed then.

● Because self-assessment can't confirm a diagnosis, anyone recognising these patterns should seek evaluation from a psychiatrist, psychologist or a mental health professional, preferably experienced with adult ADHD.

is missing. A capable child can compensate for symptoms. "It is only when they grow into adults and see their daily life interrupted and become dysfunctional that they come to us for diagnosis," says Dr Nimesh Desai, former faculty, NIMHANS, Bengaluru. The US National Institute of Mental Health notes that some adults manifest symptoms when they encounter work life challenges, experience stress, serious life events, hormonal shifts and surrender to a poor diet-sleep-sedentary lifestyle.

What changes with age is not the underlying wiring but its presentation. Hyperactivity, Dr John Vijaysagar, additional professor at NIMHANS' Department of Child and Adolescent Psychiatry, notes, "tends to visibly reduce as children become adults but impulsivity and, crucially, emotional regulation, often do not resolve the same way." Adults frequently develop what look like new struggles but are in fact old ones wearing office clothes: missed deadlines, chronic postponement, difficulty finishing what you start or difficulty starting anything in the first place.

The hidden bias

Gender can also affect who gets noticed. Dr Vijaysagar says awareness has increased around ADHD in girls and women, who may have been overlooked when clinicians and families were looking primarily for hyperactivity. Access to diagnosis is unequal in other ways too. Yashna Vishwanathan, a teacher at TISS and a development professional and therapist working at the intersection of disability and neurodiversity, points out that an urban, middle-class child may have teachers who raise concerns and families who can pursue assessment. "But a child from a rural or marginalised background may instead be labelled lazy, difficult, uninterested or indisciplined. The result is a generation of adults who may arrive at a diagnosis only after years of compensating," she says.

When ADHD looks like something else

Sometimes the problem is not that the symptoms were absent. It is that another symptom was louder. Yukta spent years being treated for anxiety. Aishwarya was diagnosed with bipolar depression at 26 and spent three years on medication before being diagnosed with ADHD at 30. She recalls significant physical side effects, including tremors, hair loss and a 12-kg weight gain. Ujjala, now 23, was initially diagnosed with anxiety and depression and later with borderline personality disorder. She event-



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ually began studying ADHD herself and raised the possibility with her psychologist. "After three years of therapy with the same clinical psychologist, I got my ADHD diagnosis," she says.

ADHD frequently co-occurs with other mental-health conditions, which can complicate assessment and treatment. Dr Vijaysagar cautions against treating every episode of inattention as ADHD. "Stress, sleep difficulties, anxiety, depression, burnout and other conditions can produce similar symptoms. A proper assessment, therefore, involves a developmental and psychiatric history, current functioning and, where possible, information about childhood behaviour and functioning," he says.

"ADHD frequently overlaps with either hypo or hypersensitivity to different sensory stimuli," says Dr Vijaysagar. For Aishwarya, it's hypersensitivity to bright lights. "I use warm lights and calm myself with plants," she says. Even seating has rules. During a period of acute distress, she recalls fixating on one specific chair at a specific café, refusing any other. "Sensitivity to sound and lights is very common in ADHD. These are environmental triggers," says Dr Sangle.

For 26-year-old marketing executive Rohan, darkness was the trigger: "It was like dialling up a sensory overload." That has faded with age but noise hasn't. "Jump scares in horror films do nothing to me. A door slamming shut does," he says. Traffic has the same effect; constant honking makes his "body tremble", which is why he wears noise-cancelling headphones and needs background noise to fall asleep. For Ujjala, food has to meet exact criteria, "I can't have chewy, solid food." Sleep requires an equally specific environment, one she's rarely able to find outside her own carefully arranged space.

How to manage ADHD?

There is no single strategy for managing adult ADHD. Clinical guidance supports a comprehensive approach that takes into account psychological, behavioural and occupational needs, as well as the person's preferences and other mental-health conditions. "Medication can be used when symptoms continue to cause significant impairment, while structured approaches like Cognitive Behavioural Therapy (CBT) can help adults develop skills around organisation, planning, attention, procrastination and emotional responses," says Dr Sangle.

For Yukta, therapy helped her recognise some of the basics she had been neglecting: sleep, nutritious food, exercise and spending time outdoors. "These do wonders for my

mental health," she says. Aishwarya has learnt to use curiosity and variety to hold her attention. Rohan, who was diagnosed after years of burnout, sleeplessness and social difficulties, has found a personal coping mechanism by starting a board games community in Navi Mumbai.

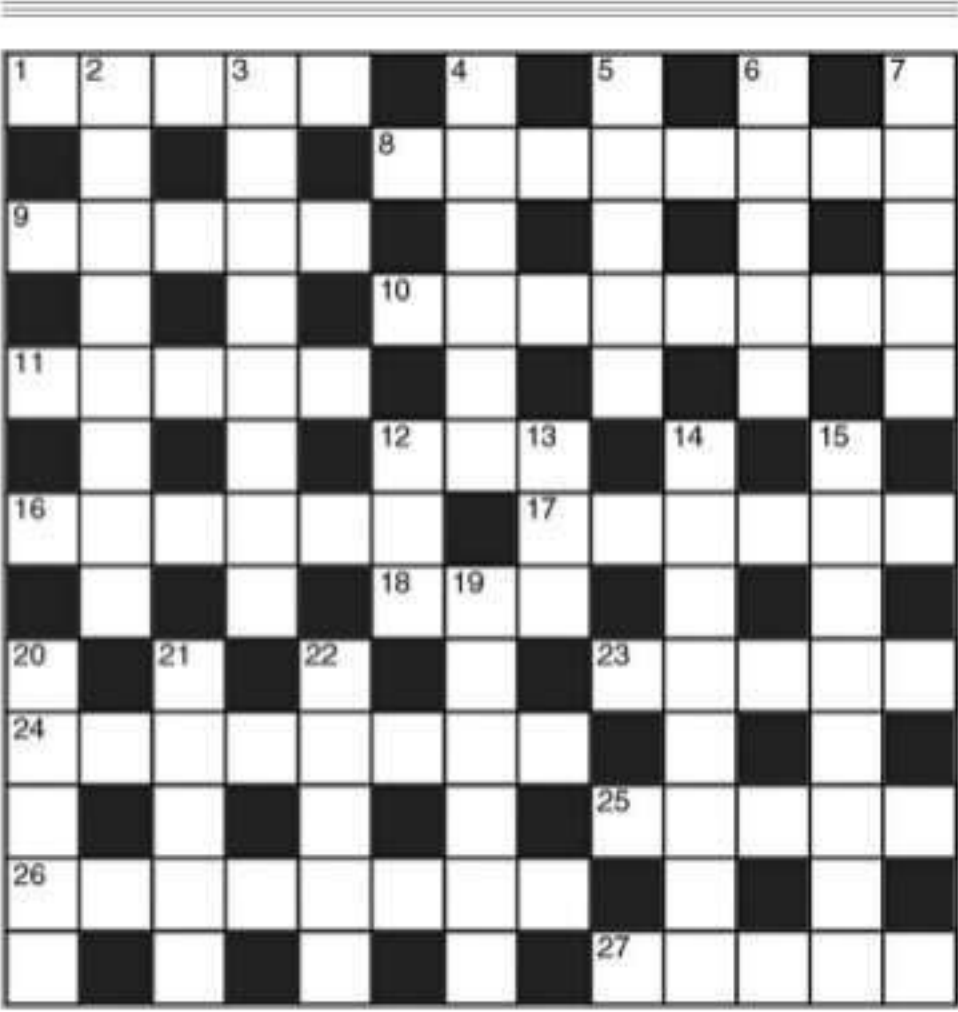
Dr Shaunak Ajinkya, psychiatrist at Kokilaben Dhirubhai Ambani Hospital, Mumbai, suggests psychoeducation in the early stages of therapy, where the patient is provided with extensive information about ADHD, including how it manifests and its neurobiological underpinnings. "This helps alleviate some of the patient's self-criticism. They are reassured that symptoms can be managed effectively with the right tools and strategies," he says. The patient is taught to break down large tasks into smaller, more manageable steps. "We use the Pomodoro technique, where the patient works for short intervals with breaks in between, helping them maintain focus and productivity. A daily planner and using a scheduling system helps them manage tasks. Sticky notes and visual cues are recommended at the workplace," he adds.

Mindfulness and role-playing exercises help curb the patient's tendency to interrupt conversations and act impulsively in social situations. "The patient is taught to recognise their cognitive distortions, such as 'all-or-nothing thinking', where they view tasks as either perfectly done or complete failures. They are taught to consider partial progress as a step forward rather than a failure. Patients are also persuaded to implement a system of rewards, where they allow themselves a small break or treat after completing a difficult task. These strategies make a significant difference. But if the manifestations are severe, then therapies must be complemented with medication," says Dr Ajinkya.

ADHD though is not only a story of difficulty. "Many people describe living with ADHD as having strengths like curiosity, spontaneity, energy, creative thinking, the ability to hyperfocus on an area of interest. These can be genuine strengths without romanticising ADHD or overlooking the challenges it creates," says Vishwanathan. But diagnosis can also make acceptance easier. "It made me realise who I am and start accepting myself rather than blaming myself, constantly questioning myself, or searching for answers to every simple and complex act of life or decision. That was healing, or perhaps liberation. At least now I'm aware of where I need to work instead of randomly fishing in the whole sea," says Sabid, 32, who spent years trying to fit in. Now he can anchor himself.

from the
OPD

CROSSWORD



ACROSS
1 Daughter and friend make trifle (5)
8 I stop wandering and I take on a job (8)
9 Clubs that place cruel restrictions on members? (5)
10 Type of book difficult to endorse (8)
11 Feel strung in getting what is in fashion (5)
12 To point but not with a finger (3)
16 I enter amended total (6)
17 A number in the arena competing in track events (6)
18 It can be pricked even after being pierced (3)
23 What one thinks about a bad side (5)
24 Command a slave to serve one first (8)
25 Brown ape is playing around (5)
26 Hearty leaders (8)
27 Present a degree (5)

DOWN
2 Bitterness shown by Army CO in trouble (8)
3 Bird to settle on a perch perhaps? (8)
4 One may appear at dinner in a jacket (6)
5 Woman of fifty-one had become unsettled (5)
6 Indian ruler; the last character in principal uprising (5)
7 This creeper could be poisonous (5)
12 Part of the eighteenth hole on the golf course (3)
13 Stray from the proper route (3)
14 Dictates one way to prove gold genuine (4,4)
15 Taking someone on of attractive disposition (8)
19 First and last letters to Rose out in Atlantic isles (6)
20 The best one to distribute (5)
21 Strike when times are bad (5)
22 Ranks as a creature of Carroll's imagination (5) down (5)

SOLUTIONS CROSSWORD 5752
ACROSS: 1 Above board, 6 Fare, 10 Defer, 11 Seventies, 12 Epidural, 13 Hello, 15 Climate, 17 Stripes, 19 Algiers, 21 Anemone, 22 Draft, 24 Napoleon, 27 Never fear, 28 Motto, 29 Will, 30 Wellington
DOWN: 1 Andy, 2 Offspring, 3 Erred, 4 Observe, 5 Revolts, 7 Ariel, 8 East of Suez, 9 In charge, 14 Ice and snow, 16 Aperture, 18 Photostat, 20 Sincere, 21 Apparel, 23 Anvil, 25 Lemon, 26 Goon

JUMBLD WORDS

Given below are four jumbled words. Solve the jumbles to make proper words and move them to the respective circles below. Select the letters in the shaded circles and jumble them to get the answer for the given quip. Always ____ your enemies; nothing annoys them so much. - Oscar Wilde (7)

GINER

GMZIO

DEIRFG

LOVERS

ANSWERS: Regin, G'zino, Fidge, Soler

Always ____ your enemies; nothing annoys them so much.

OVER THE HEDGE



CALVIN & HOBBS



MARVIN



DIFFICULTY LEVEL 1s INSTRUCTIONS

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every digit from 1 to 9 must appear in each of the nine vertical columns, in each of the nine horizontal rows and in each of the nine boxes.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL
1s = Very easy; 2s = Easy; 3s = Medium; 4s = Hard; 5s = Very Hard; 6s = Genius

SUDOKU 6434

8	4	2	3					
6	5		9	7		1		
	1	4				9	5	
9			2	8	4			
3						6		
	2	7	5				9	
3	7			4	9			
8		1	6				3	7
5				2	4	8		

SOLUTION SUDOKU 6433

4	5	2	9	6	7	3	8	1
7	1	6	5	8	3	4	9	2
9	8	3	4	2	1	6	5	7
2	4	9	3	7	5	1	6	8
6	7	1	8	9	4	5	2	3
8	3	5	2	1	6	9	7	4
3	9	4	7	5	2	8	1	6
5	6	7	1	4	8	2	3	9
1	2	8	6	3	9	7	4	5

SALUTE THE SOLDIER

GORKHA RIFLES

Indian Army and 11 Gorkha Rifles Salutes its brave heart, SS-39526 Late Capt A Joshi of 7/11 GR, who made supreme sacrifice during OP MEGHADOOT on 07 Sep 2002.

COLONEL 11 GR & SIKKIM SCOUTS AND ALL RANKS

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

HEAD CONSTABLE SANTOSH KUMAR SARKAR

76 BN BSF

21.08.1951 – 07.09.1990

Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Head Constable Santosh Kumar Sarkar on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries during a Counter terror Operation in Kupwara area, J&K and later succumbed to his injuries at Sector HQ hospital, Kupwara.

CENTRAL RESERVE POLICE FORCE

Veer Balidani Shri S. K. Mishra
Asst. Comdt.
19 BN
13-6-1951 To 7-9-1987

Veer Balidani Constable/Driver Jag Prasad
19 BN
1-8-1952 To 7-9-1987

Veer Balidani Constable Chandra Pal
19 BN
10-1-1966 To 7-9-1987

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to three valiant troopers of 19 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while bravely countering an ambush by terrorists on 7 September 1987 in Punjab. CRPF salutes the bravehearts and pledges never to let their sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani Sub Inspector A. N. Singh
66 Bn
1-6-1945 To 7-9-1990

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Sub Inspector A. N. Singh of 66 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice in a fierce encounter with terrorists on 7 September 1990 in Punjab. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Veer Balidani Constable Kamlesh Singh Yadav
92 Bn
20-12-1967 To 7-9-1994

DG and all Ranks of CRPF pay solemn tribute to Constable Kamlesh Singh Yadav of 92 Bn, who made the supreme sacrifice while countering an ambush by insurgents on 7 September 1994 in Tripura. CRPF salutes the braveheart and pledges never to let his sacrifice go in vain.

Classifieds

PERSONAL

I, Naman S/o Vijay Kumar R/o 206, Nekpur Sabtinagar, Modinagar, District- Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh - 201206 have changed my name to Naman Garg.

0071059073-1

I Sanjay Kumar S/O, Suresh Kumar R/o 958 Old Vijay Nagar Sector 9 Ghaziabad 201009 have changed my name to Sanjay Kumar Singh.

0040876844-1

I hitherto known as Komal D/o Parveen Kumar and W/o Jasbir Singh R/o H.No-8/2 F, Gali No.3, East Guru Angad Nagar, Shakar Pur Baramad, Shakarpur, Gandhi Nagar, East Delhi, Delhi-110092 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Aadrika Singh.

0040876898-1

I, Gagan S/o Chhinder Kumar, holder of Indian Passport no. V0915794, R/o Near Petrol Pump Vpo. Alawalpur, Jalandhar, Pin 144301, Punjab, India have changed my name Gagan and surname Gagan.

0040876836-1

I hitherto known as,SATYAM S/o YAGYA DUTT,R/o 13/488,BLOCK-13,Kalyan Puri, East Delhi,110091, have changed my name and shall hereafter be knownas SATYAM KARDAM.

0040876886-1

LOST & FOUND

To be known to all that, I Ashok Kumar S/o Late. Sh. Gulzari Lal R/o C-28, Peera garhi Relief Camp Delhi my Old Family photograph (attested) has been lost online FIR to this effect has been 31/08/2026 vide LR No. 593108/2026 0130068913-1

To be known to all that, I Ashok Kumar S/o Lt.Sh. Gulzari Lal R/o C-28, Peera garhi Relief Camp my brother's (Kewal Kishan) original Document i.e VoterId, Ration Card, Death Certificate has been lost An offline FIR effect on 20.05.2005 Vide LR no-7233/05 and online FIR to this effect has been 27/08/2026 vide LR No. 583347/2026 0130068912-1

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Company Petition No. 16 of 2019
e-AUCTION NOTICE

Pursuant to order dated 02.09.2026 passed by Hon'ble High Court of judicature at Allahabad, U.P. in Company Petition No. 16 of 2019, following immovable assets of M/s S. B. Petroleum Ltd. (In Liquidation) situated at Khnos No. 112, Village - Bhagwanpur, Pargana - Sarawan, Tehsil & District - Meerut will be put to sale on "as is where is and whatever there is basis" through e-auction.

Assets	Reserved Price (Rs.)	Earnest Money	Inspection Date & Time
Non agricultural Land measuring area 7662.87 Sqm. and building including Boundary Wall	9 Crore	90 Lakhs	22.09.2026 (11:00 AM to 5:00 PM)

Last date for submission of the E.M.D. 29.09.2026 upto 5:00 PM
The EMD amount (Interest free) should be deposited by way of RTGS in the account of Official Liquidator, U.P. EMD saving account 0012060101560179, Punjab National Bank, Civil Lines, Allahabad Branch Code 001200, IFSC Code PUNB0001200.
Date of bidding: 30.09.2026 up to 06:00 P.M.
This sale notice be treated as notice to the Secured and Unsecured Creditor/Contributors/Central & State Govt. Authorities/bodies, Stakeholders & all other parties having interest in the matter of company (in liquidation).
All the details along with terms and conditions of e-auction are available on portal <https://mcauctiontiger.net> of e-Procurement Technologies Limited (Auction Tiger) Ltd. For queries with regard to said e-auction contact no. (b) Gyan Prakash Mob-9265562818, (b) Aryan Vaghela, Mob- 9265562821, (b) Hardik Gadge, Mob-9374519754 (iv) Manik Shrivastava, Mob-9173528727. The details also available on www.mca.gov.in (website of Ministry of Corporate Affairs).

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BY MICHAEL FRY & T LEWIS

ROYAL STARS

BY GEORGIA NICOLS

ARIES (MAR 21 - APR 20): Hang in there. As this day progresses, it becomes more lighthearted and fun-loving. Admittedly, power struggles with a friend or a member of a group might squelch things. Be patient with kids. Basically, this is a friendly and productive day. Tonight: Be playful.

TAURUS (APR 21 - MAY 21): Home and family are your focus today, and you will be wise to avoid power struggles. Instead, seek out supportive, gentle interactions with others. Enjoy the company of children. Enjoy socialising. You're in the mood to teach. Tonight: Relax at home.

GEMINI (MAY 22 - JUNE 21): Like Taurus, home and family are a strong focus for you. Be very clear in all your communications with others. Note: Don't be demanding. Take a gentle approach. Tonight: Friendly discussions.

CANCER (JUNE 22 - JULY 23): The secret to this day is to surround yourself with kind, gentle, supportive people. Avoid ego battles about money and possessions, because you won't like it. However, with Mars in your sign, you can take care of yourself. Tonight: Check your money.

LEO (JULY 24 - AUG 23): After the Moon moves into your sign, things will tend to go your way if you align yourself with friendly, caring people. Avoid power struggles. You don't need this angst. Tonight: You win.

VIRGO (AUG 24 - SEP 23): Protect yourself today by avoiding emotional vampires and people who bring you down. You don't need this, especially today. On the other hand, you have a strong need to talk to someone so you can share your ideas. Tonight: Enjoy solitude.

LIBRA (SEP 24 - OCT 23): Today is a mixed bag when it comes to dealing with people. You might bump into power-hungry people who are too aggressive and off-putting. Or you might be lucky enough to find agreeable, sympathetic friends. Tonight: Be friendly.

SCORPIO (OCT 24 - NOV 23): Steer clear of power struggles with authority figures. Ironically, a boss or an authority figure might be sympathetic to you at work or with issues related to your health. Tonight: You're admired.

SAGITTARIUS (NOV 24 - DEC 22): This is a terrible day to get involved in controversial discussions. Instead, explore romantic connections, playful times with kids, socialising and the arts. Tonight: Explore and learn.

CAPRICORN (DEC 23 - JAN 20): Tread carefully with financial discussions today or talks about mortgages, loans or shared property, because you could reach an impasse with someone. However, a family member might be helpful. Tonight: Check your finances.

AQUARIUS (JAN 21 - FEB 19): Be your own best friend today and surround yourself with people who are friendly and supportive. Explore ideas that require imagination and a sympathetic resonance with your surroundings. Tonight: Listen and cooperate.

PISCES (FEB 20 - MAR 20): Work-related issues, as well as anything to do with health, could be challenging today. However, if you choose to be with generous, thoughtful people, it will be a whole different story. It's all about who you surround yourself with. Tonight: Get organised.

संचालनालय, आयुर्वेद योग एवं प्राकृतिक चिकित्सा, यूनानी, सिद्ध एवं होम्योपैथी, (आयुष) छत्तीसगढ़

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बी.एम.एस./बी.एम.एस./बी.एम.एस. पाठ्यक्रमों में सत्र 2026-27 में राज्य कोटे एवं निजी महाविद्यालयों के ऑल इंडिया कोटे की सीटों पर प्रवेश हेतु ऑनलाइन आवेदन सूचना

शैक्षणिक सत्र 2026-27 हेतु छत्तीसगढ़ राज्य के शासकीय एवं निजी आयुष महाविद्यालयों के बी.एम.एस./बी.एम.एस./बी.एम.एस. पाठ्यक्रमों में प्रवेश के लिए ऑनलाइन आवेदन आमंत्रित किये जाते हैं।
बी.एम.एस./बी.एम.एस. पाठ्यक्रम में प्रवेश हेतु उच्चतर माध्यमिक (10+2) परीक्षा (भौतिक शास्त्र, रसायन शास्त्र, जीव विज्ञान/बायोटेक्नोलॉजी तथा अंग्रेजी विषयों सहित) उत्तीर्ण एवं राष्ट्रीय पात्रता सह प्रवेश परीक्षा NEET (UG) 2026 में सम्मिलित, पात्र तथा इच्छुक अभ्यर्थी ऑनलाइन पंजीयन कर सकते हैं।
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Pathirage wins Diamond League final, first Sri Lankan to do so



Rumesh Pathirage . AP

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 6

WITH A throw of 89.04m, Rumesh Pathirage became the first Sri Lankan athlete to win a Diamond League title. The Javelin thrower also became only the fifth-ever Asian thrower to win the title across categories and only the second male thrower after Neeraj Chopra to achieve the same.

"I'm the first ever Sri Lankan to win the Diamond League Final and that makes me extremely proud," Pathirage said after the historic win.

Pathirage recorded three throws over 85m on the night to continue his dominant run on the circuit. He started with two underwhelming throws of 80.42m and 79.73m. In his third attempt, he surged to his usual best, recording 89.04m to take the lead. Poland's Dawid Wegner finished second with a new personal best of 87.47m, while world champion Keshorn Walcott took third with a season-best throw of 83.99m.

Breakthrough season

Pathirage, who is enjoying his breakthrough season and finished at the top position in most of the competitions he has played in, said that he could have done even better.

"I was really looking forward to compete in the Diamond League and I'm very happy that I've been rewarded with a win in the Final. I know that I could do much better than the 89.04 today, but the conditions were difficult. I'm used to much higher temperatures. I'll try to attack and take over the meeting record in the next few years," the Sri Lankan quipped after the win.

Last month, Pathirage made history by becoming only the fifth Javelin thrower to cross the 92m mark twice with a throw of 92.07m at the Zurich Diamond League. His dominance can be understood with these numbers: he holds the world lead with 92.62m, he is ranked number one in the world, he has won four out of five Diamond League meets, the Commonwealth Games gold and the Diamond League finale.

In the season top list in Javelin Throw, he has eight throws in top ten with the other belonging to Julian Weber. With another historic title in his kitty, Pathirage will look to become the first Sri Lankan thrower to win Asian Games title later in the month at Aichi-Nagoya, Japan.

In absence of former Olympic champion Neeraj Chopra, he is the favourite to win the title.

DRAGON SLAYERS

SatChi solve service, return issues to run out as winners in China

Indian duo comes from behind once again to beat home pairing He Ji Tung and Ren Xiang Yu after two lost finals earlier

Shivani Naik
Mumbai, September 6

MAYBE, IT was a 'Don't think of the white bear' episode for Satwiksairaj Rankireddy.

It's a psychological drill in which if one is told specifically to not think of a white bear, the mind thinks only of the white bear. Hence, one needs to unlearn fixating.

Around the start of 2024 heading into the Paris Olympics, the tall Satwik and Chirag Shetty realised their serves were being attacked viciously by flat-fast-playing opponents who focused solely on the first three shots. It cost the Indians three Tour finals. And the more he was told, the more tentative Satwik's return got.

On Sunday in Shenzhen, not only did Satwik-Chirag end a finals jinx in their third attempt - a charm, at the China Masters after having lost two finals. Satwik also, finally, seemed to have found confidence in handling the service "situation", which he now seems to have found a grip over. Their 11-21, 21-13, 21-17 victory over He Ji Tung and Ren Xiang Yu was a reaffirmation of what they have been working quietly on. Satwik picked five points in the decider solely based on his work at the net - on serve and later receiving.

His coaches - a cohort dedicated to keeping him happy and hopeful, as well as winning - might have considered not alerting him to the chink in the armour at all: psychology favours that. But the losses arising from the Indians getting cornered with frenzied ambushes on the first three strokes were piling up.



Satwiksairaj Rankireddy (L) and Chirag Shetty after they won the China Masters Super 750 on Sunday. BWF/BADMINTON PHOTO

Accustomed to winning titles relying on their steep attack, they were coping defeats. Chirag got down to problem-solving in his own meticulous way. But just as well that when injuries struck, Satwik too eased out of smashing mode and got down to work on the biomechanical part of the serve-receive problem, and is now in the happy zone where he knows it's a matter of backing his serve and feeling confident.

"It's very rare I get five points on my service. It's always Chirag who takes the game. But the quarterfinals against Astrup-Rasmussen gave us confidence," Satwik explained to BWF after the Indians won four three-game matches to emerge triumphant at the end of the week.

"It was the same scenario when we were down and then 17-all. I practised services a lot. When I was injured also, I practised serve and receive. It's helped in the last two tournaments. But it's just a feeling, mental thing - you need to believe your serve is good.

The Shenzhen Super 750 title was a coat of varnish on that chipped confidence, after a sandpaper of technical training had smoothened the edges.

There's been a lot of behind-the-scenes with the coach because opponents target me when I'm serving. We saw a lot of videos of people targeting me. They want to challenge me. In the third game, I was pretty calm. Even Chirag was telling me to stay calm saying, 'We're in control.' We didn't panic much. Just served and played according to the shuttle," he added.

Bouncing back

Plenty has taken its toll on Satwik's confidence. Losing a parent, the Olympics heartbreak, the trolling after the Thomas Cup bronze after he spoke of wanting to be ac-

knowledgeed. And the shoulder that doesn't let him hit a smash as he once could. All this week and in the final against the local pairing, Satwik and Chirag backed themselves to not get pushed into a corner. The Shenzhen Super 750 title was a coat of varnish on that chipped confidence, after a sandpaper of technical training had smoothened the edges.

The opponents were lower-ranked, but the Chinese came out swinging in all three games - 0-5, 1-3, 0-4 starts for the Indians as He-Ren went aggressive with deep pushes.

In the opener, the Chinese came at them with the doubles ambush of letting speed overwhelm everything else. Chirag explained, "In the first game, aggression wasn't lacking. But we weren't playing the right strokes. We were playing a style which favoured them. And then they come out all guns blazing. You don't really find space to play against them because they are extremely fast and furious. So in the second, we wanted to be aggressive but mindfully aggressive."

A 5-11 deficit just kept extending and the Indians found themselves a game down in no time.

The path back involved straight attacks both to avoid the drift and because the Indians found the precise lengths on tall parallels. The towering Chinese with their strong defence couldn't be bullied with a steep attack. But the straight hits adopted by Satwik-Chirag caught the Chinese flush as the match got levelled.

Once in the decider, the battling game whistled out like a train exiting a tunnel. The Satwik serve was on a roll.

The Chinese had a game plan that went beyond the fast parallels usually used against the Indians. But bisecting the Satwik-Chirag duo isn't sustainable when the Indians turn the tables on opponents using the same mid-line shelling to carve into the Chinese defence. Confidence in serve and reception did the rest.

The gnarly white bear was out of sight, out of mind, and out of the frame.

Odegaard winner dispatches Chelsea; Everton salvage draw

Reuters
London, September 6

ARSENAL PASSED their biggest test so far in the defence of their Premier League title in style as they hit back from conceding inside two minutes to beat Chelsea 2-1 on Sunday.

Morgan Rogers volleyed the visitors ahead after 77 seconds but Arsenal's response was emphatic with Kai Havertz equalising after 25 minutes and Martin Odegaard finishing off a flowing move shortly after the break for the decisive goal.

Chelsea were never out of contention in an absorbing high-octane duel and substitute Estevao was denied a late



Kai Havertz (L) levelled the score for Arsenal against Chelsea. REUTERS

equaliser by a superb save from David Raya.

Victory left Arsenal level at the top with Manchester City with both sides on a maximum nine points after three

games. Chelsea's first dropped points left them on six.

Everton rescue point

Ainsley Maitland-Niles scored a brilliant equaliser on

his debut with virtually the last kick of the game as Everton rescued a point in a 2-2 Premier League draw with Manchester United at the Hill Dickinson Stadium on Sunday.

Benjamin Sesko looked to have won the game for the visitors with an 87th-minute header, but substitute Maitland-Niles hit a first-time shot from 30 yards to preserve his side's unbeaten start to the season. United have four points from their opening three games of the campaign and lie in 11th place in the standings, while Everton are in eighth with five points from the same number of matches.

Bryan Mbeumo's superb solo effort had put the visitors

in front early in the second half, but Everton grew steadily into the game and Tyrrique George equalised with a ferocious shot, before the late goals from Sesko and Maitland-Niles.

United will be disappointed not to have taken the three points in a game in which they led twice and struck the bar in the first half through Bruno Fernandes.

But Everton had the better of the attacking chances with more shots on target and kept plugging away, showing the kind of fighting spirit they will need this season with their wafer-thin squad following a much-criticised transfer window.

Zverev into last 16 but US Open turns sour for home favourites



Alexander Zverev dispatched Alejandro Tabilo 6-2, 7-6(2), 6-2. AP

Reuters
New York, September 6

ALEXANDER ZVEREV kept his bid for a second Grand Slam title alive with a straightforward win over Alejandro Tabilo, while Coco Gauff stayed strong to reach the fourth round of the U.S. Open as several of her fellow Americans crashed out on Saturday.

Naomi Osaka overcame a mental and physical battle to outlast Belgium's Elise Mertens in a three-setter on Louis Armstrong Stadium.

Two of the brightest young prospects in the women's draw, and close friends off it, put on a show as American Iva Jovic edged Filipina Alexandra Eala in a thrilling clash on Arthur Ashe Stadium.

After back-to-back five-setters, top seed Zverev finally enjoyed a quieter night as he overcame a small mid-match dip to see off Chile's Tabilo 6-2, 7-6(2), 6-2. "I think today was definitely much better than the last couple of days. I think I improved a lot from the baseline," Zverev said.

"I wasn't happy with the second set. I think especially the end of the second set I lost focus a little bit. I was not moving as well. I was not playing as well. But I think the first and third sets are a big improvement to the other days. I'll try to focus on that."

Japanese 13th seed Osaka, a two-time U.S. Open champion, worked through a challenge after letting slip a one-set and break advantage before managing an Achilles niggle to beat Mertens 6-3, 3-6, 7-5. The match was as much a test of Osaka's composure as her tennis, with the 28-year-old showing visible frustration before regaining control. "Honestly, I didn't feel like I played amazing, and it was really getting me down, like I was very negative on myself, so I'm really sorry about my behavior," an emotional Osaka said.

Jovic, 18, and Eala, 21, traded momentum throughout a contest that lasted more than three hours before the American prevailed 7-5, 3-6, 7-5. Jovic, the 14th seed, will next face compatriot and fan favourite Gauff. Fourth seed Gauff had earlier provided the day's clearest positive for the home fans, the 22-year-old beating Spain's Cristina Bucsa 6-3, 6-4, as the 2023 champion looks to win a third Grand Slam crown.

After back-to-back five-setters, top seed Zverev finally enjoyed a quieter night as he overcame a small mid-match dip

Second seed Elena Rybakina continued her quest for a third major title and the top spot in the WTA rankings, advancing after a 7-6(6), 6-3 win over Yulia Starodubtseva.

Australian Open champion Rybakina avenged the second-round defeat she suffered to the Ukrainian at the French Open. The Kazakh will face Osaka for a place in the quarter-finals.

Iga Swiatek, the 2022 champion, beat Marie Bouzkova 7-6(3), 7-6(3) while French Open champion Mirra Andreeva advanced by downing Nikola Bartunkova 6-2, 7-6(5).

The day had begun with a string of exits for the home players. Past U.S. Open finalists Taylor Fritz, Madison Keys and Amanda Anisimova all crashed out in the third round, dealing a stinging blow to the home fans at Flushing Meadows.

Ninth seed Fritz had yet to drop a set in New York and looked on his way to another routine victory before Argentinian Francisco Cerundolo flipped the script and won 3-6, 4-6, 6-3, 6-4, 6-4.

It was the earliest exit in four years for the 2024 runner-up and Cerundolo will next face Belgium's Alexander Blockx, who shocked fifth seed Flavio Cobolli 6-7(4), 6-3, 6-0, 6-3; Learner Tien bt Jakub Mensik 6-3, 1-6, 6-7(2), 6-3, 6-4.

RESULTS
Men's singles third round: Alexander Zverev bt Alejandro Tabilo 6-2, 7-6(2), 6-2; Francisco Cerundolo bt Taylor Fritz 3-6, 4-6, 6-3, 6-4, 6-4; Alexander Blockx bt Flavio Cobolli 6-7(4), 6-3, 6-0, 6-3; Learner Tien bt Jakub Mensik 6-3, 1-6, 6-7(2), 6-3, 6-4.

Women's singles third round: Elena Rybakina bt Yulia Starodubtseva 7-6(6), 6-3; Naomi Osaka bt Elise Mertens 6-3, 3-6, 7-5; Iva Jovic bt Alexandra Eala 7-5, 3-6, 7-5; Coco Gauff bt Cristina Bucsa 6-3, 6-4.

NEW SPRINTER EMERGES

Two national records taken down, Samraj, 17, has his sights set on loftier goals

Nihal Koshie
New Delhi, September 6

LAST WEEK, 17-year-old Neil Samraj didn't celebrate, though he broke the national record twice within an hour at the National Youth Athletics Championships in Ludhiana. He clocked 10.53 seconds in the semifinals to become India's fastest-ever Under-18 sprinter, then improved the time to 10.46 seconds in the final. But Neil felt he missed an opportunity to lower the record further. Unfortunately, he was under the weather.

"The target was to clock sub-10.40 in the finals. But on the day of the competition, I had a cold. There was an hour's gap between the semis and the final, so I could not really recover as I was unwell. So, with whatever energy I had left, I could produce 10.46. The final was not up to my expectations.

I wanted to go faster," Coimbatore-based Neil said. A significantly faster national record shows Neil is on the right track, with the previous mark at 10.63.

Becoming a sprinter was written in his stars.

His mother, Selvarasi, a government school teacher, advised Neil to focus on sprinting when he was in Class 9. His physical education teacher also felt he had the potential to excel in the 100 and 200 metres. Neil loves the adrenaline rush of a sprint, so he didn't think twice once he bought into the idea.

"When I was in school, I was into athletics, football, and basketball. My mother participated in school zonals and district zonals when she was young, but didn't have support. She felt that I would be good at sprinting. From the beginning, I was focused on the 100 metres and the 200

metres. Compared to other events, sprinting is a showcase event, so I get a different kind of motivation. That is why I love running fast," Neil said.

He also had inspiration at home as his sister Nedra — two years older than him — is a bronze medalist at the school nationals in the 100 metres. His father, Rathnam, who works in banking, and his mother encouraged both children to take up sports. "Whatever we asked, my parents fully supported it. We are blessed to have parents like this," Neil said.

Fast track

His coach at Coimbatore's Unique Sports Academy, Velmurugan Paul Raj, has moulded his career over the past four years. Getting Neil hooked onto sprinting required a pep talk. "In the early days, he would come for



Neil Samraj broke the national record twice within an hour at the National Youth Athletics Championships in Ludhiana. AFI

training for just two to three days a week and was not fully focused. I told him he was gifted as he was blessed with fast-twitch muscles, which is a big plus point if one wants to

be a sprinter. I convinced him he could win medals. After that, his attitude towards training changed," Paul Raj said. Neil's inbuilt confidence helps him win the mental

“There is nothing majorly weak about Neil's sprinting technique. He is solid. First 30m is probably the area where he needs to work. I have been giving him advice on how he handles his first three steps and sets the race.”

JAMES HILLIER,
ATHLETICS DIRECTOR

battle when on the track, the coach added.

Neil is also now working with James Hillier, the Athletics Director at Reliance Foundation. A medal at the

Youth Olympics in Dakar is Neil's aim for this year.

"When I graduate to the senior level, I want to ensure my performances are not up and down so I can win medals for India," Neil, a first-year BA history student at Loyola College, said.

Hillier wants Neil to be consistent at 10.40 seconds as the first step towards getting better. "There is nothing majorly weak about Neil's sprinting technique. He is generally pretty solid. The first 30 metres is probably the area where he needs to work technically. I have been giving him a bit of advice on how he handles his first three steps and sets the race up. He did actually start really well in the competition (national youth championships), so it seems like that is coming together. It is about improving the consistency of what he does. 10.46

is definitely good for a seventeen-year-old. What he needs to do is get consistent at that time rather than push for 10.3s and 10.2s right now. We want to develop a sprinter who will go from junior to senior and be successful at the highest level. We don't want to rush the performance," Hillier said.

A quality of Neil that Hillier likes is his openness to being coached. "We see a lot of talented kids running fast, but it is always the attitude that I am drawn to. He is very ambitious; he wants to learn, which is a great quality that he has got," Hillier said.

Neil believes divine intervention and his training regimen will hold him in good stead on the track. "I can work hard till I reach the starting point (blocks). After that, it is the training that I have done and God that will determine how fast I run."

